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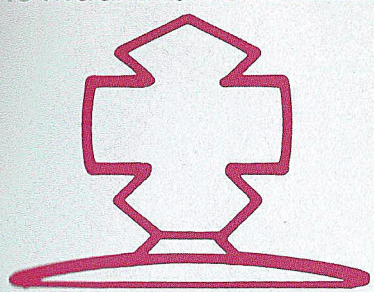
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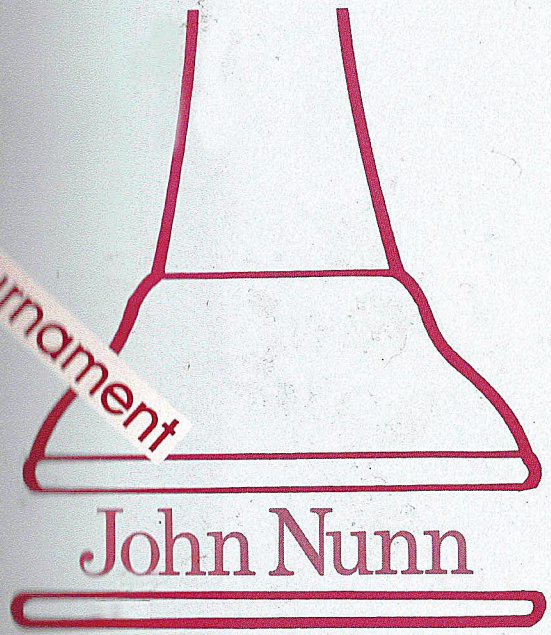
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THE CLASSICAL KING'S INDIAN



John Nunn

The Classical King's Indian

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Introduction

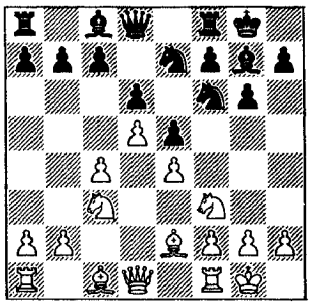
One of the attractions of the King's Indian is that Black may adopt it against virtually any non-e4 opening by White. For this reason White players need to consider which system to adopt against the King's Indian, and they often choose the Classical Variation. There seems little risk in a system involving straightforward development by ♘c3, ♘f3, ♗e2 and 0-0, yet very sharp and double-edged positions often arise. The main line of the Classical runs

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**c4**	**g6**
3	**♘c3**	**♗g7**
4	**e4**	**d6**
5	**♘f3**	**0-0**
6	**♗e2**	**e5**
7	**0-0**	**♘c6**
8	**d5**	**♘e7** *(1)*

reaching the position in Diagram 1.

Note that we do not consider any of the White alternatives such as 7 d5 or 8 ♗e3, nor do we examine systems involving ... ♘bd7 by Black. All these lines are fundamentally different, and here we are examining only those variations resulting from Diagram 1. This may sound like

1
W



undue specialisation, yet in practice I have found that roughly one third of all my games in the King's Indian reach Diagram 1. I have attempted to give a detailed and complete coverage of all resulting lines, but for reasons of space there is a slight bias in favour of those lines which are popular today.

What are the strategic aims for the two players from this position? The pawn structure dictates that White must attack on the queenside and Black on the kingside, but it is a mistake to assume, naively, that the game will develop into a straight race between the two attacks. White's objective is to play b4 and

c5, gaining space and attacking the vulnerable d6 point. The direct attack on d6 can be unpleasant, especially if it is augmented by ♘d2–c4 and ♘b5 or ♗a3 and b5, yet Black can normally defend this single weakness. The opening of the c-file by cxd6 followed by possible penetration with ♖c1, ♕c2 and ♘b5 is usually a more serious worry, and sometimes the a7 pawn comes under fire by ♗e3 and ♘b5. When Black has to move a queenside pawn more weaknesses are created and the end is in sight on that flank, although he may gain time to further his kingside counterplay. That counterplay is based on moving the ♘f6 and playing ... f5, when returning to f6 with the knight usually forces White to defend e4 by f3. Then Black often transfers the attack to White's king by playing ... f4, advancing his other kingside pawns and trying to force through ... g4. Black's play need not be quite so one-sided, since in many lines it is worth spending time to hold White up on the queenside, and occasionally Black can play on the queenside himself by ... c6 and maybe ... b5.

We therefore consider 9 b4 in Chapter 1, since this is the most direct way of setting about White's plan. Black will aim for counterplay by ... ♘h5–f4 and possibly ... f5, and this is the main defect of 9 b4; it allows the f6 knight to clear the way for the f-pawn while taking up an active position itself. Despite this 9 b4 is quite a dangerous line and deserves to be treated with respect. In Chapters 2–4 we look at 9 ♘d2, which again aims for b4, c5 and ♘c4 but at the same time prevents ... ♘h5, so if Black wants to play ... f5 he has to move his knight backwards. Black can play 9 ... ♘e8 or 9 ... ♘d7, as in Chapter 4, but challenging White to a race seems a bad decision as White's attack arrives first, so these lines have fallen into disuse. Instead attention has switched to plans which slow down White's queenside attack, namely 9 ... a5 and 9 ... c5. The move 9 ... a5, analysed in Chapter 2, effectively gains a tempo, because by spending one move Black forces White to prepare b4 with the two moves a3 and ♖b1. In this chapter we see for the first time how Black sometimes makes a pre-emptive strike on the queenside by ... c6 in order to interfere with White's attack. This line is currently very popular thanks to its adoption by the world champion Gary Kasparov. 9 ... c5 is more conservative; White can still get a queenside attack by ♖b1 and b4 but Black prevents White gaining a big space advantage and forces White to conduct the attack on a narrower front. 9 ... c5 may also be met by 10 dc, which changes the pawn structure dramatically and leads to a quite different type of position.

9 ♘e1 is the subject of Chapters 5–8. In this case White again prevents ... ♘h5, but he abandons his plan to transfer the knight to the best square c4, aiming for d3 instead. This supports c5, so White normally has little trouble opening the c-file, but it is not so clear whether he can make good use of it. In Chapter 5 we look at the 'long main line', a variation which shows most dramatically the contest of queenside v kingside attacks. Despite a great deal of practical experience and analysis the final verdict on this line is not clear. Chapter 6 examines the Benko Attack 9 ♘e1 ♘d7 10 f3 f5 11 g4. At first sight this pawn thrust looks like madness, since it breaks the rule that you should not make a pawn move in the area where you are being attacked. However there is good sense behind this move, the plan being to blockade the kingside, preventing Black gaining a big space advantage there, and then to resume play on the other flank. This line leads to particularly complex positions in which there is a strong link between the queenside and kingside play. In Chapter 7 Korchnoi's favourite line 9 ♘e1 ♘d7 10 f3 f5 11 ♗e3 comes under the microscope (or at least the magnifying glass). At the cost of some time (because ... f4 comes with gain of tempo), White transfers his bishop to a more active diagonal. Once again we have the kingside v queenside race, with most games leading to double-edged tactics.

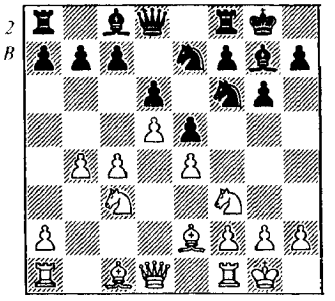
The last two chapters perform a rounding-up exercise. In Chapter 8 we look at unusual replies to 9 ♘e1; these lines are not very important. However Chapter 9, which considers White's 9th move alternatives, includes some significant possibilities. Most of these are based on the logic that Black may not be threatening ... ♘ moves and ... f5 at the moment, because White can reply ♘g5–e6. After the exchange on e6 Black may round up the pawn on e6, but the time taken and the resulting white-squared weaknesses may enable White to develop a strong attack. Therefore White plays relatively useful moves such as ♗d2 and ♖c1, waiting for ... f5; if Black plays ... h6 first to prevent ♘g5, then Black loses a clear tempo. Such is the logic, but experience shows that ♘g5–e6 is not such a terrible possibility and Black can allow it without incurring any disadvantage. Moreover the whole plan may be crossed by the simple 9 ♗d2 ♘h5. These lines are not often played today.

Most of the world's leading players are willing to take one side or the other in Diagram 1. Some, like Kasparov, are willing to take either colour. It is therefore not surprising that no final verdict has been reached on these lines; in addition to the long theoretical

variations there are many sidelines which have hardly been touched upon in practice. I am sure there are many years of investigation ahead in Diagram 1, and tournament points for those who are willing to make a close study of its complexities.

1 9 b4

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**c4**	**g6**
3	**♘c3**	**♗g7**
4	**e4**	**d6**
5	**♘f3**	**0-0**
6	**♗e2**	**e5**
7	**0-0**	**♘c6**
8	**d5**	**♘e7**
9	**b4** *(2)*	



In some ways this is White's most direct plan. He simply proceeds with his queenside attack without worrying too much about the other wing. A second advantage of leaving the knight at f3 is that ... f5 by Black can sometimes by met by ♘g5-e6. The problem is that Black can respond by ... ♘h5-f4, which usually forces White to take the knight. This activates the g7 bishop and gives Black a potential kingside attack by ... h6 and ... g5. However, the g7 bishop often turns out to be surprisingly powerless even on the open long diagonal. White has gained enough time to move everything off the diagonal, so the bishop is striking into thin air. Moreover Black's other pieces are better posted for kingside play, and do not co-operate well with the g7 bishop. Because of this Black should always consider taking a knight with the bishop, even though most King's Indian players are reluctant to part with their favourite piece. It is not easy for Black to equalize against 9 b4, and it is surprising that it is not played more frequently.

9 ... ♘h5

The most common reply by far. Other moves:

a) **9 ... c5** (this looks dubious, but its only practical outing was a success) 10 bc dc 11 ♗b2? (the idea is that 11 ♘xe5 is met by 11 ... ♘d7! when 12 ♘xd7 ♗xc3 13 ♘xf8 ♗xa1 14 d6 ♘c6 15 d7 ♔xf8

and 12 f4 ♘xe5 13 fe ♗xe5 14 ♕d3 ♘c6! are slightly better for Black; however, 11 a4 followed by ♗a3 is much better since if Black plays ... b6 White can reply a5) 11 ... ♘e8 12 a4 ♘d6 13 ♘d2 f5 14 ♘b3? (14 f3 is better) 14 ... fe! 15 ♘xc5 e3 16 fe ♘ef5 with a clear plus for Black in Lomaia–Efimov, USSR 1981.

b) **9 ... ♘d7** (both this and 9 ... ♘e8 fail to take advantage of the bad side of 9 b4) and now:

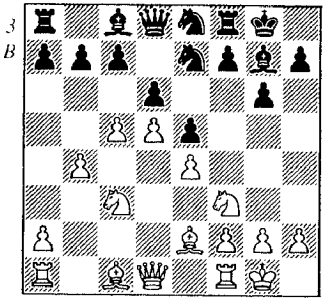
b1) **10 c5** f5 (10 ... dc 11 bc ♘xc5 12 ♗a3 b6 13 ♖c1 is good for White) 11 cd (11 ♘d2! is simple and good – see Chapter 4 – but 11 ♘g5 ♘f6 12 f3 is doubtful after 12 ... dc 13 bc h6 14 ♘e6 ♗xe6 15 de ♕d4+!) 11 ... cd 12 ♘d2 ♘f6 13 b5?! ♗h6 14 ♗d3 fe 15 ♘dxe4 ♗xc1 16 ♖xc1 ♗f5 17 ♕d2 ♖c8 18 ♘xf6+ ♖xf6 19 ♗xf5 gf 20 ♔h1 ♘g6 and Black had the edge in Flear–Mestel, Bath 1987, since White's queenside pawn advance has only served to weaken c5.

b2) **10 ♗d2** f5 11 ♘g5 ♘f6 12 f3 f4 13 ♕b3 (13 b5?! c6 14 ♘e6 ♗xe6 15 de ♕c8 16 bc bc is fine for Black, Rubinetti–Quinteros, Buenos Aires 1969) 13 ... ♘h5 14 ♘e6 ♗xe6 15 de c6 16 ♗e1 with a slight advantage for White, Ruiz–Durao, Malaga 1967.

b3) **10 ♗e3** f5 11 ♘g5 ♘f6 12 f3 f4 13 ♗f2 h6 14 ♘e6 ♗xe6 15 de c6 16 ♕d2 ♕c7 and again White is a little better, Pachman–Durao, Munich Ol 1958.

b4) **10 ♘d2**. This transposes to a line of Chapter 4 considered good for White, and is sufficient reason in itself to condemn 9 ... ♘d7.

c) **9 ... ♘e8** 10 c5 *(3)* (just as in variation b above, 10 ♘d2 leads to a favourable line from Chapter 4, but here 10 c5 appears even better) and now:



c1) **10 ... c6** 11 ♗e3 f5 12 dc ♘xc6 13 b5 ♘a5 14 ♕d5+ ♔h8 15 cd with a very good position for White, Klüger–Popov, Hungary–Bulgaria 1959.

c2) **10 ... a5** 11 ♗a3 ab 12 ♗xb4 dc 13 ♗xc5 ♘d6 14 ♕b3 ♔h8 15 ♖ac1 f5 16 ♘d2 with a clear advantage, Welemander–Borisenko, corr. 1955.

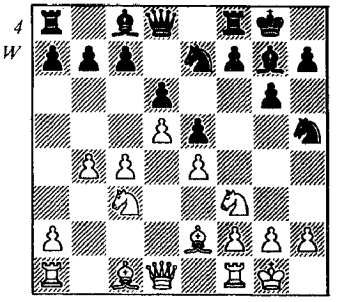
c3) **10 ... f5** 11 ♘g5 ♘f6 12 f3 ♔h8 13 ♗e3 ♗h6 14 ♘f7+ ♖xf7 15 ♗xh6 f4 16 ♖c1 ♘eg8 17 ♗g5 is also dismal for Black, Najdorf–Cuartas, Buenos Aires 1973.

c4) **10 ... ♔h8** 11 a4 f5 12 ♘g5 h6 13 ♘e6 ♗xe6 14 de fe 15 cd ♘xd6 16 b5 ♕c8 17 ♘d5 ♖e8 18 ♗g4 was not so clear in Gligorić–Evans, Amsterdam 1971, but the simple 11 ♘d2! leaves White virtually a tempo up over an already promising line from Chapter 4.

c5) **10 ... h6** 11 ♘d2 (or 11 a4 f5 12 ♗a3 fe 13 ♘d2 e3 14 fe ♘f5 15 ♘c4 h5 16 e4 and Black is in trouble, Cvetković–Mestrović, Yugoslavia 1974) 11 ... f5 12 ♘c4 (again White has an extra move as ... h6 is no asset; 12 ♗a3 g5 13 b5 dc 14 ♗xc5 ♘d6 15 a4 b6 16 ♗b4 was less incisive in Savon–Borodanski, USSR 1966) 12 ... ♘f6 (there is only a choice of miserable lines: 12 ... f4 13 f3 g5 14 a4 ♖f6 15 ♗a3 ♖g6 16 b5 is similar, Klüger–Sapi, Hungarian Ch 1963) 13 f3 f4 14 a4 g5 15 ♗a3 ♘g6 16 b5 ♘e8 17 a5 ♖f7 18 b6 and the queenside attack crunches home, Smyslov–Ciocaltea, Sochi 1961.

d) **9 ... a5** 10 ♗a3 (or 10 ba c5 11 dc ♘xc6 and now both 12 a6 ♖xa6 13 ♖b1 ♗e6 14 ♗e3 ♖e8, Taimanov–Bolesławsky, USSR Ch 1961, and 12 ♗g5 ♕xa5 13 ♗xf6 ♕xc3 14 ♕xd6 ♗e6 15 ♗g5 ♖a6 16 c5 ♖xa2 17 ♖xa2 ♗xa2 18 ♕d2 ♕xd2 19 ♘xd2, Bonin–Ree, New York 1985, were equal) 10 ... ♘d7 (this leads to the same thing as 10 ... ab 11 ♗xb4 ♘d7) 11 ba ♖xa5 12 ♗b4 ♖a8 13 a4 ♘c5 (13 ... ♗h6 14 ♕b3 ♔h8 15 ♖fd1 b6 16 a5 ♘c5 17 ♕b2 gave White an edge in Tisdall–I.Sokolov, Preston 1989) 14 ♘d2 ♘a6!? (14 ... f5 15 ♗xc5 dc 16 ♘b3 b6 17 a5 was good for White in Kevitz–Pinkus, New York 1955, while 14 ... ♗d7 is met by 15 ♗xc5! dc 16 ♘b3 b6 17 a5 or 15 a5 ♘c8 16 ♘b3 ♕e7 17 ♗f3, Petrosian–Stein, USSR Ch 1969, with an edge for White in both cases) 15 ♗a3 f5 16 ♘b3 fe 17 ♘xe4 ♘f5 18 c5 ♕h4 19 ♕b1 ♘xc5 20 ♘bxc5 dc 21 ♗xc5 ♘d4 22 ♗c4 ♗f5 23 f3 ♗xe4 24 fe ♖xf1+ 25 ♕xf1 ♕d8 ½–½ K.Berg–Nunn, Bundesliga 1985.

After 9 ... ♘h5 *(4)* there are two main lines in current use:



A 10 g3
B 10 c5

10 ♘d2 was played at one time, but after the famous game Petrosian–Gligorić, Rovinj-Zagreb 1970, it fell into disuse. The continuation 10 ... ♘f4 11 a4 (11 c5 f5 12 ♗f3 g5 13 ef ♘xf5 14 g3 ♘d4 15 gf ♘xf3+ 16 ♘xf3 g4 is unclear) 11 ... f5 12 ♗f3 g5 13 ef ♘xf5 14 g3 ♘d4! 15 gf ♘xf3+ 16 ♕xf3 (or 16 ♘xf3 ef 17 ♗b2 g4 18 ♔h1 with equality) 16 ... g4 17 ♕d3 (not 17 ♕h1? ef

with a good game for Black as in Petrosian-Gligorić) 17 ... ♗f5 is level.

Of the two lines 10 c5 causes more problems. Although 10 g3 prevents ... ♘f4 it weakens White's kingside and gives Black time to play ... f5 under relatively favourable circumstances.

A

10 g3 f5

The standard reply, but one should note the game Vanheste-Riemersma, Dutch Ch 1987, which continued 10 ... a5 11 ba f5 12 ♘d2 ♘f6 13 ♗a3 ♗h6 14 c5 ♗xd2 15 ♕xd2 ♘xe4 16 ♘xe4 fe 17 ♖ac1 ♗h3 18 ♖fd1 ♘f5 19 ♗b2 e3! 20 fe ♘xg3 21 hg ♕g5 22 g4 ♖f2! 23 ♕e1 ♖af8 24 e4 ♕f4 0-1. The preliminary ... a5 removes the danger of a quick c5 as in the main line, but unfortunately White did not play the critical line 12 ♘g5 ♘f6 13 f3.

11 ♘g5

Or 11 ♘d2 ♘f6 12 c5 (12 f3 f4 13 g4 g5 14 c5 ♘g6 15 ♘c4 ♖f7 16 a4 ♗f8 17 ♗a3 h5 18 h3 ♖h7 19 ♔g2 ♗e7 led to a double-edged position in Anelli-Quinteros, Argentine Ch 1971) 12 ... f4 13 ♘c4 ♗h3 14 ♖e1 ♘c8! (not 14 ... h5?! 15 gf! ef 16 ♕d3!) 15 a4 (15 ♕d3 ♘g4 16 f3 is met by the unclear 16 ... ♘h6 rather than 16 ... ♘xh2? 17 ♔xh2 ♕g5 18 ♖g1 ♕h5 19 ♖h1!) 15 ... h5! 16 ♕d3 ♘g4 17 ♘d1 ♘h6 18 ♖a3 ♗g4 19 ♗f1 ♘e7 20 h3 ♗c8 21 ♖b3 g5 22 ♗a3 ♘f7 23 b5 b6! 24 cd cd 25 ♗b4 ♘g6 with a clear plus for Black, Sosonko-Kavalek, Waddinxveen 1979.

11 ... ♘f6

12 f3

12 c5? h6 13 ♘e6 ♗xe6 14 de fe and 12 ef ♘xf5 are pleasant for Black.

12 ... c6 *(6)*

This has become the most popular, although 12 ... f4 has not been refuted. The possibilities are:

a) **12 ... ♔h8** 13 ♗e3 ♘eg8 14 ♕d2 ♕e7 15 c5! h6 16 ♘e6 ♗xe6 17 de ♕xe6 18 ♘b5 ♘e8 19 cd cd 20 ♖ac1! fe 21 fe ♖xf1+ 22 ♗xf1 was good for White in Bukić-Nemet, Yugoslavia 1981.

b) **12 ... h6** (spending a tempo to force ♘e6 plays into White's hands and now Black is slightly worse) 13 ♘e6 ♗xe6 14 de c6 (14 ... ♕c8? 15 ♘d5 ♖e8 16 ♗d3! is unpleasant for Black, while 14 ... ♘h7 15 c5 f4 16 ♕b3 ♔h8 17 ♗a3 fg 18 hg does nothing to remove the thorn in Black's flesh, McGullen-Coldrick, Ireland 1973) 15 b5! (better than 15 ♗e3 ♕c7 16 ♕b3 ♖ad8 17 ♖ad1 ♕c8 18 ♗xa7 ♕xe6 19 ♗b6 with just an edge for White, Szabo-Gligorić, Buenos Aires 1960) 15 ... ♕c7 (15 ... ♘e8 16 bc bc 17 ♖b1 ♘c7 18 ♗a3 c5 19 ♘b5 gives White a clear plus) 16 ♖b1 ♖fd8 17 ♕a4 (not 17 ♗e3 d5 and Black escapes) 17 ... ♕c8 18 bc bc 19 ♗e3 ♕xe6 20 ♖b7 and now:

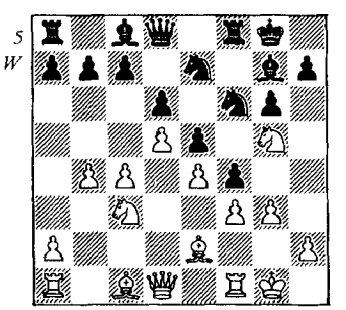
b1) **20 ... ♔h7 ?!** 21 ♕a6! ♘d7 22 ♖d1 f4 23 ♖xa7 regains the pawn with advantage, Bukić-Minić, Yugoslav Ch 1962.

b2) **20 ... a5** 21 ♖fb1 f4 22 ♗f2 h5 23 ♖c7 ♖d7 24 ♖bb7 ♖xc7 25 ♖xc7 fg 26 hg ♗h6 27 c5!, Taimanov-Gligorić, Santa Fe 1960, was good for White.

b3) **20 ... ♖d7** 21 ♖fb1 ♔h7 22 ♕a6! h5 23 ♖xd7 ♘xd7 24 ♕b7 ♖b8 25 ♕xa7 ♖xb1+ 26 ♘xb1 with an edge for White, Schmidt-Hübner, Skopje Ol 1972.

b4) **20 ... f4** 21 ♗f2 fg 22 hg ♔h8 23 ♖xa7 (23 ♖fb1 d5 is equal but 23 ♕a6, as in the lines above, should be slightly better for White) 23 ... ♖ab8! 24 ♖b1 ♖xb1+ 25 ♘xb1 ♖b8 26 ♖a8 ♕c8 27 ♖xb8 ♕xb8 with a level position, Taimanov-Simagin, USSR Ch 1961.

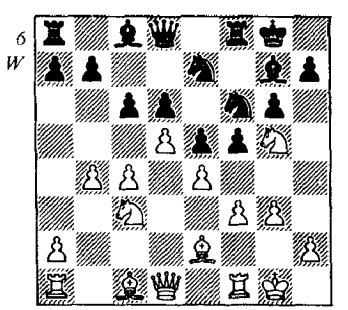
c) **12 ... f4** *(5)* and now:



c1) **13 b5** h6 (or 13 ... ♘e8 and now not 14 ♔g2?! ♘f5! 15 ♘e6 ♗xe6 16 de ♘d4 but 14 ♘e6 ♗xe6 15 de ♕c8 16 ♘d5 ♕xe6 17 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 18 ♕d5+ ♔h8 19 ♕xb7 ♘f6 20 ♗d2, Ghitescu-Uhlmann, Berlin 1982, or 14 ♕b3 with an advantage to White in both cases) 14 ♘e6 ♗xe6 15 de fg 16 hg ♕c8 17 ♘d5 ♕xe6 18 ♘xc7 ♕h3 with a draw by perpetual check.

c2) **13 ♔g2** ♔h8!? 14 ♖b1 ♘e8 15 ♘h3 ♗f6 16 ♘f2 h5 17 gf ef 18 ♘b5 g5 was slightly better for Black in G.Garcia-Marjanović, Banja Luka 1979.

c3) **13 c5** fg (13 ... dc 14 bc h6 15 ♘e6 ♗xe6 16 de ♕d4+ 17 ♕xd4 ed 18 ♘b5 fg 19 ♖b1 gh+ 20 ♔xh2 ♘h5 21 ♔g2 c6 22 ♘d6 b5 23 f4 was complex but probably better for White in Sieglen-Düster, Bundesliga 1988/9) 14 hg h6 (based on the last bracket I suggest 14 ... dc 15 bc h6 16 ♘e6 ♗xe6 17 de ♕d4+ 18 ♕xd4 ed 19 ♘b5 ♘xe4!? 19 fe d3 and Black seems to have good chances) 15 ♘e6 ♗xe6 16 de d5! 17 ed ♘fxd5 18 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 19 ♗c4 c6 20 ♖b1! ♔h7 21 ♖b3 ♕e7! 22 ♗xd5 cd 23 ♕xd5 ♖ad8 24 ♕c4 ♖d4 25 ♕e2 ♕xe6 with equality in Taimanov-Bilek, Leningrad-Budapest 1957.



13 b5

Or 13 ♗e3 (not 13 ♗b2? fe 14 fe h6 15 ♘e6 ♗xe6 16 de ♕b6+ 17 ♔h1 ♕xb4, Littlewood-Gligorić, Hastings 1965/6) 13 ... ♗h6!? (13 ... f4 14 ♗f2 h6 15 ♘e6 ♗xe6 16 de ♔h7 17 b5 d5 18 bc bc 19 cd cd 20 ♘xd5 ♘exd5 21 ed ♘xd5 22 ♗b5 ♖c8 23 ♗d7 ♘c3 24 ♕d3 was very good for White in Sieglen-Heim, Bundesliga 1988) 14 ♕d2 (14 ♔h1 may be more dangerous since 14 ... ♘fxd5!? looks good for White after Seirawan's 15 cd f4 16 gf ef 17 dc ♗xg5 18 cb ♗xb7 19 ♗d4) 14 ... ♘h5 15 f4 ♗xg5 16 fg f4! 17 gf ef 18 ♗d4 (not 18 ♗xf4 ♗h3 19 ♖f2 ♖xf4! 20 ♖xf4 ♘xd5 21 ♘xd5 ♕xg5+ 22 ♔f2 ♘xf4 23 ♘xf4 ♖f8 and wins) 18 ... ♗h3 19 ♗xh5 gh 20 ♖xf4 ♕d7, Gleizerov-Frolov, USSR 1987, and Black is slightly better according to *Informator*, but an exchange sacrifice such as 21 ♗f6 ♘g6 22 ♖d1 ♘xf4 23 ♕xf4 ♕g4+ 24 ♕xg4 ♗xg4 25 ♖d2 looks safe for White.

13 ... ♘e8

Or 13 ... h6 14 ♘e6 ♗xe6 15 de and now not 15 ... d5? 16 cd cd 17 ♘xd5 ♘fxd5 18 ed ♕b6+ (18 ... ♕xd5 19 ♕xd5 ♘xd5 20 ♗c4 ♘e7 21 ♗a3 ♗f6 22 ♖fd1 wins) 19 ♔h1 ♖fd8 20 ♕b3 ♖xd5 21 ♗c4! with advantage to White, C. Hansen-Hebden, Silkeborg 1983. Instead Hansen assesses 15 ... ♕c7 16 bc bc 17 ♖b1 ♖fd8 18 ♕a4 ♕c8 19 ♗e3 ♕xe6 20 ♖b7 as unclear but 15 ... ♘e8! may be best of all, when 16 ♗a3 (16 bc bc 17 ♖b1 ♘c7 18 ♗a3 c5 19 ♘b5 ♘xe6 is at least equal for Black) 16 ... c5 17 ♕d3 ♕c8 18 ♘d5 ♕xe6 19 ef gf 20 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 21 ♖ad1 a6 left Black a pawn up in Makarov-Cvitan, GMA Belgrade Open 1988.

14 bc bc
15 c5 h6

16 ♗a3!? dc (16 ... hg 17 cd ♘xd6 18 dc ♕b6+ 19 ♔h1 ♖d8 20 ♗xd6 ♗e6 21 ♗xe7 ♖xd1 22 ♖fxd1 ♕xc6 23 ♖ac1 would have been unclear according to Donaldson) 17 ♗xc5 hg 18 d6 ♘xd6 19 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 20 ♗xd6 ♔f7 21 ♘a4 ♖d8 22 ♖fd1 ♗e6 23 ♘c5 ♘c8 24 ♘xe6 ½-½ Donaldson-Schroer, Philadelphia 1986.

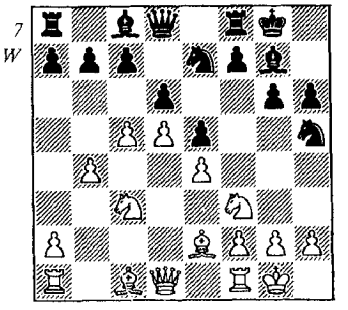
B

10 c5 ♘f4

Or:

a) **10 ... f5** 11 ef (11 ♘g5 ♘f6 12 ef gf 13 ♕b3 h6 14 cd cd 15 ♘e6 ♗xe6 16 de d5 17 ♖d1 d4 18 ♗a3 ♖c8 19 b5 ♖e8 was unclear in Yrjölä-Gudmundsson, Reykjavik 1986, while 11 ... ♘f4 is also possible since 12 ♗xf4 ef 13 ♖c1 ♗xc3 14 ♖xc3 h6 and 15 ... fe is good for Black) 11 ... ♘xf5 (11 ... gf 12 ♘g5 ♘f6 13 f4 and 11 ... e4 12 ♘d4 ♘xf5 13 ♘xf5 ♗xf5 14 ♗b2 are good for White) 12 ♘e4 and now both 12 ... ♘f4 and 12 ... ♘f6 are playable for Black.

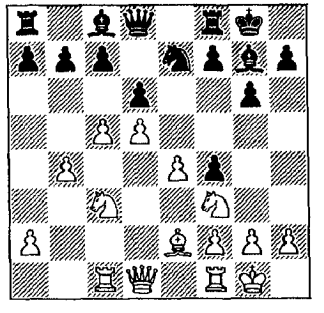
b) **10 ... h6** *(7)* (not a bad move, because White has no really constructive way to use the spare tempo, e.g. 11 ♘d2 prevents the immediate ♗xf4, while moving the bishop from c1 loses a tempo after a later capture on f4) and now:



b1) **11 ♘d2** ♘f4 12 ♘c4 f5 13 f3 (13 cd cd 14 ♘b5 fe is unclear) 13 ... g5 14 ♗e3 ♘eg6 15 cd cd 16 ♘b5 ♘h4 17 g3 (17 ♗xf4 ef 18 ♘bxd6 ♗xa1 19 ♕xa1 fe 20 fe g4! is murky) 17 ... ♘h3+ 18 ♔h1 f4 19 ♗xa7 fg 20 hg g4 21 ♗b6 ♕d7! 22 fg (22 gh g3! 23 ♘bxd6 ♘f4! wins) 22 ... ♕xb5 23 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 24 gh ♕xb4 25 a4 ♘f4 26 ♗f1 ♗d7 27 a5 ♖c8 28 ♕c2 ♗b5 29 ♖b1 ♖xc4 30 ♖xb4 ♖xc2 31 ♗xb5 ½-½ Karlsson-Sznapik, Pohja 1985.

b2) **11 g3** f5 12 ♘d2 ♘f6 13 f3 (Black is effectively a tempo down over 10 g3 f5 11 ♘d2 above, but that line was fine for Black and the extra tempo does not sway the balance too far in White's favour) 13 ... fe (13 ... h5 14 ♘c4 fe 15 fe ♗h3 is best met by 16 ♖f3!? since 16 ♖e1? ♘g4 and 16 ♖f2 b5!? are satisfactory for Black; 16 ... b5 is still the best reply, with an unclear position) 14 fe ♗h3 15 ♖f2 ♕d7 16 ♘c4 ♘g4 17 ♖xf8+ (not 17 ♖f3? ♘f5! 18 ef e4 19 ♘xe4 ♗xa1 20 ♗xh6 ♗g7 21 ♗xg7 ♕xg7 with advantage to Black) 17 ... ♖xf8 18 ♗f3 with a roughly level position, Lalić-Petrushin, Bosna 1985.

11 ♗xf4 ef
12 ♖c1 *(8)*



Or 12 ♕d2 h6 (12 ... ♗g4 13 ♖ac1 ♗xf3 13 ♗xf3 g5 followed by ... ♘g6 and ... ♕e7 is a simple plan, but there is a danger of ♗g4 followed by cd and ♘b5, when Black cannot contest the c-file; 12 ... f5 is another possibility, but 13 ♖ad1 fe 14 ♘xe4 h6 15 cd cd 16 ♘d4 ♘f5 17 ♘xf5 ♗xf5 18 ♕xf4 ♗e5 19 ♕e3 ♗xh2+ 20 ♔xh2 ♕h4+ 21 ♔g1 ♗xe4 22 ♖d4 ♖ae8 23 ♗f3 won material in Tisdall-Jonsson, Reykjavik 1989) 13 ♖ad1 g5 (13 ... ♗d7 14 ♘d4 g5 15 ♖fe1 ♘g6 16 c6 bc 17 dc was played in Welin-Mortensen, Winterthur 1986, and now 17 ... ♗xd4

18 ♕xd4 ♗xc6 19 b5 ♗b7 20 a4! ♘e5 21 a5 would have been unclear) 14 e5 ♘f5 (14 ... g4 15 ed cd 16 ♘e1 ♘g6 appears fine for Black) 15 ed cd 16 h3 ♗d7 17 ♘b5 ♕f6 18 ♖c1 h5 19 c6 ♗c8 20 ♘h2 with advantage for White in Welin–Scholseth, Gausdal 1987.

12 ... h6

This move prepares ... g5 and ... ♘g6, but there are other plans:

a) **12 ... f5** 13 e5!? (13 cd cd 14 ef ♗xf5 15 ♘b5 is unclear, while 13 ♘g5!? has not been tested) 13 ... de (13 ... ♗xe5? 14 ♘xe5 de 15 d6 cd 16 cd ♘c6 17 ♕d5+ ♔g7 18 b5 is very good for White) 14 d6 and now 14 ... ♘c6? 15 ♕d5+ ♔h8 16 b5, Suba–Uhlmann, Romania–GDR 1983, was bad for Black. Suba gives 14 ... cd 15 cd ♘c6 16 ♕d5+ ♔h8 17 b5 ♘d4 (17 ... ♘b4? 18 ♕c5 ♕a5 19 a3 wins) 18 ♘xe5 ♘xe2+ 19 ♘xe2 ♕e8 20 d7 ♗xd7 (not 20 ... ♕xe5 21 d8♕) 21 ♘xd7 ♖d8 22 ♖cd1! ♕xe2 23 ♖fe1 as leading to an unclear position.

b) **12 ... a5** 13 cd cd 14 ♘b5 ab and now:

b1) **15 ♕d2** when both 15 ... ♗g4 16 ♖c7 ♘c8 17 ♘fd4 ♗xe2 18 ♘xe2, K.Grigorian–Geller, USSR Ch 1971, and 15 ... f5 16 ♗d3 fe 17 ♗xe4 ♖a4 18 ♖c4 ♗f5 19 ♗xf5 ♘xf5 20 ♖xb4 ♕a5 21 ♖xa4 ♕xa4 22 ♕e2, Henley–Spraggett, New York 1983, were slightly better for White.

b2) **15 ♕b3** ♗g4 16 ♖c7 (16 ♖c2 ♕b6 17 ♕xb4 ♗xf3 18 ♗xf3 ♗e5 is equal) 16 ... ♖e8 (16 ... f5!? is risky, but may be possible) 17 ♖fc1 ♘f5 18 ♕xb4 ♖xa2 19 ef ♖axe2 20 fg hg 21 ♕xf4 and again White has an edge, Yrjölä–Grivas, Thessaloniki Ol 1984.

c) **12 ... ♗g4** 13 ♘d4 (more active than 13 ♘d2) 13 ... ♗xe2 14 ♘cxe2 a5 15 a3 ab 16 ab with a slight plus for White, Benjamin–Mäki, World Student Team Ch 1981.

13 h3

There have been attempts to manage without this move, the alternative being to transfer the f3 knight to c4, e.g. 13 a4 (if White wants to play ♘d2–c4 this preparatory move seems unnecessary, for example 13 ♘d2 g5 14 ♘c4 ♘g6 15 ♗g4 ♘e5 16 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 17 ♗xc8 ♖xc8 18 ♘b5 ♕f6 19 c6 bc 20 ♖xc6 ♖b8 21 a4 ♕g6 22 ♕d3 with advantage for White, Lein–Rohde, New York 1977) 13 ... g5 14 ♘d2 ♘g6 15 ♘c4 ♖e8 (15 ... ♗xc3 16 ♖xc3 ♕f6 is more solid) 16 cd! cd 17 ♘b5 ♖xe4 (17 ... ♗e5 18 ♘c7! ♕xc7 19 ♘xe5 ♕e7 20 ♘xg6 fg 21 ♗b5! is good for White) 18 ♕c2! ♖e7 19 ♘cxd6 a6 20 ♘xc8! (20 ♕xc8 ♖xc8 21 ♖xc8 ♕xc8 22 ♘xc8 ♖xe2 23 ♘bd6 ♖c2! is unclear) 20 ... ♖xe2! 21 ♕xe2 ab 22 ♕xb5 ♖xc8 23 ♖xc8 ♕xc8 24 d6! and the complications turned out well for White, Estévez–García Martínez, Cuban Ch 1984.

13 ... g5

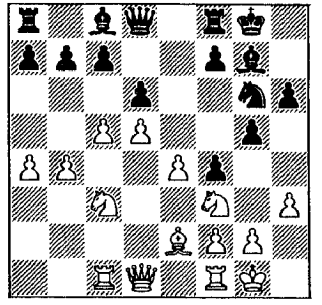
Black may change plans and directly attack White's centre by 13 ... f5 14 cd cd 15 ef ♘xf5 (15 ... ♗xf5?! 16 ♘d4 aims at the weak spot e6), when 16 ♕d2 h5 17 ♘b5 ♖f7 18 a4 a6 19 ♘a3 (19 ♘bd4 ♘xd4 20 ♘xd4 ♗xd4 21 ♕xd4 f3 22 ♗xf3 ♖xf3 23 gf ♗xh3 is also fine for Black) 19 ... g5 20 ♘h2 g4 21 hg ♘d4 was good for Black in Fedorowicz–Boudy, Mexico 1978. The crucial line runs 16 ♘b5 ♖f7 17 ♕c2 ♗d7 18 ♖fd1 ♕b6 19 a4 ♖c8 20 ♕xc8+!? ♗xc8 21 ♖xc8+ ♖f8 (21 ... ♔h7 22 a5 ♕a6 23 ♘bd4 b5 24 ♖b8 wins for White after 24 ... ♖b7 25 ♗xb5 ♖xb5 26 ♘xb5 and ♖c1–c6 or 24 ... ♘xd4 25 ♘xd4 ♗xd4 26 ♗xb5 ♕b7 27 ♖xb7 ♖xb7 28 ♖xd4) 22 a5 ♕a6 23 ♘bd4 b5 24 ♖xf8+ ♔xf8 25 ♘xf5 gf 26 ♖c1 with a double-edged position.

14 a4

Not 14 ♘d4?! ♘g6 15 ♗g4 ♗xg4 16 hg ♗xd4 17 ♕xd4 f3 18 gf ♘h4 with advantage to Black.

14 ... ♘g6 *(9)*

And now:



a) **15 a5** ♖e8 16 ♘d2 ♘e5?! (after 16 ... ♗xc3 17 ♖xc3 ♕f6 White has just an edge) 17 cd cd 18 ♘b5! ♖e7 19 ♕c2 a6 (not 19 ... g4 20 hg ♘xg4 21 ♘xa7) 20 ♘d4 g4 21 hg ♘xg4 22 ♘e6! ♗xe6 23 de ♘e5 24 ef+ ♖xf7 25 ♗c4 ♘xc4 26 ♕xc4 and now White has a clear plus, Diesen–Day, Lone Pine 1977.

b) **15 ♘b5** a6 16 ♘bd4 ♖e8 17 ♖c4 ♕f6 (17 ... ♖xe4 18 ♘e6) 18 ♕c2 h5 19 ♘f5 (19 cd cd 20 ♘f5 may be better) 19 ... ♖xe4! 20 ♕xe4 ♗xf5 21 ♕d4 ♕e7 22 ♕d1 (22 ♕d2 g4 23 hg hg 24 ♘d4 ♗xd4 25 ♖xd4 ♕g5 intending ... ♔g7 and ... ♖h8 gives Black a dangerous attack) 22 ... g4 23 hg hg 24 ♘h2 ♕g5! with good compensation for the exchange in Suba–Schmidt, Prague 1985.

c) **15 cd** cd 16 ♘b5 ♘e5 (16 ... ♗d7!? intending 17 a5 ♗xb5 18 ♗xb5 a6 19 ♗e2 ♕d7 is a suggestion of Henley; this appears good for equality) 17 ♘fd4 (17 ♘xe5 ♗xe5 18 ♖c4 ♗d7 is equal) 17 ... ♕f6 18 ♗h5 ♗d7 19 ♕b3 (Gufeld suggests 19 ♖c7!?) 19 ... a6 20 ♘c7 ♖ab8 21 ♖fd1 (21 ♘de6 ♖fc8 22 ♘xg7 ♔xg7 is equal according to Gufeld) 21 ... ♔h8 22 b5 g4! 23 hg ♘xg4 and Black is at least equal, Henley–Gufeld, Tbilisi 1983.

Although these lines are relatively unexplored, Black should hold the balance by accurate play. The note to move 13 is a little worrying for Black, but 10 ... f5 and 10 ... h6 are interesting and playable alternatives.

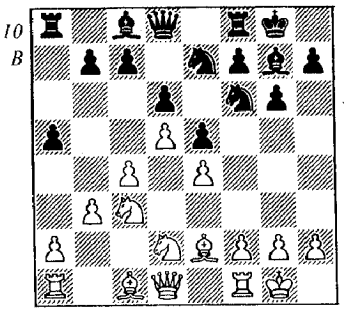
2 9 ♘d2 a5

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**c4**	**g6**
3	**♘c3**	**♗g7**
4	**e4**	**d6**
5	**♘f3**	**0-0**
6	**♗e2**	**e5**
7	**0-0**	**♘c6**
8	**d5**	**♘e7**
9	**♘d2**	**a5**

In the early days of this line 9 ♘e1 was often played, so as to continue with ♘d3 supporting c5. Later ♘d2 was preferred because after 9 ♘d2 ♘d7 10 b4 f5 11 f3 (11 c5 is also possible) 11 ... ♘f6 12 c5 the d2 knight goes to c4 and after ♗a3 and b5 Black's d6 pawn comes under heavy pressure. Today Black has two common methods of meeting 9 ♘d2, both of which aim to exploit the lack of support for b4 and c5 compared with the ♘e1–d3 line. In this section we look at 9 ... a5, holding up the queenside advance. This move is pointless against 9 ♘e1 since 9 ♘e1 a5 10 ♘d3 b6 11 b4 only accelerates White's queenside attack, but against ♘d2 it delays White for a couple of moves. In the next section we consider 9 ♘d2 c5, fighting for space on the queenside. If Black can hold up c5 then the knight on d2 is badly placed, obstructing White's bishop. Returning to 9 ... a5, White can play ♘b3 after a3, ♖b1 and b4, but here the knight is offside and even after White plays c5 he normally has to re-position the knight from b3 to generate any real threats.

10 a3 *(11)*

The two alternatives are 10 ♖b1 and 10 b3. The former normally transposes to the main line since next move White has nothing better than playing a3, so we do not consider it independently (the one semi-independent line 10 ♖b1 c5 11 f4?! is considered under line B below). 10 b3 is usually played to prepare ♗a3 and b4, a manoeuvre which Black can prevent by replying 10 ... c5. Then White reverts to preparing b4 by a3 and ♖b1, when he is effectively a tempo down over lines considered below. Although this is not the type of position in which an extra tempo is very important Black should equalize without problems. After 10 b3 *(10)* Black may play:



a) **10 ... ♘d7** (allowing White to execute his plan) 11 ♗a3 and now:

a1) **11 ... f5** 12 b4 ab 13 ♗xb4 with a branch:

a11) **13 ... ♗h6** 14 ♘b3 ♘f6 15 ♗f3 g5 16 ef ♗xf5 17 c5! g4 18 ♗e2 ♔h8 19 ♘a5 was clearly better for White in Gleizerov–V.Gurevich, USSR 1987, and even the superior plan of 14 ... b6 and 15 ... ♘c5 fails to equalize.

a12) **13 ... ♔h8** 14 a4 ♘g8 15 ♘b3! (15 a5?! ♘df6 is unclear) 15 ... b6 (15 ... ♘gf6 16 c5 and 15 ... ♘df6 16 ef gf 17 c5 are better for White) 16 a5 ♘c5 17 ♖a3! ♗d7 18 ♗xc5! bc 19 a6 ♘f6 20 a7 with a clear plus for White, Lputyan–Dorfman, Moscow 1986.

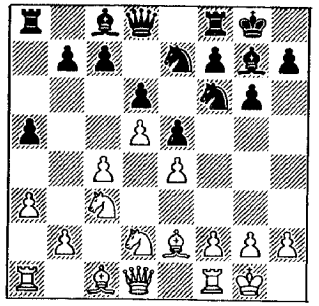
a13) **13 ... b6!** (the most solid) 14 a4 ♗h6?! (this is similar to a11 above, so the untested 14 ... ♘f6 is probably best, when White cannot play the natural 15 a5 because of 15 ... c5! 16 dc ♘xc6 17 ♗a3 ♘xa5 18 ♘b5 ♘b7 with advantage to Black) 15 a5 ♘c5 16 ♖a3! fe (16 ... ba? 17 ♗xc5 dc 18 ♘b3 and 16 ... ♗xd2?! 17 ♕xd2 ♘xe4 18 ♘xe4 fe 19 ab ♖xa3 20 bc ♕xc7 21 ♗xa3 are good for White) 17 ♘dxe4 ♘xe4 18 ♘xe4 ♗f5 (18 ... ba?! 19 ♗xa5 ♗f5 20 ♘c3! and 21 ♘b5 is awkward) 19 ♗d3 ♗xe4 20 ♗xe4 ba 21 ♗xa5 ♘f5, Nemet–F.Portisch, Virovitica 1977, and now 22 ♗xf5 gf (22 ... ♖xf5? 23 ♗xc7) 23 ♖g3+ ♗g7 24 ♗c3 would have given White an edge according to Kovačević, but in view of the reduced material Black faces no serious problems.

a2) **11 ...** ♘c5 12 b4 ab 13 ♗xb4 ♘a6 14 ♗a3 b6 15 ♘b3 f5 and now 16 ♗b2, Korchnoi–Geller, match 1971, should have been met by 16 ... ♔h8 17 a4 ♘c5 18 ♘xc5 bc 19 a5 ♘g8 followed by ... ♘f6 according to Gufeld, but 16 ♗c1! ♘c5 17 ♘xc5 bc 18 a4 ♔h8 19 ♗d2 ♘g8 20 a5 ♗h6 21 ef, with the same general type of position, was good for White in Mikhalchishin–Braga, Mexico 1977.

b) **10 ... c5** (this logical move prevents the ♗a3 and b4 plan, so White has to lose a tempo preparing b4) 11 a3 ♘e8 12 ♖b1 f5 13 b4 ab 14 ab b6 15 ♕b3 ♘f6 16 ♗d3 ♗h6?! (16 ... ♘h5! is fine for Black) 17 ♖b2 ♖a1 18 ♕c2 ♗f4 (18 ... ♗xd2?! 19 ♕xd2! f4 20 ♘a2 intending ♖b3 and ♕b2 is unpleasant) 19 ♘f3?! (19 bc bc 20 ♖b1 ♖xb1 21 ♘dxb1 is slightly better for White according to Karpov) 19 ... fe 20 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 21 ♗xe4 ♖xc1 22 ♖xc1 ♗xc1 23 ♕xc1 ♘f5 24 ♕g5

♘d4 25 ♕xd8 ♘xf3+ 26 ♗xf3 ♖xd8 27 bc bc 28 ♖b8 and even here White keeps an edge, Karpov-Kasparov, Seville (17) 1987.

Now there is a major division:



A 10 ... ♘d7
B 10 ... c5

Other moves:

a) **10 ... ♘e8** (if Black plays ... ♘f6 later this will probably transpose to line A below) 11 ♖b1 f5 12 b4 ab 13 ab ♗h6 14 ♘b3 (14 c5!? ♘f6 transposes to line A) 14 ... ♗xc1 15 ♖xc1 ♘f6 and again there is a transposition.

b) **10 ... ♗d7** (the idea is to 'threaten' to meet ♖b1 by ... a4, in the hope that White will waste time playing b3 first, but it isn't clear that ... a4 is a real threat) and now:

b1) **11 b3** (White gains no advantage by falling in with Black's plan) with a further branch:

b11) **11 ... ♘c8** 12 ♖b1 ♘b6 and now:

b111) **13 b4** ab 14 ab ♘a4 15 ♕c2 ♘xc3 16 ♕xc3 ♗h6 17 ♗b2 ♘h5!? (17 ... ♗xd2 18 ♕xd2 ♘xe4 19 ♕e3 f5 20 f4 gave White fair compensation for the pawn in Langeweg-Geller, Amsterdam 1974) 18 ♗xh5 gh 19 f4 f6 20 f5 ♖f7 21 ♖f3 ♖g7 22 ♘f1 ♖a2 23 ♖h3 ♗e8 24 ♘g3 h4 25 ♖xh4 ♗g5 26 ♖h3 ♕a8, Scheeren-Pieterse, Emmen 1989, and although Black won this game I am doubtful about his strategy.

b112) **13 ♕c2** ♘e8 14 b4 ab 15 ab ♘a4 16 ♘xa4 (16 ♘b5 c6 17 dc bc 18 ♘c3 ♘xc3 19 ♕xc3 f5 is unclear, while 16 ♘d1!? is suggested by Lerner) 16 ... ♗xa4 17 ♕c3 ♗d7 18 c5 f5 19 f3 (19 c6 bc 20 dc ♗e6 21 ♗c4 ♗xc4 22 ♕xc4+ ♔h8 is double-edged) and now 19 ... ♗h6?! 20 c6 was slightly better for White in Lerner-Pieterse, Amsterdam II 1988, but 19 ... ♘f6!? 20 ♗d3 ♘h5 would have been better.

b12) **11 ... c5!** (the simplest solution) 12 ♖b1 (12 dc bc 13 c5 d5 is fine for Black) 12 ... ♘e8 13 b4 ab (better than 13 ... b6 14 bc dc 15 ♘f3 ♘d6 16 ♗g5 ♖b8 17 ♘d2 f6 18 ♗h4 h5 19 ♗g3 ♗h6 20 h3, which was marginally better for White in M.Gurevich-Ivanchuk, Reggio Emilia 1988) 14 ab b6 (we have reached a position from line B of this chapter, but with Black having the extra tempo ... ♗d7; although this is not quite as good as in the line 10 b3 c5 above, where the extra tempo was completely free, the move ... ♗d7 is an asset and Black should equalize without trouble) 15 bc bc 16 ♘b3 f5 17 f3 (in particular the move ♗g5, dangerous in the later line B, is pointless here because there is no ♘xc5 trick after the reply ... ♘f6) 17 ... ♘f6 18 ♗d2 (18 ♗e3 ♘c8 19 ♔h1 ♘b6 20 ♘xc5 dc 21 ♗xc5 ♘a4 22 ♘xa4 ♗xa4 23 ♕d3 ♖f7 was unconvincing for White in Ambartsumian-Rivello, Prague Open 1989) 18 ... f4 19 ♘b5 ♘c8 20 ♖a1 ♖xa1 21 ♕xa1 g5 22 ♕a6 ♕e7 23 ♘a5 g4 (with an unclear position) 24 ♘c6 ♕f7 25 ♘b8 g3 26 ♘xd7 gh+ 27 ♔h1 ♕xd7 28 ♕c6 ♕d8 29 ♖a1 ♘h5 30 ♗e1 ♘g3+ 31 ♗xg3 fg and not surprisingly White's back rank cost him the game, Vaganian-Gelfand, USSR Ch 1989.

b2) **11 ♖b1** (probably the best move) 11 ... a4 (otherwise ... ♗d7 has no point) 12 b4 (12 ♖a1 c5! 13 b4 ab 13 ♘xb3 ♘e8 shows up White's rook moves as a waste of time) 12 ... ab 13 ♘xb3 b6 14 ♖a1 (an unfortunate loss of time, but otherwise White cannot play a4-a5; however this doesn't help Black much) 14 ... ♘e8 (14 ... ♗a4 15 ♗e3 ♘d7 16 ♘xa4 ♖xa4 17 ♘c5 ♘xc5 18 ♗xc5 ♖a7 19 ♗b4 is slightly better for White) 15 a4 f5 16 f3 ♔h8 (this plan is too slow, but White has the advantage in any case) 17 ♗e3 ♘g8 18 a5 ba 19 ♘xa5 ♗h6 20 ♗xh6 ♘xh6 21 ♕d2 ♘f7 22 c5 dc 23 ♘b7 ♕b8 24 ♘xc5 with a clear plus for White, Lputyan-Kupreichik, USSR Ch 1987.

b3) **11 ♖a2** (the idea is again to prepare b4, but with the added point that 11 ... a4 12 b4 ab 13 ♘xb3 saves White a tempo compared to line b2, since the rook already supports a4; unfortunately the reply 11 ... c5 is good) and now:

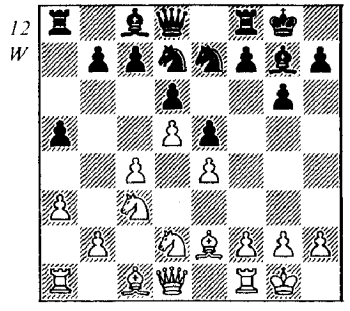
b31) **11 ... ♘e8** 12 b4 f5 13 c5 ab 14 ab ♖xa2 15 ♘xa2 ♘f6 16 ♘c3 ♔h8 (16 ... ♘c8 17 f3 ♗h6 18 ♘c4 ♗xc1 19 ♕xc1 f4 20 ♕a3 g5 21 ♕a8 g4 22 ♕xb7 ♔h8 23 ♘b5 was also good for White in Beaumont-Hennigan, British Ch 1988) 17 f3 f4 18 ♘c4 ♘c8 19 ♘a5 b6 20 ♘c6 ♗xc6 21 dc with a slight advantage for White in Salov-Khalifman, USSR Ch 1988.

b32) **11 ... c5** (once again this reply exposes the artificiality of White's play) 12 dc (12 b4 ab 13 ab cb 14 ♖xa8 ♕xa8 15 ♘b5 ♗xb5 16 cb ♗h6 is fine for Black) 12 ... bc 13 b4 ab 14 ab ♖xa2 15 ♘xa2 ♕a8 16 ♘c3 d5 17 cd (or 17 ed cd 18 ♘f3 e4 19 ♘e5 ♗f5 20 ♘b5 dc 21 ♘xc4 ♖d8 22 ♕b3 ♕b8 23 ♘e3 ♗e6 24 ♕b1 ♘ed5 22 ♘xd5 ♖xd5 and Black has the initiative, Kolev-Neverov, Odessa 1989) 17 ... cd 18 ed ♘fxd5 19 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 20 ♘e4 ♗a4 21 ♕e1 ♖b8 22 ♗d2 ♘xb4 23 ♘c5 ♘c2 24 ♕d1 ♘e3 0-1 Flear-M.Gurevich, Tel Aviv 1989.

A

10 ... ♘d7 *(12)*
11 ♖b1

The alternatives are:



a) **11 ♖a2** (the idea is similar to line b3 above) 11 ... f5 12 b4 ♘f6 13 f3 and now:

a1) **13 ... f4** (the rook is less effective at generating queenside pressure on a2, so perhaps Black can challenge White to a race) 14 c5 g5 15 ♘c4 (15 cd cd 16 ba aiming to occupy b6 may be better) 15 ... ab 16 ab ♖xa2 17 ♘xa2 and now 17 ... g4!? 18 cd cd 19 fg ♘xe4 or 17 ... h5 18 ♗a3 g4 19 cd cd 20 b5, with an unclear position in both cases.

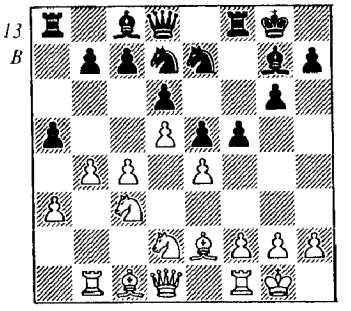
a2) **13 ... c6** (it sometimes happens in this line that Black may make a move on the queenside himself to interfere with White's attack there; normally this only makes sense when White has played f3, opening the b6-g1 diagonal) 14 ba (Nikolić suggests 14 ♔h1) 14 ... fe (the immediate 14 ... ♕xa5 is bad because of 15 ♘b3! and if 15 ... ♕xc3 16 ♗d2 traps the queen) 15 ♘dxe4 (15 fe ♕xa5 16 ♘b3 ♕xc3 17 ♗d2 is completely different because 17 ... ♘xe4! 18 ♗xc3 ♘xc3 gives Black good compensation for the queen) 15 ... ♘f5 16 a6 ♖xa6 (this appears dangerous, but Black can defend) 17 c5 ♖a5 18 ♗c4 (18 dc bc 19 cd ♗e6 20 ♖b2 ♘d5 is also satisfactory for Black) 18 ... b5! (the point is that 19 ♗b3 may be met by 19 ... dc 20 dc+ c4) 19 cb ♕xb6+ 20 ♔h1 ♗a6 21 ♗xa6 ♕xa6 22 dc (22 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 23 dc ♕xc6 24 ♘e4 ♗g7 25 ♗d2 is better, with equality) 22 ... ♘xe4 23 ♘xe4 d5 24 ♘g3 ½–½ P.Nikolić–Nunn, Reykjavik 1988, although Black is slightly better in the final position.

b) **11 ♘a4** (a risky attempt to prepare b4 and c5 without spending time playing ♖b1, but it puts the knight offside and weakens e4) 11 ... f5 12 b4 ♘f6 13 ef (an admission that something has gone seriously wrong, but 13 f3 c6 is also good for Black) 13 ... gf 14 ba f4 15 ♘b3 ♘f5 16 ♘c3 ♘h4 17 f3 ♔h8 18 ♖a2 ♖g8 19 ♗d3 ♗f8 20 ♔h1 ♘h5 21 ♘e4 ♘f5 22 ♘f2 ♕h4 23 ♖e1 ♗e7 24 ♔g1 ♗d7 25 a4 ♖g7 26 ♘g4 ♖ag8 27 ♗xf5 ♗xf5 28 ♘h6 ♖f8 29 ♘d2 ♗d7 30 ♘g4 ♖fg8 31 h3 ♘g3 32 ♘e4 h5 33 ♘h2 ♗xh3 34 ♘xg3 ♖xg3 35 ♖ee2 ♗f5 36 ♗a3 ♖h3 37 g4 fg 0–1, Guseinov–Smirin, Klaipeda 1988.

11 ... f5

11 ... ♘b6 12 b4 ab 13 ab ♗d7 14 ♕c2 ♘a4 loses a lot of time and after 15 ♘xa4 ♗xa4 16 ♕d3 ♗d7 17 c5 f5 18 f3 f4 18 ♗a3 White's queenside play is more dangerous than Black's efforts on the other wing, Pigott–W.Watson, British Ch 1988.

12 b4 *(13)*



At this point there is a major division:

A1 12 ... ♔h8
A2 12 ... b6

12 ... b6 has been played most frequently, but recent games have concentrated on 12 ... ♔h8. The only real alternative to these two moves is **12 ... ab** 13 ab and now:

a) **13 ... ♗h6** with a further branch:

a1) **14 ♘b3** ♗xc1 15 ♖xc1 ♘f6 16 f3 ♔h8 17 ♖a1 ♖xa1 18 ♕xa1 fe (18 ... f4? 19 ♕a5! g5 20 ♘b5 b6 21 ♕a7 is very good for White) 19 fe ♘eg8, Vukić–Ciocaltea, Belgrade 1977, and now 20 h3! leaves Black passively placed.

a2) **14 ef** (after the immediate 14 c5 Black can probably take the pawn on c5 because the e4 pawn is hanging at the end) 14 ... gf 15 c5 dc 16 bc ♘xc5 17 ♘c4 ♗xc1 18 ♕xc1 ♘g6 19 ♖d1 ♘e4 20 ♘xe4 fe 21 ♕e3 ♘f4 22 ♗f1 ♕g5 23 ♕g3 ♕xg3 24 hg ♘g6 25 d6 ♗g4 26 ♖e1 cd 27 ♘xd6 ♗e6 28 ♖xb7 with a better ending for White which he did eventually win, Lputyan–Zapata, GMA Belgrade Open 1988.

a3) **14 f3** ♗e3+ (14 ... ♘f6 15 c5 transposes to b) 15 ♔h1 f4 16 c5! dc 17 ♘c4 ♗d4 18 ♘b5 with a very dangerous attack for the pawn.

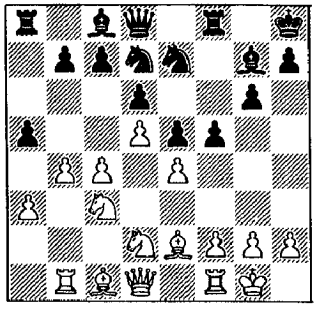
b) **13 ... ♘f6** 14 c5 (more active than 14 f3 g5 15 ♕c2 f4 16 c5 ♘g6 17 ♘b5 ♖f7 18 ♗b2 g4 19 ♖a1 ♖b8 20 fg ♘xg4 21 ♗xg4 ♗xg4 22 ♖f2 ♗f8 23 ♘a7 ♗e7, with advantage to Black in L.B.Hansen–Timoshchenko, Budapest 1989) 14 ... ♗h6 (not 14 ... dc? 15 bc fe 16 ♗c4 and 17 ♘dxe4 with a clear plus for White) 15 f3 (not 15 ♗f3?! since on f3 the bishop is a target for Black's advancing kingside pawns and after 15 ... ♖f7 16 ♕b3 g5! 17 ef g4 18 ♗e4 ♘xf5 19 ♕c4 ♕f8 20 ♗xf5 ♗xf5 Black took over the initiative in Antunac–Sznapik, Zagreb 1979; however 15 ♕b3 ♔g7 16 ♗d3 was promising for White in Vaganian–Doroshkevich, USSR Ch 1975, while Kovačević recommends 15 ♗d3) 15 ... ♘h5 (15 ... ♗e3+ 16 ♔h1 dc 17 ♘c4! ♗xc1 18 ♕xc1 cb 19 ♖xb4 ♘d7 20 ♖d1 gives White excellent play for the pawn) 16 ♘c4 ♗xc1 17 ♖xc1 ♘f4 18 g3 ♘xe2+ 19 ♕xe2 fe 20 fe ♗h3 21 ♖xf8+ (White heads straight for a very good ending in which c7 is

weak and Black's minor pieces are useless) 21 ... ♕xf8 22 ♕f2 ♕xf2+ 23 ♔xf2 ♘c8 24 ♘b5 ♖a2+ 25 ♔e3 dc 26 bc c6 27 ♘c3 1-0 Dorfman-Balashov, USSR Ch 1987.

A1

12 ... ♔h8 *(14)*

This is based on the assumption that White has no really constructive moves, for example the knight on d2 is best placed on c4, so White will be reluctant to commit it to b3; moreover it is occasionally helpful to have missed out ... b6, which can create a weakness at c6. At first this line gave Black good results, but recently White has fought back with the idea of playing c5 as a pawn sacrifice, justifiable on the grounds that the knight really does belong on c4, and it is worth a pawn to get it there. The gambit is dangerous but not completely clear, and Black has the option of avoiding it by Kasparov's 13 ... ♘g8. At the moment this position is one of the main battlegrounds in the King's Indian.


14 W

There are now two possible lines for White:

A11 13 ♕c2
A12 13 f3

The feeble 13 ♘b3 justifies Black's last move and after 13 ... ab 14 ab ♘f6 15 f3 (or 15 ef ♗xf5 16 ♗d3 ♕d7 17 f3 ♘h5 and now White should play 18 ♘e4 with equality rather than 18 ♗e4?! ♘g8 19 ♗e3 ♗h6! 20 ♕d2 ♗xe3+ 21 ♕xe3 ♘gf6 with advantage for Black, Kulikov-Belov, USSR 1988) 15 ... f4 16 c5 g5 we transpose to the note to White's 14th in A12 below, which is fine for Black.

A11

13 ♕c2

A flexible semi-waiting move which is useful both for supporting e4 and for control of the c-file after a later c5. The main minus point is that a possible ... fe and ... ♘f5-d4 will gain time for Black.

13 ... b6

Black reverts to his ... b6 plan now that White is committed to ♕c2. The alternatives are:

a) **13 ... ♘f6** (probably best) 14 f3 ab 15 ab f4 16 c5 g5 (the idea is to secure c7 by ... ♘g6 and ... ♖f7, then start the attack by ... g4, so White strikes first) 17 ♘b5 dc! (a surprising defence; the passive 17 ... ♘e8 18 ♘c4 ♘g8 19 ♗b2 ♘gf6 20 ♖a1 was disastrous for Black in Orlov-Kurz, Budapest 1989) 18 bc (18 ♕xc5 c6 is fine for Black after 19 dc ♘xc6 or 19 d6 ♘ed5!) 18 ... c6 19 d6 (or 19 dc ♘xc6 when the outpost at d4 is as useful as White's occupation of d6) 19 ... cb 20 de ♕xe7 21 ♖xb5 g4 22 ♗b2 gf 23 ♗xf3 ♘g4 24 ♗xg4 ♗xg4 25 ♘f3 ♖fc8 ½-½ Ftačnik-Nunn, Groningen 1988.

b) **13 ... ♘g8** (as we shall see, this is a reasonable answer to 13 f3, but here it makes less sense) 14 ♗b2 ♘gf6 (when White has played f3 this knight can go to h5 and f4, but here Black has no clear way to improve his position) 15 ♖be1 (or 15 ♖bd1 ♘e8! 16 ef gf 17 ♔h1 ♕h4 18 g3 ♕h3 19 ♘f3 ♕h6 20 ♗c1 f4 21 g4! with a clear plus for White, Pinter-Sznapik, Haifa 1989) 15 ... f4 (playing this when White has not played f3 looks wrong, but what other move is available?) 16 c5!? (here too the pawn offer is dangerous) 16 ... dc 17 bc ♘xc5 18 ♘b5 ♘fd7 19 ♘f3 b6 20 a4 ♗a6 21 ♗a3 ♗f6 22 ♖d1 g5 23 h3 ♖g8 24 ♘h2 ♗g7 25 ♗c4 ♗f8 26 d6 ♗xb5 27 dc ♕xc7 28 ♗xb5 ♘f6 29 ♗b2 g4 30 hg ♗d6, Salov-Short, Skelleftea 1989, and now 31 ♖xd6! ♕xd6 32 ♖d1 gives White a nearly decisive advantage.

14 f3

After 14 ♘b3 ab 15 ab fe 16 ♘xe4 ♘f6 17 ♗d3 ♘xe4 18 ♗xe4 ♘f5 19 ♕d3 ♕h4 20 g3 ♕f6 21 f3 ♗d7 22 ♗d2 ♘d4 White had just an edge in Gavrikov-Kasparov, USSR Ch 1988, but 15 ... ♘f6 appears more logical to me.

14 ... f4

15 ♘b3

Or 15 ♘b5 g5 (Black should interpolate 15 ... ab, because in the continuation Black's position is much improved by the removal of the a-pawns) 16 c5!? (this should be a familiar idea by now!) 16 ... bc 17 bc ♘xc5 18 ♘b3 c6 19 dc ♘xc6 20 ♘xc5 dc 21 ♕xc5 ♗d7 22 ♗b2 with advantage to White, Sakaev-Tkachev, Pinsk 1989.

15 ... ab
16 ab g5

If Black inverts his moves and plays 16 ... ♘f6 White cannot adopt the line of the next note, but as the main line appears good for White this may not help Black.

17 c5

White may also try 17 g4!? (if Black had played 16 ... ♘f6 instead then this would be much more dubious) 17 ... fg 18 hg ♘g6 19 ♘d1 ♖g8 20 ♖f2 ♘df8 21 ♖h2 ♕f6 22 ♘f2 ♘e7 23 ♘g4 ♕g6 24 ♘e3 ♕f6 25 ♕d2 ♕g6 26 g4 ♕e8 27 ♘f5 with some advantage for White, Lerner-H. Grunberg, Moscow GMA Open 1989.

17 ... ♘f6

18 ♘b5 g4 19 cd cd 20 ♕c7 gf 21 gf ♕e8 22 ♘xd6 (22 ♔h1?! ♘h5! 23 ♖b2 ♗h3 24 ♖e1 ♕g6 25 ♗f1 ♘g3+! gave Black an enormous attack in Gavrikov-Smirin, Klaipeda 1988) 22 ... ♕g6+ 23 ♔h1 ♘exd5 24 ed ♕xb1 25 ♖g1 ♘h5 26 ♘d2! (a crushing improvement on published analysis of the Gavrikov-Smirin game, which only

gave a draw by 26 ♘f7+ ♔g8 27 ♘h6+) 26 ... ♕xb4 27 ♕e7 ♔g8 28 ♘xc8 ♕d4 29 ♘d6 ♖f6 30 ♘2e4 1-0 Shevelev-Bezman, Leningrad 1989.

A12

13 f3

Probably the most dangerous move. White secures his centre and waits to see Black's intentions. If the reply is ... f4, releasing the central tension, then White can offer his c-pawn.

13 ... f4

Or:

a) **13 ... ♗h6** (a doubtful alternative) 14 ♘b3 ♗xc1 15 ♖xc1 ab 16 ab ♘f6 and now the game Lukov-Sznapik, Tbilisi 1988, continued 17 c5 g5 18 ♘d2? (too slow; after 18 ♕c2! intending ♘b5 Black faces the likelihood of an invasion at c7) 18 ... f4 19 ♘b5 g4! (in such a sharp line one error can turn the game around) 20 fg ♖g8 21 ♗f3 (21 h3 h5! 22 cd cd 23 ♘c7 ♖a2! 24 ♘e6 ♕b6+ 25 ♔h1 ♕e3 is also dangerous) 21 ... ♗xg4 22 ♔h1 ♗xf3 23 gf ♘h5! 24 ♖g1 ♘g3+! (with a winning attack) 25 hg fg 26 ♖g2 ♘g6 27 ♘f1 ♕h4+ 28 ♖h2 gh 29 ♖c2 ♘f4 30 ♘xh2 ♘h3 0-1. However the simple 17 ♖a1! transposes to line a1 in the note to Black's 12th move, which was good for White.

b) **13 ... ♘g8** (Kasparov's move is logical; the intention is ... ♘df6 and ... ♘h5, when White must allow ... ♘f4 or weaken his kingside further by g3) and now:

b1) **14 ♕c2** ♘gf6 (Black reacts very passively in this example; 14 ... ♘df6 is better) 15 ♘b5 b6 16 ef gf 17 f4 ab 18 ab ef 19 ♘f3 ♘e5 20 ♗xf4 ♘e4 21 ♘d2 ♗d7 22 ♖b3 with advantage to White, Lerner-Smirin, USSR Ch 1989.

b2) **14 ♘b3** (this does not seem a critical test of Black's idea) 14 ... ab 15 ab ♘df6 (or 15 ... b6 16 c5 bc 17 bc ♘df6 18 ♕c2 ♘h5 19 g3 ♘hf6 20 ♗d2 fe 21 fe ♗h3 22 ♖f3 ♘g4 with good counterplay for Black, Schüssler-Mortensen, Espoo 1989) 16 ♗d2 ♘h5 17 g3 ♘hf6 18 ♖f2 ♘h6 19 ♖a1 ♖xa1 20 ♕xa1 ♘f7 21 ♕c1 f4 22 g4 h5 23 h3 ♘h7 (afterwards Kasparov suggested 23 ... ♘g5 24 ♕f1 c6!? as even better) 24 ♗e1 ♗f6 25 ♔g2 ♔g7 and Black has a dangerous initiative, Karpov-Kasparov, Skelleftea 1989.

14 ♘a4

With this move White prepares c5 without committing his other knight to the bad square b3. However there are at least three alternatives, including the pawn sacrifice 14 c5!?, and it is far from clear which is the best. Here is the analysis:

a) **14 ♘b3** (the only clear point is that this move is a mistake; White's knight remains inactive on b3) 14 ... ab 15 ab g5 16 c5 ♘f6! (16 ... ♘g6 17 c6 ♘f6 18 cb ♗xb7 19 ♘a5 ♗c8 20 ♘c6 ♕d7 and 16 ... ♖g8 17 c6 bc 18 dc ♘xc6 19 ♗c4 ♖f8 20 ♗d5 ♗b7 21 b5 ♘a5 22 ♘xa5 ♗xd5 23 ♘xd5 ♖xa5 24 ♕c2 are unclear) 17 ♘b5 (after 17 ♗d2 ♘g6 18 c6 b6 19 ♗e1 ♖g8 20 ♘d2 h5 21 ♘b5 g4 Black's attack rolled forward in Dreev-Sirov, USSR 1988, while 17 g4 h5 18 h3 ♘g6 19 ♗d2 ♘h4 led to a double-edged position, Gofman-Belov, USSR 1988) 17 ... g4!? 18 ♕c2?! (18 fg ♘xe4 19 ♗d3 ♘g5 is unclear) 18 ... gf 19 gf (19 ♖xf3? ♘xe4 and 19 ♗xf3 ♗d7 are also good for Black) 19 ... ♗h3 20 ♖f2 ♖g8 21 ♔h1 ♘h5 22 cd cd 23 ♕c7 ♕xc7 24 ♘xc7 ♖a2 25 ♗b2 ♖c8 and Black won material in Pigott-Nunn, London 1989.

b) **14 ♘b5** (a logical move; White cuts out the defensive ... c6 and prepares c5) 14 ... b6 15 c5 bc 16 bc ♘xc5 17 a4 g5 18 ♗a3 ♘a6 19 ♕c2 ♖f7 20 ♖fc1 ♘g6 21 ♕c6 ♗d7 22 ♕b7 with very strong pressure for the pawn, Vladimirov-Temirbaev, Alma Ata 1989.

c) **14 c5** (the direct course is also dangerous for Black) 14 ... ab (this must be better than the immediate capture on c5, which led to a spectacular win for White after 14 ... dc 15 bc ♘xc5 16 a4 ♖f7 17 ♘c4 ♘g8 18 ♗a3 ♘d7 19 ♘b5 b6 20 d6 c6 21 ♘c7 ♖b8 22 ♕b3 ♖f6 23 ♖fd1 ♘h6 24 ♘xa5! ba 25 ♕xb8 ♘xb8 26 ♖xb8 ♖f8 27 d7 ♕xc7 28 ♗xf8 ♕a7+ 29 ♗c5! 1-0 Lobron-Fleck, Bundesliga 1989) 15 ab dc (15 ... g5 16 ♘c4 ♘f6 17 ♗a3 b6 18 cd cd 19 b5 ♘e8 20 ♘a4 ♖b8 21 ♕e1 ♘g8 22 ♕f2 gave White strong pressure in Chantsev-Bragin, USSR 1989) 16 bc ♘xc5 17 ♘c4 b6 18 ♗a3 (once again the position is ominous for Black, but he may be able to hang on) 18 ... ♗a6 19 ♗xc5 bc 20 ♕c2 c6 21 ♘b6 ♗xe2 22 ♘xe2 ♖b8 23 d6, van der Sterren-Gelfand, OHRA B Amsterdam 1989, and now 23 ... ♕xd6 24 ♖bd1 ♘d5 25 ♘xd5 (25 ♘c4 ♘b4) 25 ... cd 26 ♖xd5 would have led to a draw.

14 ... ab

15 ab c6!

Crossing White's plan. After 15 ... g5?! 16 c5 b6 17 cd cd 18 b5!, O. Kalinin-Zlochevsky, USSR 1988, Black's queenside is full of holes and ♘c4 followed by ♗a3 will cause serious problems.

16 c5

Black theatened 16 ... b5 and after 16 ♘c3 ♘f6 the pressure on d5 rules out c5 by White, so Black can continue his attack with ... g5 and so on. In Polugayevsky-Hellers, Biel 1989, White continued 16 ♗b2 ♘f6 17 dc ♘xc6 18 c5 dc 19 ♘xc5 ♘d4 20 ♘c4 ♘h5 21 ♖f2 with a slight advantage, but 16 ... b5 must be the critical test.

16 ... cd

The safe alternative, but the piece sacrifice 16 ... dc!? 17 d6 cb 18 de ♕xe7 (threat ... b5) 19 ♘b2 b5 was also playable.

17 cd ♘c6

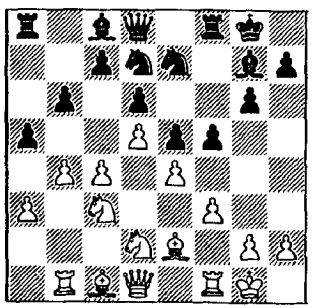
18 ed ♘d4, Salov-Nunn, Rotterdam 1989, and now 19 ♘c5 ♘xc5

20 bc ♕a5 21 ♘e4 ♗f5 22 ♗d2 ♕a3 would have been equal. Instead 19 ♘c3?! ♘b6 20 ♘de4 ♗f5 21 ♗d3 ♖c8 was slightly better for Black.

A2

12 ... b6
13 f3 *(15)*

Once again White would prefer not to play ♘b3 unless he has no other constructive move. After 13 ♘b3 ab 14 ab fe! (closing the centre by 14 ... ♘f6 15 f3 f4 is less attractive now than after 12 ... ♔h8, because ... b6 wastes a tempo and weakens Black's queenside) 15 ♘xe4 ♘f6 16 ♗d3 ♗d7 17 ♗b2 (17 f3 ♘f5! is unclear) 17 ... ♘xe4 (17 ... b5!? 18 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 19 cb ♕e8 20 ♕e2 ♖b8 is a promising idea) 18 ♗xe4 ♔h8! (intending ... ♘g8–f6) 19 ♖a1 ♘g8 20 ♕d3 ♖xa1 21 ♖xa1 ♘f6 22 ♘d2 ♗h6 23 ♘f1 with just an edge for White, Vilela–A. Rodriguez, Havana 1978.



After 13 f3 Black has tried:

a) **13 ... ♗h6** (this manoeuvre is usually dubious; it wastes time and improves the position of White's rook) 14 ♘b3 ♗xc1 15 ♖xc1 f4 (or 15 ... ab 16 ab ♘f6 17 c5 ♔g7 18 ♖a1 with a plus for White in Blees–Berg, Dieren Open 1987) 16 c5 ♘f6 17 cd cd 18 ba ba 19 a4 (the immediate 19 ♘b5 heading for c7 and e6 appears better) 19 ... g5 20 ♘b5 g4 21 ♕e1 g3 22 hg ♘h5 23 gf ♘xf4 24 g3 with a complex position which eventually turned out better for White, Hölzl–García Martínez, Dubai Ol 1986.

b) **13 ... f4** (the comments above about playing ... b6 and then closing the centre apply here too; Kasparov demonstrates that the move ... b6 is no asset) 14 ♘a4 (14 ♘b3 plays into Black's hands because the knight has gone to the inferior square b3 without Black even having to spend a tempo on ... ♔h8; after 14 ... ab 15 ab g5 16 c5 ♘f6 17 ♗d2 h5 18 h3 ♖f7 19 cb cb 20 ♖c1 ♗f8 21 ♘b5 g4 22 ♘c7 ♖a2 23 ♘e6 ♗xe6 24 de ♖g7 Black had dangerous kingside threats in Lev–Dam, Lugano 1989; however 14 ♕c2 g5 15 ♘b5 ♖f7 16 c5!? bc 17 bc ♘xc5 18 ♘b3 ♘xb3 19 ♖xb3 ♘g6 20 ♖c3 was promising for White in Dautov–Bokan, Sverdlovsk 1989) 14 ... ab 15 ab g5 16 c5 ♘f6 17 cd cd 18 b5 ♗d7 19 ♘c4 ♘c8 20 ♗a3 ♘e8 21 g4 (White has a clear advantage) 21 ... fg 22 hg g4 23 ♗c1 gf 24 ♗xf3 ♘f6 25 ♗g5 ♖a7 26 ♖f2 ♖b7 27 ♖b3 ♖a7 28 ♖b1 ♖b7 29 ♖b3 ♖a7 30 ♖b4 ♔h8?! (30 ... ♕e8 was a better chance) 31 ♕f1 ♗xb5 32 ♖xb5 ♖xa4 33 ♗g2 h6 34 ♗h4 ♕e8 35 ♗xf6 ♖xf6 36 ♖xf6 ♕xb5 37 ♖e6 ♔g8 38 ♗h3 ♖xc4 39 ♖xh6 ♗xh6 40 ♗e6+ ♔h8 41 ♕f6+ 1–0 Kasparov-Smirin, USSR Ch 1988.

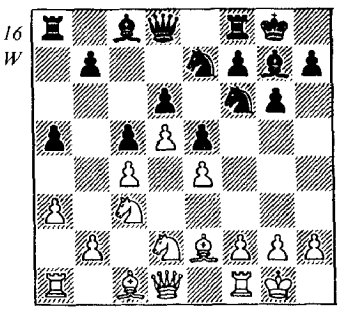
c) **13 ... ♔h8** (as with 12 ... ♔h8, this useful move waits for ♘b3 before switching to kingside play) 14 ♘b3 ab 15 ab ♘f6 16 c5 bc 17 bc ♘h5 18 g3 (I prefer 18 ♗b5 ♘f4 19 ♗e3) 18 ... ♘g8 19 ♗d2?! (Mortensen recommends 19 ♘d2 and 20 ♘c4) 19 ... ♘hf6 20 ♘c1 (20 g4 fg 21 fg ♘e8! and ... ♕h4 is fine for Black) 20 ... fe 21 fe ♗h3 22 ♖f2 h5 and Black was slightly better in J. Kristiansen–Mortensen, Esbjerg 1984.

The conclusion is that 12 ... ♔h8 is fully playable for Black. Perhaps 12 ... b6 13 f3 ♔h8 is also possible, but if Black intends to play ... ♔h8, it is more logical to do so at move 12.

B

10 ... c5 *(16)*
11 ♖b1

Not 11 dc bc 12 ♖b1 c5! 13 b4 ab 14 ab cb 15 ♖xb4 ♘c6 16 ♖a4 ♖xa4 17 ♕xa4 ♘d4 and Black was already slightly better in Litinskaya–Chiburdanidze, USSR 1982. This seems an appropriate moment to mention the idea 10 ♖b1 c5 11 f4!? ef 12 ♘f3, which



presumably could also be played with 10 a3 in place of 10 ♖b1. Hernandez–Rodriguez, Havana 1982, continued 12 ... ♘g4?! 13 ♗xf4 f5 14 ♕d2! fe 15 ♘xe4 ♘f5 16 ♗d3 ♘f6 17 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 18 ♘g5! with advantage to White, but 12 ... h6! 13 ♗xf4 g5 14 ♗xd6 (not 14 e5?! ♘g4! 15 ed ♘f5 and ... ♘e3) 14 ... ♕xd6 15 e5 ♕d8 16 ef (16 ♘xg5 ♘d7!) 16 ... ♗xf6 17 ♗d3 is much better. A. Rodriguez assesses the final position as slightly better for White, but after 17 ... ♗g7 intending ... f5 or ... ♘f5 I cannot agree with his judgement. Black can defend his king with ... ♖a6 and become active with his two bishops and kingside majority.

11 ... ♘e8
12 b4 ab
13 ab b6
14 bc

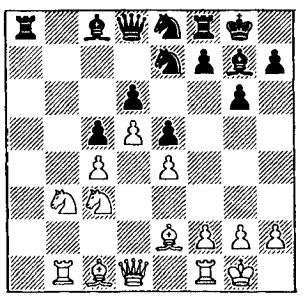
Attempts to delay this exchange have turned out badly:

a) **14 ♕b3** f5 15 bc bc 16 ♕b6 ♕d7!? 17 ♘f3 h6 18 ♗d2 ♘f6 19 ♗d3 ♖a6! 20 ♕b2 ♘h5 with a

slight plus for Black, Ftačnik–Sznapik, Prague 1985.

b) **14 ♖b3?!** f5 15 ♖a3 ♖xa3 16 ♗xa3 ♘f6 17 ♗d3 ♗h6 18 ♕e2? (a strange move inviting ... ♘h5–f4; 18 ♘b3 may be better but the off-side position of the bishop on a3 suggests that White's whole plan is wrong) 18 ... ♘h5! 19 g3?! (19 ♗c2 was the last chance) 19 ... f4! 20 ♕d1 ♕d7! 21 ♖e1 fg 22 fg ♘xg3 23 hg ♕h3 24 ♘f1 ♖xf1+ 25 ♗xf1 ♕xg3+ 26 ♗g2 ♗g4 27 ♖e2 ♕xc3 0–1 P. Nikolić-Ye Jiangchuan, Thessaloniki Ol 1988.

14 ... bc
15 ♘b3 *(17)*



There are now two lines for Black:

B1 15 ... ♔h8
B2 15 ... f5

The main reason for favouring the first move is that the immediate 15 ... f5 allows the slightly tricky reply 16 ♗g5, aiming for tactics based on ♘xc5. On the other hand the manoeuvre ... ♔h8 and ... ♘g8, although very solid, does cost time and allows White to take over the a-file. Both lines are playable, but my subjective preference is to get on with the job by 15 ... f5.

B1

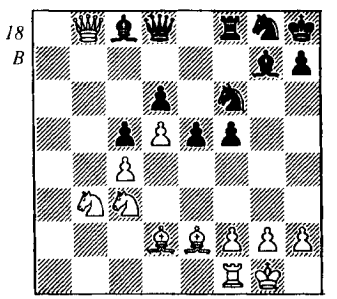
15 ... ♔h8
16 ♗d2 ♘g8

Or 16 ... f5 (now White has played ♗d2 Black need not fear the reply ♗g5, so this is logical) 17 f3 fe 18 fe ♖xf1+ 19 ♕xf1 ♘f6 20 ♖a1 ♗d7 21 ♗d3 ♘eg8 22 ♖xa8 ♕xa8 23 ♕c1 (perhaps 23 ♘b5 sets slightly more problems) 23 ... ♕f8 24 ♘b5 ♗h6! 25 h3 ♗xd2 26 ♕xd2 ♘h5 ½–½, Stempin–Pedzich, Linhamn 1987.

17 ♖a1 ♖xa1
18 ♕xa1 f5
19 ♕a8

Or 19 ♘a5 ♘ef6 20 ♘c6 ♕d7 21 f3 fe 22 fe ♗h6 23 ♗xh6 ♘xh6 24 ♕b2 ♘hg8 25 ♕b6 ♕g7 26 ♕b2 with equality in Lerner–Timoshchenko, Moscow GMA Open 1989.

19 ... ♘ef6
20 ef gf
21 ♕b8 *(18)*



Better than 21 f4 ♘e4 22 ♘xe4 fe 23 ♕b8 ♕d7 24 ♗e3 ♗b7 25 ♕a7 ♖a8 26 ♕b6 ♖a6 27 ♕b5 ♕xb5 28 cb ♖a8 29 ♗c4 ♘f6 with advantage to Black, Stohl–Vokac, Czechoslovak Ch 1986.

After 21 ♕b8 practical experience is contradictory. Games played so far are as follows:

a) **21 ... ♕e7** 22 ♕b6 ♘d7? 23 ♕c7 e4 24 ♘a5 ♘e5 25 ♕xe7 ♘xe7 26 ♖b1 with a promising ending for White, W. Schmidt–Czerwonski, Polish Ch 1988.

b) **21 ... ♕d7** 22 ♕b6 and now:

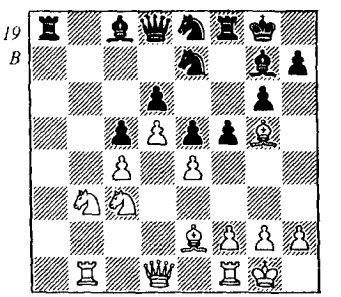
b1) **22 ... ♘e4** 23 ♘xe4 fe 24 ♗e3 ♘f6 (24 ... ♗h6? 25 ♗xh6 and 26 ♘xc5) 25 ♘d2 (White has a slight advantage because Black is tied down to the defence of d6 and e4) 25 ... ♖g8 26 ♖a1 ♗f8 (a good plan freeing Black's queen) 27 g3 ♕h3? (27 ...♕f5 is much better) 28 ♕d8! ♕f5 29 ♖a7 ♗d7 30 ♗g4! and White won in Pekarek–Vokac, Kecskemet 1988.

b2) **22 ... ♕e7** 23 ♘a5 (this move has little obvious point, since on c6 the knight strikes into thin air; 23 ♖a1!? must be better) 23 ... ♘e4 24 ♘xe4 fe 25 ♗e3 ♗h6! 26 ♘c6 ♕f6 27 ♘a7? (this is really asking for trouble; 27 ♕b3 was essential) 27 ... ♗g4! 28 ♕b2 ♗f3! with advantage to Black, Pekarek–W. Schmidt, Prague 1988.

This evidence is hard to interpret, as White was better in line a, but line b2, where Black had a tempo less, was good for him! All this proves is that the play in these examples leaves much to be desired. I suggest 21 ... ♕e7 22 ♕b6 f4!? as the best option, preparing a variety of attacking options on the king-side, or simple development by ... ♘h6–f5. In this case Black has enough counterplay to compensate for White's queenside initiative.

B2

15 ... f5
16 ♗g5 *(19)*



Or 16 f3 (16 ♗d2 fe 17 ♘xe4 ♘f6 was roughly level in Boudy–Rodriguez, Piñar del Rio 1981) 16 ... ♘f6 (16 ... ♔h8 as in line B1 is also possible) 17 ♗d2 ♘h5 18 ♖a1 ♖xa1 19 ♕xa1 ♘f4 20 ♕a5 ♕xa5 21 ♘xa5 fe 22 fe ♘xe2+ (22 ... ♗h6? 23 ♗xf4 ef 24 ♘b5 ♗g7 25 ♘xd6 ♗d7 26 ♔h1 ♖b8 27 ♘ab7 was very good for White in Farago–Sznapik, Warsaw 1987) 23 ♘xe2 ♖xf1+ 24 ♔xf1 ♗a6 25 ♘c3 ♘c8 26 ♘b5 ♘b6 27 ♘xd6 ♗f8 and Black should hold the ending.

16 ... ♗f6

Black's other moves are:

a) **16 ... ♘f6?** (this is the move White is hoping for) 17 ♘xc5 dc 18 d6 ♘c6 19 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 20 ♕d5+ ♔h8 21 ♕xc6 ♖a6 22 ♕xc5 ♕xd6 is distinctly better for White.

b) **16 ... h6** (also satisfactory for Black) 17 ♗d2 (17 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 18 ♖a1 ♖xa1 19 ♕xa1 ♘f6 20 ♗d3 f4 21 f3 g5 22 ♘b5 g4 was agreed drawn here in Beaumont–Howell, British Ch 1988; moreover 20 ... ♘h5!? is interesting) 17 ... ♘f6 18 f3 g5! (inducing ... h6 has made ... fe less promising, but it has opened up this new possibility) 19 ♖a1, Sirov–Antonsen, Timisoara 1988, and now 19 ... ♖xa1 20 ♕xa1 ♘g6 is unclear according to Sirov.

17 ♗d2

And now:

a) **17 ... ♖f7** 18 f3 f4? 19 ♖a1 ♖b8 20 ♘b5 ♗d7 21 ♖a6 gave White a clear plus in Eingorn–Marjanović, Bor 1985.

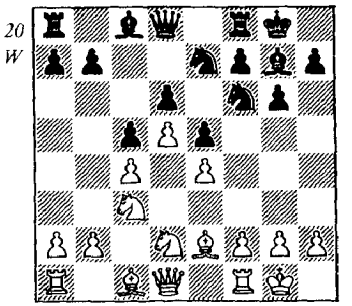
b) **17 ... fe** 18 ♘xe4 ♘f5 19 ♖a1 ♖xa1 20 ♕xa1 ♘d4 21 ♘xd4 ed 22 ♗d3 ½–½ Adamski–Novak, Polish Ch 1986.

c) **17 ... ♗d7** 18 ♖a1 ♖xa1 19 ♕xa1 ♘c8 (intending ... ♗g5) 20 ♕c1 ♗g7 ½–½ Chernin–van der Wiel, Amsterdam OHRA 1987.

It seems that 10 ... c5 is a solid line. With accurate play Black should hold the balance, but it offers very few winning chances.

3 9 ♘d2 c5

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**c4**	**g6**
3	**♘c3**	**♗g7**
4	**e4**	**d6**
5	**♘f3**	**0-0**
6	**♗e2**	**e5**
7	**0-0**	**♘c6**
8	**d5**	**♘e7**
9	**♘d2**	**c5** *(20)*



With this move Black aims to contest White's queenside ambitions directly by blocking the standard b4 and c5 breakthrough. There are two possible replies for White. The first, currently very popular, is to play ♖b1 and b4, but although White gains control of the open b-file he is attacking on a narrow front and it takes several more moves before White can generate real queenside threats. The second plan is to play 10 dc and 11 b4. Although this strengthens Black's centre White hopes to gain control of d5 by playing b5. Recently White players have more or less given up this plan,since the main line presents Black with few problems.

A 10 ♖b1
B 10 dc

In the early days of this line White would often play 10 a3, but since the move ♖b1 will be necessary sooner or later this usually loses a tempo, e.g. 10 ... ♘e8 11 b4 b6 12 bc (or 12 ♘b3 f5 13 ♗d2 ♘f6 14 f3, Gligorić–Taimanov, Belgrade 1969, and now 14 ... ♔h8 intending ... ♘eg8 is fine for Black) 12 ... bc 13 ♘b3 f5 14 f3 ♔h8 15 ♗d2 ♘g8 16 ♖b1 ♘gf6 17 ♕c2 (17 ♘c1 ♘h5 18 ♘d3 f4 19 ♗e1 ♗f6 is equal, Najdorf–Gligorić, Siegen Ol 1970) 17 ... ♘h5 18 g3 ♘ef6 19 ef gf with a level position, Korchnoi–Tringov, Kapfenburg 1970. Black has no problems after 10 a3.

A

10 ♖b1 ♘e8

10 ... a5 transposes to Chapter 2, but 10 ... ♘d7!? is dubious, e.g. 11 ♘b5! ♕b6 (11 ... ♘f6 may well be best, but this is no recommendation for Black's play) 12 b4! cb 13 a3 ba (after 13 ... a6 14 ♘c3 bc 15 ♖xb6 cd both 16 ♖xd6 and 16 ♕xd2 ♘xb6 17 ♕b4 ♘d7 18 ♕xd6 ♖e8 19 ♗g5 ♗f8 20 ♕c7 f6 21 ♗g4 are good for White) 14 c5! ♘xc5 (14 ... dc 15 d6 ♘c6 16 ♘c7 ♕xb1 17 ♘xb1 a2 18 ♗b2 ab♕ 19 ♕xb1 ♖b8 20 ♘d5 is no better) 15 ♗xa3 ♕d8 16 ♘xd6 b6 (or 16 ... ♕xd6 17 ♘c4 ♕d8 18 ♗xc5 b6 19 ♗a3 ♗a6 20 ♕a4 with a clear advantage for White) 17 ♘2c4 and Black has a miserable position. Lputyan-Khalifman, USSR Ch 1987.

11 b4 b6

12 bc

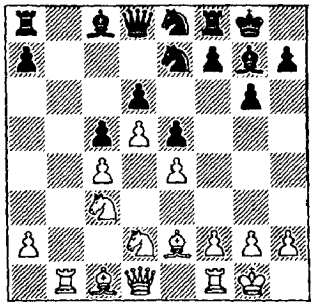
The alternative is 12 a4 f5 13 a5 and now:

a) **13 ... ♘f6** 14 ♕a4 ♗d7 15 ♕a3 ♗h6 16 bc! (16 ♗d3 ♕c7 17 bc bc 18 ef gf was equal in Larsen-Fischer, Denver (match) 1971) 16 ... bc 17 a6!? ♖b8 18 ♖xb8 ♕xb8 19 ♘f3 ♗xc1 20 ♖xc1 ♕b4? (20 ... ♕c7 21 ♖b1 ♖b8 22 ♖xb8+ ♕xb8 23 ♕a5 is only very slightly better for White) 21 ♕a1 ♘xe4 22 ♘xe4 fe 23 ♖b1 ♕a4 24 ♕xa4 ♗xa4 25 ♘g5 ♗c2 26 ♖b7 with a good ending for White, J. Kristiansen-Hellers, Esbjerg 1978.

b) **13 ... ♔h8** 14 ♕a4 ♗d7 15 ♕a3 ♘g8 16 ♗d1 (this somewhat artificial plan should be replaced by bc and a6 as in line a) 16 ... ♘ef6 17 ♗a4 ♗h6 18 bc bc 19 ♗xd7 ♕xd7 20 ef gf was roughly equal in Ree-Gligorić, Wijk aan Zee 1975.

12 ... bc *(21)*

This is the natural move, but 12 ... dc has been played a few times. Although Black's practical results were not bad I am suspicious of the idea. After 13 ♗b2 (13 a4 a5 14 ♕b3 ♖a6 15 f4 ef 16 ♘f3 g5 17 ♘xg5 ♘g6 18 ♘f3 ♗g4 19 h3 f5 20 ♗b2 ♘d6 was unclear in Orlov-Krum Georgiev, GMA Belgrade Open 1988, while 13 ♕b3 ♘d6 14 a4 ♗d7 15 a5 ♘ec8 16 ♕a3 ♕c7 17 ab ♘xb6 18 ♕a2 a5 19 ♗a3 a4 20 ♖bc1 ♗h6 21 ♖c2 ♖fc8 was slightly better for White in Fedorowicz-Bastian, Bundesliga 1988/9) 13 ... ♗d7 14 ♗d3 ♘d6 15 ♘e2 f6 16 f4 ♕c7 17 ♕e1 ♘f7, Pekarek-Krum Georgiev, Warsaw 1987, White had developed considerable pressure and now 18 f5 (instead of 18 ♕g3 f5) looks unpleasant for Black.



13 ♘b3

Or 13 ♕a4 f5 14 f3 (or 14 ♘b3 fe 15 ♘xe4 ♘f6 16 f3 ♘xe4 17 fe ♖xf1+ 18 ♗xf1 ♔h8 with equality in Gligorić-Ciocaltea, Hastings 1971/2) 14 ... ♗h6 15 ♘b3 ♗xc1 16 ♖fxc1 a5!? (a drastic method of preventing ♘a5-c6) 17 ♘d2 ♗d7 18 ♕d1 ♘f6 19 ♖b7 ♗c8 20 ♖b2 g5 21 ♖cb1 ♘g6 22 ♖b8 ♖xb8 23 ♖xb8 ♕e7 24 ♕a4 (going after the a-pawn is a bit greedy; 24 ef ♗xf5 25 ♖xf8+ is roughly equal) 24 ... ♘f4 25 ♕xa5 fe 26 fe ♕f7 27 ♘f3 (27 ♖b1 ♘6xd5! is also better for Black) 27 ... ♘xe2+ 28 ♘xe2 ♘xe4 29 ♕a8 ♕f5 30 ♘g3 ♘xg3 31 hg e4 32 ♘e1 e3 33 ♕c6 (an attempt to force perpetual check which fails to Black's 37th move) 33 ... e2 34 ♕xd6 ♕f2+ 35 ♔h2 ♕xe1 36 ♖xc8 ♕h1+! 37 ♔xh1 e1♕+ 38 ♔h2 ♖xc8 39 ♕f6 ♕e3 0-1, A. Lewis-Nunn, London 1988.

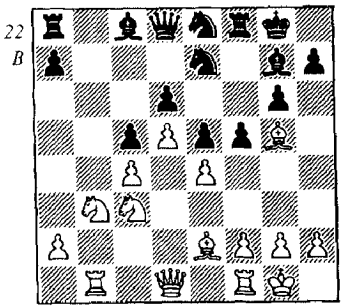
After 13 ♘b3 we have the same position as in Chapter 2, but with added a-pawns. In my view the addition of the a-pawns slightly favours White. The reason is that in Chapter 2 White's only way to make progress is to exchange rooks with ♖a1, which costs time, whereas here White has the extra possibility of ♘a5-c6. Moreover Black's a-pawn can easily become a weakness. In Chapter 2 Black equalized with accurate play, whereas here I am not at all sure that Black can hold the balance. If this is true then 9 ... c5 10 ♖b1 should be met by 10 ... a5.

13 ... f5

13 ... a5 is an alternative designed to hold White up on the queenside. Although it is an interesting idea, Black gives away b5 and creates a target on a5, which should be more important than the gain of time. Lerner-Renet, Geneva 1988, continued 14 a4 ♘c7?! (aiming for b4, but allowing a tactic; 14 ... f5 was better) 15 ♘xc5 dc 16 d6 ♘e6 (not 16 ... ♘c6? 17 dc ♕xc7 18 ♕d5) 17 de ♕xe7 18 ♘d5 ♕a7 19 ♗e3 ♘d4 20 ♗xd4 ed 21 f4 ♗e6 22 ♔h1 ♖ab8 23 ♕c2 and now 23 ... ♖xb1 24 ♖xb1 ♖b8 25 ♖b3 ♗f8 is best, with just a slight advantage for White after 26 e5.

13 ... ♔h8 is a logical move; the idea is to wait for 14 ♗d2 before playing 14 ... f5, when the ♗g5 idea of the main line would involve a loss of time (see the corresponding idea in Chapter 2 for more details). After 14 ♕c2 f5 15 f4 ♘g8 16 ef ♗xf5 17 ♗d3 ♖b8 18 ♗d2 ef 19 ♗xf4 White was slightly better in Baikov-Krasenkov, Moscow 1989, but 14 ... h6!? is one possible improvement.

14 ♗g5 *(22)*



The most dangerous move. 14 f3 ♔h8 (14 ... f4!? 15 ♕e1! g5 16 g4 fg 17 hg ♘g6 18 ♘d1 h5 19 ♘e3 h4 20 g4 was slightly better for White in Hölzl–Schmidt, Holzoster am See 1981) 15 ♗d2 ♘g8 16 ♕c2 ♘h6 17 ♖b2 ♘f6 gave Black enough counterplay in Stein–Panno, Las Palmas 1973.

14 ... ♔h8 *(23)*

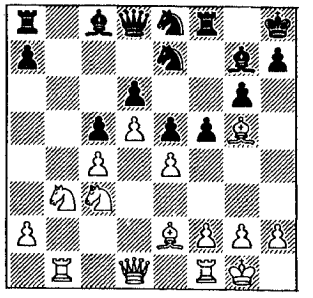
This is a critical moment. Black has a wide range of moves, of which ... ♔h8 is the best, even though it may not fully equalize. The other lines are:

a) **14 ... ♗f6** 15 ♗d2 ♔h8 (15 ... ♗d7 16 ♗d3 f4 17 ♗e2 ♕c8 18 ♘a5 g5 19 h3 ♘g6 20 ♗g4 ♗d8 21 ♗xd7 ♕xd7 22 ♖b7 ♕c8 23 ♕h5 ♘g7 24 ♕h6 ♖f7 25 ♖xf7 ♔xf7 26 ♘c6 was very good for White in Beaumont–Carr, British Ch 1988) 16 ♗d3 ♗g7 (16 ... ♘g8 is met by 17 ef gf 18 ♘e2 intending ♘a5–c6) 17 f3 ♘g8, Eingorn–Hebden, Moscow 1986, and now 18 ef gf 19 ♘e2 would have been slightly better for White according to Eingorn, but 18 ♘e2 f4 19 ♘a5 g5 20 ♘c6 ♕f6 as played was double-edged.

b) **14 ... h6** (this is perhaps the simplest answer to White's plan, but I am sceptical about ... h6; compared with Littlewood–Nunn below, which is unclear, Black not only loses the tempo ... ♔h8 but he also blocks a possible ... ♗h6) 15 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 16 ♘a5 (once again the availability of ♘a5 makes a big difference) 16 ... ♘f6 (16 ... h5 17 ♘c6 ♕g5 18 ef ♗xf5 19 ♖b7 e4 20 ♕c1 ♕f6 21 ♘d1 ♖f7 22 ♖xf7 ♕xf7 23 ♕f4 ♔h7 24 ♘e3 ♗h6 25 ♕h4 ♘g7 26 g4 hg 27 ♗xg4 ♖f8 was unclear in Flear–Sellos, Paris 1988) 17 ♘c6 ♕d7 (17 ... ♕e8!? 18 ef gf 19 ♕a4 ♖f7 20 ♘b5 ♕d7 21 ♖b3 f4 22 ♖fb1 ♗f8 23 ♕a5 ♖g7 gave Black adequate counterplay in Krasenkov–Neverov, Odessa 1989, but I remain doubtful about 14 ... h6) 18 ef!? gf 19 ♖b3 e4!? (Sznapik suggests 19 ... ♗b7) 20 ♕c1 ♗b7 21 ♕f4 ♗xc6 22 dc ♕xc6 23 ♘b5 ♔h7!? 24 ♘xd6 ♕d7 25 ♖d1 ♕e6 26 ♖d5 ♖ad8 and at this stage Black's position appears precarious, although in Pekarek–Sznapik, Warsaw 1987, he went on to win by 27 ♖g3 ♔h8 28 ♗h5 ♖d7 29 ♖g6? (29 ♗g6!) 29 ... ♖f6 30 ♖xg7 ♖xg7 31 ♘e8 ♖b7 32 h4 (32 ♘xf6 ♕xd5) 32 ... ♖f8 33 ♘d6 ♖d7 34 ♕d2 ♕f6 35 ♘e8 ♕a1+ 36 ♔h2 ♕e5+ 37 g3 ♖xd5 38 cd f4 39 d6 e3 40 ♕e2 fg+ 41 fg ♖f2+ 0–1.

c) After **14 ... ♘f6** the crucial line is 15 ♘xc5 (better than 15 ef gf 16 ♕d2 ♘g6 17 f3 ♖f7 18 ♔h1 ♘f4 19 ♖fe1 h6 20 ♗h4, which gave White no advantage in Winants–Scheeren, Budel 1987) 15 ... dc 16 d6 ♘c6 (16 ... ♗e6 17 de ♕xe7 18 f3! ♖ab8 19 ♘d5 ♕f7 20 ♗e3 ♖xb1 21 ♕xb1 ♖c8 22 ♕b5 ♗f8 23 ♕a6! was also good for White in Sirov–Zarnicki, Timisoara 1988) 17 ♗xf6 and 18 ♕d5+, as in Chapter 2.

d) **14 ... ♖f7** is very dubious and after 15 ef ♗xf5 16 ♗d3 h6 17 ♗xe7 ♖xe7 18 ♕c2 ♖f7 19 ♘e4 ♘f6 20 ♘g3 ♗xd3 21 ♕xd3, Chernin–Gunawan, GMA Belgrade Open 1988, Black had the type of position which gives King's Indian players nightmares; bad bishop against knight planted on e4.



15 ef

Or 15 ♗xe7 (the immediate 15 ♘xc5 is bad because of 15 ... dc 16 d6 ♘xd6 17 ♘d5 ♖e8 18 ♘xe7 ♖xe7 19 ♕d5 ♗e6! 20 ♗xe7 ♗xd5 21 ♗xd8 ♗xe4 and Black is slightly better) 15 ... ♕xe7 16 ♘a5 ♘f6 (after 16 ... ♗h6 a draw was agreed in Lalić–Kozul, Sarajevo 1988) 17 ♘c6 ♕f7 (17 ... ♕d7 also comes into consideration) 18 ♗f3 g5, P. Littlewood–Nunn, London 1987, and now instead of 19 ef?! ♗xf5 20 ♖b3 g4 21 ♗e2 ♗h6 with good play for Black, White should have played 19 ♘b5! g4 (19 ... ♕d7 20 ef and 19 ... ♘e8 20 ♗h5 are worse) 20 ♘xd6 ♕d7 21 ♘xf5 gf 22 ♘xe5 ♕e8 23 ♘xf3 ♗xf5 24 ef with a slight advantage.

15 ... gf

And now:

a) **16 ♘xc5** dc 17 d6 ♘xd6 18 ♘d5 ♖e8 (not 18 ... ♖f7? 19 ♗h5) 19 ♘xe7 ♖xe7 20 ♕d5 ♗b7 (20 ... ♗e6? 21 ♗xe7 ♗xd5 22 ♗xd8 ♗e4 23 ♗e7 ♗xb1 24 ♖xb1 ♘e4 27 ♗f3 ♖e8 28 ♖b7 is a very good ending for White) 21 ♖xb7 ♘xb7 22 ♕xd8+ ♖xd8 23 ♗xe7 ♖d2 24 ♗h5 (24 ♖b1 ♖xe2 25 ♔f1 ♖xa2 26 ♖xb7 ♔g8 27 ♗xc5 is a draw) 24 ... e4 (not 24 ... ♖xa2? 25 g4 f4 26 ♖b1 f3 27 ♗f7 e4 28 ♗d5 ♗d4, Flear–Nunn, Szirak 1987, and now 29 ♗h4! would have won for White) 25 ♖b1 ♖xa2 26 ♗xc5 (not 26 g4?? ♖a1 27 ♖xa1 ♗xa1 with a clear plus for Black, Farago–W. Watson, Beersheva 1987) 26 ... ♘xc5 27 ♖b8+ ♗f8 28 ♖xf8+ ♔g7 29 ♖f7+ ♔h6 30 g4 fg 31 ♗xg4 and Black will have no trouble holding the draw.

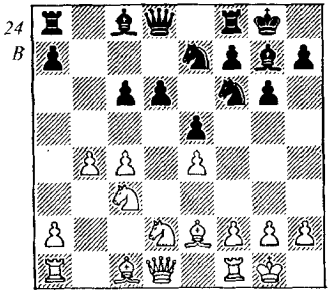
b) **16 f4** (this recent idea appears more dangerous) 16 ... h6 (16 ... ♖g8 17 ♕e1 ♕d7 18 ♗h5 ♗a6 19 ♕h4 e4 20 ♘xe4 fe 21 ♗xe7 ♗xc4 22 f5!? ♗xf1 23 ♖xf1 c4 led to a total mess in Polugayevsky–Krum Georgiev, Haifa 1989) 17 ♗h4 ef (better than 17 ... e4 18 ♕c2, when White has the plan of ♘d1–e3 and ♗e1–c3; after 18 ... ♘f6 19 ♘d1 ♗d7 20 ♗e1 a5 21 ♗c3 a4 22 ♘a1! ♖b8 23 ♘e3 ♘g6 24 ♖xb8 ♕xb8 25 ♕d2 ♘e8 26 ♘ac2

♗xc3 27 ♕xc3+ ♘f6 28 g3 ♘e7 29 ♕a1! White gained control of the b-file with a clear plus, M. Gurevich–Kuzmin, USSR 1988) 18 ♕d2 ♘f6 19 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 20 ♗h5 ♗g5 21 ♘e2 ♘g8! 22 ♘xf4 ♘f6 23 ♕e2 ♗xf4 24 ♖xf4 ♘xh5 25 ♕xh5 ♕g5 26 ♕f3 ♗a6 with an edge for White, Chernin–Kuzmin, USSR 1988. This critical line appears to offer White real chances of an advantage.

10 ♖b1 enables White to fight for an advantage and so should be preferred to 10 dc.

B

10 dc bc
11 b4 *(24)*



11 ... d5

White aims to undermine d5 by playing b5, and getting in first is the most natural counter to White's plan. 11 ... a6 has also been played, but without success. Lines b–d below are experimental:

a) **11 ... a6** 12 ♘b3 (12 a4!? d5 13 ♗a3 ♗e6 14 ♖e1 ♖e8 15 ♗f1 ♘h5 16 ♘b3! d4 17 ♘a2 ♘f4 18 ♘c5 ♗c8 19 ♘c1 g5 20 g3 ♘e6 21 ♘xe6 ♗xe6 22 ♘b3 g4 23 ♘c5 ♗c8 24 b5 was also good for White in Hernandez–Thipsay, Calcutta 1988) 12 ... ♖b8 13 a3 (in Nemet–Bukić, Yugoslavia 1978, White played 13 ♗a3 d5 14 cd cd 15 ♘c5 d4 16 ♘3a4 ♖a8 17 ♖b1 ♘e8 18 ♘b2 ♘c7 19 ♘bd3 and also gained the advantage) 13 ... d5 14 ♗g5 d4 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 ♘a4 ♗g5 17 ♘b2 f5 18 ♘c5 ♕d6 19 ♘bd3 was good for White, Farago–Hebden, Hastings 1982/3.

b) **11 ... ♘h5** 12 g3 (12 ♗xh5 gh 13 ♕xh5 f5 must be the critical continuation; Black can open the position up for his two bishops by playing ... d5, but whether he has enough for the pawn is unclear) 12 ... a6 (the immediate 12 ... f5 is met by 13 b5) 13 ♖e1 f5 14 ♗f3 ♘f6 15 ♗b2 ♕c7 16 ♕e2 ♖e8 17 ♖ad1 (17 c5? d5 18 ed cd 19 ♕xe5 ♕xe5 20 ♖xe5 ♘e4 is good for Black) 17 ... ♗b7 18 ♗g2 ♖ad8 19 ♘b3 ♗c8 20 ♘d2 ♗b7 and in Kalinichev–Didishko, USSR 1986, White decided to avoid the draw by 21 ♖c1, but after 21 ... ♕b8 22 ♖c2 d5! Black broke out and went on to win.

c) **11 ... ♖e8!?** 12 b5 cb 13 ♘xb5 a6 14 ♘c3 ♘c6 15 ♘b3 ♗e6 16 ♗e3 ♖c8 17 c5 ♘d4! 18 ♗xa6 ♖a8 19 ♗b7 ♗xb3 20 ab ♖xa1 21 ♕xa1 dc was level in Plachetka–Chiburdanidze, Vinkovci 1982.

d) **11 ... ♘e8** 12 ♘b3 f5 13 ♗a3 a6!? 14 ♕d2 fe (14 ... ♗e6 15 ♖fd1 is slightly better for White) 15 ♘xe4 ♘f5 16 ♖ad1 ♖a7 17 ♗b2 (17 ♘a5 ♘d4 18 ♘xc6? ♘xc6 19 ♕d5+ ♔h8 20 ♕xc6 ♗b7 wins for Black) 17 ... ♖af7 18 b5 ♕h4 19 ♕c2 c5 20 g3 and White has a slight advantage.

Now there is a major division. At one time 12 ♗a3 was the most common choice, then attention switched to 12 b5, but now the whole 10 dc line has fallen out of favour.

B1 12 ♗a3
B2 12 b5

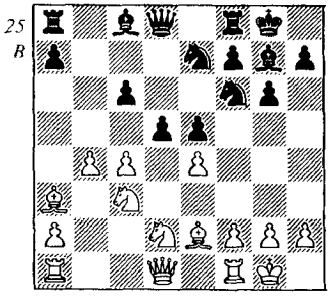
Or:

a) **12 ♖e1** ♖e8! 13 b5 ♗e6 14 ♗a3? (14 a4 is better) 14 ... ♕a5 15 ♗b2 (not 15 ♕b3 d4 16 ♗b4 ♕c7 attacking c3 and b5) 15 ... ♘xe4 16 ♘dxe4 de 17 ♘xe4 cb 18 cb ♕b4 19 ♕c2 ♖ac8 20 ♗c3 ♖xc3! 21 ♘xc3 ♖c8 with advantage to Black, Plachetka–Krum Georgiev, Dubai Ol 1986.

b) **12 cd** cd 13 b5 ♗b7 (13 ... d4 14 ♘a4 d3 transposes to the main line, while 13 ... de 14 ♘dxe4 ♘xe4 15 ♘xe4 ♘f5 16 ♗a3 ♖e8 17 ♘d6 ♘xd6 18 ♕xd6 ♗e6 19 ♗f3 e4 20 ♗xe4 ♗xa1 21 ♗xa8 ♕xa8 22 ♖xa1 ♗xa2 23 ♗b2!, Nesis–Sislov, corr. 1978, was better for White) 14 ♗f3 (14 ♗d3 ♖c8 15 ♗b2 de 16 ♘dxe4 ♘fd5 17 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 18 ♖c1 ♘f4 19 ♗b1 ♕b6 20 ♖xc8 ♖xc8 21 ♕d7 ♖d8 22 ♕e7 ♘d5 23 ♕c5 f5 24 ♕xb6 ab, Koshil–Kopylov, corr. 1983, was also fine for Black) 14 ... a6 15 b6 ♕xb6 16 ♗a3 ♖fe8 17 ♖b1 ♕c7 18 ♗xe7 ♖xe7 19 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 20 ed e4 21 d6! ♕xd6 22 ♘xe4 with equality, Nesis–Kopylov, corr. 1982.

B1

12 ♗a3 *(25)*



12 ... a6

It is unwise for Black to commit himself in the centre too soon, e.g. 12 ... d4 13 ♘a4 ♗h6 (or 13 ... ♘e8 14 b5 f5 15 ♗b4 ♖b8 16 ♘c5 a5 17 ♗a3 ♘d6 18 ♖b1 ♗h6 19 ♗d3 ♔h8 20 ♖e1 ♗g7 21 ♕a4 and White was better in Stefanov–Tratatovici, Romanian Ch 1979) 14 ♘c5 ♖e8?! (14 ... a6 15 ♘db3 ♘d7 is better, but an early ... d4 giving White a mobile queenside majority looks wrong), Schmidt–Torre, Buenos Aires Ol 1978, and now 15 b5!? a6 (or 15 ... ♕a5 16 ♗c1 and ♘db3) 16 ♗b4! would have been good for White according to Kovačević.

13 ♖e1

13 ♗f3 ♗e6 14 cd cd 15 b5 ♖e8 16 b6 d4 17 ♘a4 ♘d7 18 ♖b1 ♖b8

19 ♗d6 was better for White in Burger–Uhlmann, Budapest 1982, but 15 ... d4 16 ♘d5 ♘fxd5 17 ed ♘xd5 18 ♗xf8 ♗xf8 is a promising exchange sacrifice.

13 ... ♗e6

Other moves are also possible, for example the unusual plan **13 ... h5!?** 14 ♖b1 ♖e8 15 ♗f1 ♗g4 16 ♕b3 de 17 ♘dxe4 ♘f5 18 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 19 ♘e4 ♘d4 gave Black a fine position in Sinković–Uhlmann, Stary Smokovec 1985, while the ambitious **13 ... ♖e8** 14 ♗f1 ♖a7 (14 ... ♗e6 transposes to the main line) 15 ♗b2 ♖d7 (White did not refute Black's idea in this game) 16 ♕b3 de 17 ♘dxe4 ♘f5 18 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 19 ♘e4 ♕h4 20 c5 ♘d4 21 ♕a4 ♘b5 led to a double-edged position in Kochiev–Mortensen, Leningrad 1984.

14 ♗f1 ♖e8

After 14 ... ♖e8 White may play:

a) **15 ♗b2** ♕b8 16 a3 ♖a7 17 ♘a4?! (17 cd cd 18 ed ♘exd5 19 ♘xd5 ♗xd5 20 ♘c4 ♖ae7 was slightly better for White according to Vokac) 17 ... de 18 ♘c5 ♗g4 19 ♕a4 a5 20 b5 cb 21 cb e3! was unclear in Marin–Vokac, Bucharest 1985.

b) **15 ♘b3** de 16 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 17 ♖xe4 ♘f5 18 ♘c5 ♗c8 19 ♖e1 ♘d4 20 ♘e4 ♗h6 with an equal position, Keene–Quinteros, Haifa Ol 1976.

B2

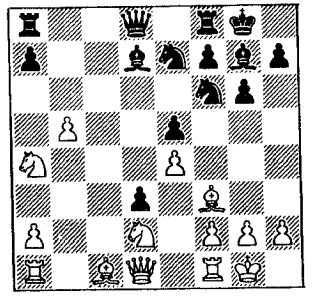
12 b5

The logical follow-up, but it allows the d-pawn to advance to d3.

12 ... d4
13 ♘a4 cb

This is the safest line, but there is an ambitious alternative in 13 ... ♘h5, e.g. 14 ♗a3 (after 14 ♗xh5 gh both 15 ♕xh5 cb 16 cb ♕a5 and 15 ♗a3 h4 are unclear, but in view of the next note 14 ♖e1 ♘f4 15 ♗f1 may be best) 14 ... ♘f4 15 ♘b3 ♖e8 16 ♖e1 ♔h8 (16 ... ♘xe2+ 17 ♕xe2 ♖b8 is better, threatening 18 ... cb 19 cb ♗d7) 17 ♗f1 ♘g8 18 bc ♖e6? (18 ... ♘e7 is better) 19 g3! with a good position for White in Vilela–Hernandez, Havana 1982.

14 cb d3
15 ♗f3 ♗d7 *(26)*



16 ♘c5

Or 16 ♖b1 ♖b8 17 ♘c3 ♕a5 (or 17 ... a6!? 18 a4 ♕a5 19 ♖b3 ♗e6 20 ♖a3 ♖fd8 21 ♘db1!? ♖d7 22 ♗d2, W.Schmidt–Uhlmann, Poland–GDR 1982, and now 22 ... ab 23 ab ♕d8 gives Black the edge according to W.Schmidt) 18 ♖b3 (18 ♗b2 ♗xb5 19 ♘b3 ♕b6 20 ♗a3 ♖fe8 21 ♘c5 a6 22 ♘xb5 ab 23 ♘xd3 ♘c6 24 ♗c5 ♕a5 25 ♕b3 ♘d7 26 ♗e3 ♘d4 was fine for Black in Grunfeld–Enoshi, Tel Aviv 1988) 18 ... ♖fc8 (more accurate than 18 ... ♗e6 19 ♖a3 ♕c7 20 ♕a4 ♘c8 21 ♕a5 ♕d7 22 ♗d1 ♖b7 23 ♘a4 ♖xb5, but even this is enough for equality, Nesis–Strelcov, corr. 1983) 19 ♗a3 ♗e6 and Black is better, Nesis–Pankević, corr. 1983.

16 ... ♗xb5
17 a4 ♗c6
18 ♗a3

Or 18 ♖a3 ♕d6 19 ♘xd3 ♖fd8 20 ♗b2 ♘d7 21 ♕a1 ♖ab8! (setting up a tactical defence to 22 ♘c4 ♕e6 23 ♘cxe5 since 23 ... ♘xe5 wins after 24 ♘xe5 ♖xb2 or 24 ♗xe5 ♖xd3! 25 ♗xg7 ♖xa3) 22 ♖e1 ♗a8 23 ♘c4 ♕e6 24 ♘e3 h5! with a double-edged position in Vilela–Vogt, Cienfuegos 1983.

18 ... ♖e8
19 ♖c1 ♘d7!

The tactical line 19 ... ♖c8 20 ♖c3 ♘f5!! 21 ef e4 22 fg hg 23 ♘cxe4 ♘xe4 24 ♖xc6 ♖xc6 25 ♘xe4 ♕d4! 26 ♘c5 ♖xc5 27 ♗xc5 ♕xc5 28 ♕xd3 ♗d4, which led to equality in Lukacs–Sznapik, Polanica Zdroj 1984, was adorned with exclamation marks in *Informator*. Unfortunately the simple 23 ♘dxe4! ♘xe4 24 ♖xd3 ♕a5 25 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 26 ♖d7 left White a pawn up for nothing in Farago–Gavrić, Banja Luka 1985, and after 26 ... ♗c6 27 ♗xc6 ♖xc6 28 ♖xf7 ♖ce6 29 ♕d7 1–0 Black had learnt not to believe everything in *Informator*.

20 ♘xd3

Or 20 ♘db3 ♘xc5 21 ♘xc5 ♕d4 attacking a4.

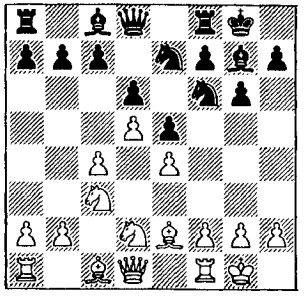
20 ... ♘b6

21 ♕e2 (21 ♗xe7 ♖xe7 22 ♖xc6 ♕xd3 is equal) 21 ... ♗xa4 22 ♘c5 ♗h6 23 ♘xa4 ♕xd2 24 ♕b5 ♕d4 (according to Piket 24 ... ♕g5 is best, avoiding the somewhat risky game continuation) 25 ♗b2 ♕d6 (not 25 ... ♕xa4 26 ♕xe5 ♔f8 27 ♖c7! with a very dangerous attack) 26 ♖fd1 (26 ♗xe5 ♕d7 wins material) 26 ... ♕e6 (this position looks dangerous for Black, but he soon gains the advantage) 27 ♗g4?! (27 ♘c5 ♕c6 holds on) 27 ... ♕xg4 28 ♕xe5 ♔f8 and White could not find a way to break through, Farago–Piket, Amsterdam 1985.

The conclusion is that the main line of 10 dc is satisfactory for Black, and there are a number of interesting and unexplored sidelines on the way.

4 9 ♘d2 others

1	d4	♘f6
2	c4	g6
3	♘c3	♗g7
4	e4	d6
5	♘f3	0-0
6	♗e2	e5
7	0-0	♘c6
8	d5	♘e7
9	♘d2 *(27)*	



There are four moves, apart from 9 ... a5 and 9 ... c5, which are worth considering:

A 9 ... ♗h6
B 9 ... ♘d7
C 9 ... ♘e8
D 9 ... c6

The first move aims to exchange Black's bad bishop, but as in so many lines of the Classical King's Indian the move ... ♗h6 turns out to be a bad idea. Black wastes a lot of time moving his bishop three times to swap off a piece which is still on its original square, and in any case this exchange does not improve Black's position. The bishop on g7 is a vital piece, lending force to ... f5, and if it is absent White can very well meet ... f5 by ef, since the opening of the long diagonal is no longer a worry. 9 ... ♘d7 and 9 ... ♘e8 often transpose into the same line, since after ... f5 the knight usually returns to f6. This line, which is considered under B, features a kingside v queenside pawn race. Unfortunately for Black the white pawns touch down first, and White gains the advantage more or less by force. Finally we consider 9 ... c6, which has only been played a few times. Although, as we have mentioned in earlier chapters, the move ... c6 can be effective, it makes most sense when White has compromised his position in some way, otherwise the pawn move may make it easier for White to attack on the queenside. More practical experience is necessary before a final verdict can be reached, but although so far Black's results have been good I am doubtful about the idea.

A

9 ... ♗h6
10 b4 ♘e8

After 10 ... a5 11 ba ♖xa5 12 ♘b3 ♗xc1 13 ♕xc1 ♖a8 14 a4 c5 15 f4 White suddenly had a dangerous kingside initiative in Taimanov–Tatai, Venice 1969, while 10 ... ♘d7 11 c5! dc 12 bc ♘xc5 13 ♗a3 ♘d7 14 ♘b5 ♖e8 15 ♘c4 intending ♘xc7 is clearly good for White.

11 c5!

As we mentioned before, the d2 knight belongs on c4, so this move is stronger than 11 ♘b3 ♗xc1 12 ♕xc1 f5 (12 ... c6 13 dc bc 14 a4 ♗e6 15 b5 f5 16 f4 a6 17 fe was good for White, Mecking–Naranja, Palma de Mallorca 1970, but 16 ... d5 would have been unclear according to Velimirović) 13 f4 ♘f6 14 fe de 15 ♕g5 ♔g7 16 ef ♘xf5 with just an edge for White, Taimanov–Zelandinov, USSR Ch 1967.

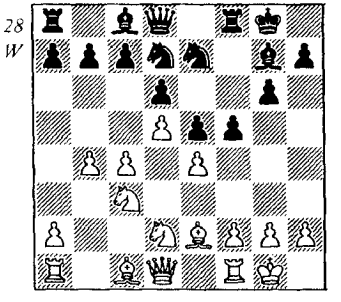
11 ... f5

12 ef gf 13 ♘c4 ♗xc1 14 ♖xc1 ♘g6 15 ♗h5 ♕e7 16 ♗xg6 hg 17 f4!, Gligorić–Vukić, Sarajevo 1969, with a clear plus for White because although Black has exchanged his g7 bishop, the blockade of the f5 pawn has made the c8 bishop bad instead.

B

9 ... ♘d7
10 b4 f5 *(28)*

10 ... a5 (10 ... ♗h6 11 c5 transposes to line A) 11 ba ♖xa5 12 ♘b3 ♖a8 13 a4 f5 14 a5 ♘f6 15 f3 ♔h8 16 c5 was good for White in Spassov–Biyiasas, Vrnjačka Banja 1976.



11 f3

Other moves:

a) **11 ♘b3** (weak) 11 ... fe! 12 ♘xe4 ♘f6 13 ♘g3 ♘f5 14 ♘xf5 ♗xf5! 15 ♗e3 h5 16 f3 ♕d7 with a level position, Korchnoi–Gligorić, Havana 1969.

b) **11 ♗a3** (not the most accurate, because in some lines it is preferable to push the a-pawn; moreover this move lends force to ... ♗h6) 11 ... ♘f6 (11 ... a5!? is possible since 12 ba ♖xa5 forces White to spend time moving the bishop) 12 f3 ♗h6 13 c5 ♗e3+ 14 ♔h1 f4?! (14 ... ♘h5!? seems playable for Black) 15 ♘c4 ♗d4 16 ♘b5! ♗xa1 17 ♕xa1 ♘e8 18 ♘xc7! ♘f5 (18 ...

♘xc7 19 cd ♘b5 20 de is also very good for White) 19 ef ♕xc7 20 fg hg 21 cd ♘xd6 22 ♘xe5!? ♗f5 23 ♕d4 g5 24 ♗b2 ♕h7 25 ♘g4 ♖ae8 26 ♗d1 with a decisive advantage for White, Panno–Yepez, Quito 1976.

c) **11 a4** (as in line b this move is unnecessarily committal; White should pressure d6 and then decide how to continue his attack) and now:

c1) **11 ... ♘f6** 12 a5 (this is going too far; it was time to support e4 by 12 f3) 12 ... ♗h6 13 c5 ♗xd2 14 ♗xd2 ♘xe4 15 ♘xe4 fe 16 ♗g5 ♕e8 17 ♖c1 ♘f5 18 ♖c3 ♗d7 19 ♕d2 ♘d4 20 ♖e1 ♗b5 21 ♗xb5 ♕xb5 22 ♕b2 b6 23 ♗e7 bc! 24 ♗xf8 ♖xf8 with advantage for Black, Epishin–Akopian, Tbilisi 1989.

c2) **11 ... ♗h6** 12 ♘b3 ♗xc1 13 ♖xc1 (or 13 ♕xc1!? intending f4) 13 ... ♘f6 14 f3 f4 15 c5 g5 16 ♘b5 ♘e8 17 ♕c2 ♘g6 (not 17 ... a6 18 cd cd 19 ♘c7 nor 17 ... ♗d7 18 ♘a5!) 18 cd cd 19 ♘c7 ♘xc7 20 ♕xc7 ♕f6! followed by ... ♖f7 with a double-edged position in M. Gurevich–Uhlmann, Tallinn 1987.

The evaluation of the above three lines is rather academic since the main variation is so good for White. In fact the only real choice is one of move order: should White play 11 f3 or 11 c5? I can see little advantage to 11 c5, even though this is most frequently played in practice. The point is that after 11 f3 Black has nothing better than 11 ... ♘f6, when 12 c5 reaches the same position as after 11 c5 ♘f6 12 f3, except that Black has been denied the possibility of taking the pawn on c5.

d) **11 c5** dc (we only consider this move, as 11 ... ♘f6 12 f3 transposes to the main line) 12 bc ♘xc5 and now:

d1) **13 f3** c6 14 ♗a3 b6 15 ♗c4 ♔h8 16 ♘b3 ♘xb3 17 ab c5 (17 ... b5 18 d6 ♘g8 19 d7 wins) 18 b4! cb 19 ♗xb4 ♗d7 20 ♗a6 b5 21 ♔h1 ♖e8? (a blunder, but even after 21 ... ♖f7 White has a clear advantage) 22 ♗a5! 1–0, Platz–Vogt, GDR 1970. Black's troubles in this game can be traced back to 13 ... c6?; 13 ... b6 is better, with an unclear position.

d2) **13 ♗a3** b6 (not 13 ... ♘xe4? 14 ♘dxe4 fe 15 ♘xe4 when 15 ... ♖f4 16 d6 ♘c6 17 dc ♕xc7 18 g3 and 15 ... ♖e8 16 ♗c4 are good for White) 14 ♗xc5 bc 15 ♘b3 (15 ♗c4 ♔h8 16 ♘b3 ♕d6 17 ♘b5 ♕b6 and 15 ♕b3 ♔h8 16 ♖fd1 c6 17 d6 ♕xd6 18 ♘c4 ♕c7 19 ♘d6 h5 20 ♕c4 are unclear) 15 ... ♔h8!? (15 ... ♕d6 16 ♘b5 ♕b6 17 ♖c1 and 15 ... fe 16 ♗c4 ♘f5 17 ♘xe4 ♘d6 18 ♕e2 are good for White, but 15 ... a6 16 ♘xc5 ♕d6 17 ♘b3 c6 18 dc ♕xc6 19 ♖c1 offers White only a slight advantage) 16 ♕d2 fe 17 ♘xc5, Lputyan–Akopian, Erevan 1988, and now 17 ...e3! 18 ♕xe3 (or 18 fe ♘f5) 18 ... e4 19 ♘5xc4 ♘xd5 20 ♘xd5 ♕xd5 21 ♖fd1 gives White just an edge.

The conclusion is that White may preserve a slight plus after 11 c5 dc, but his advantage is certainly less than in the main line, so 11 f3 is to be preferred.

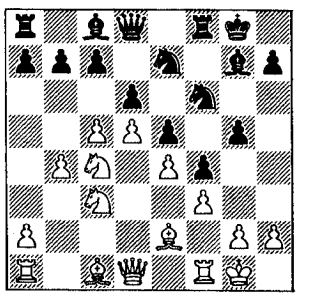
11 ... ♘f6

11 ... ♗h6 12 ♘b3 ♗xc1 13 ♖xc1 f4 14 c5 ♘f6 15 ♘b5 was good for White, Portisch–Gligorić, Hastings 1969/70.

12 c5 f4

Or 12 ... ♗h6 (12 ... a5 13 ba dc 14 ♘c4 ♗d7 15 ♖b1 ♘c8 16 ♗e3 fe 17 fe ♘d6 18 ♕d3, Geller–I. Zaitsev, USSR Ch 1969, was distinctly better for White) 13 ♘c4 ♗xc1 14 ♖xc1 f4 15 ♘b5!? ♘e8 16 ♕b3 g5 (16 ... ♔g7 17 ♕c3! sets up unpleasant tactical possibilities) 17 cd cd 18 ♘xe5! de 19 d6+ ♔h8 20 de ♕xe7 21 ♖fd1 a6 22 ♘c3 ♗e6 23 ♕b2 ♘f6 24 ♘a4 ♗g8 25 ♘b6 ♖ae8 26 a4 with a definite advantage for White, Speelman–Mestel, England 1987.

13 ♘c4 g5 *(29)*



14 a4

White can attack either with or without his a-pawn. The advantage of 14 a4 is that when the attack does arrive, it is guaranteed to demolish Black's queenside. However even 14 ♗a3 is very promising, e.g. 14 ♗a3 ♘e8?! (14 ... ♖f7 looks more flexible, intending to cover d6 with ... ♗f8 and ... ♘g6) 15 ♕b3 ♘g6 16 ♖ac1! (16 b5 b6 17 cd cd 18 ♘d1 h5 19 ♘f2 ♖f7 20 ♗b4 is slower, but still slightly better for White, Stein–Sahović, Vrnjačka Banja 1971) 16 ... h5 17 h3 ♖f7 18 ♘d1 ♗f8 19 ♘f2 ♖g7 20 ♖c2 ♘h4 21 ♖fc1 ♘f6 22 cd cd 23 b5 g4 24 fg hg 25 hg ♘xg4 26 ♘xg4 ♗xg4 27 ♗xg4 ♖xg4 28 ♕h3 ♕g5 29 ♗xd6 f3 30 ♘xe5 ♖f4 31 ♕e6+ ♔h8 32 ♘f7+ 1–0 Kaplan–Meyer, USA 1978.

14 ... ♘g6

Or 14 ... a6 15 ♗a3 ♘e8 16 b5 ♖f6 17 ♕b3 ♔h8 18 b6 dc 19 ♗xc5 ♘g6 20 bc ♕xc7 21 ♗b6 ♕f7 22 ♗f2 with a large plus for White in Olivier–Rasmussen, Lugano 1989.

15 ♗a3 ♖f7

16 b5

Certainly not 16 ♘b5 ♗f8 and White has only succeeded in blocking his own lines of attack.

16 ... ♗f8

In this critical position White has a choice of two attacking methods:

a) **17 a5** (this seems sounder) with the further branch:

a1) **17 ... dc** 18 b6 ab 19 ab cb 20 ♕b3 ♖a6 21 ♖fb1 g4 22 ♘xb6 gf 23 ♗xa6 ba, Stupica–Mista, Yugoslavia 1971, and now the simple 24 gf would have given White a winning position.

a2) **17 ... b6** 18 cb cb 19 ab ab 20 ♘a2 g4 21 ♘b4 ♘xe4 (or 21 ... g3 22 ♘c6 and again White stands very well, Bukić–Marjanović, Yugoslavia 1970) 22 fe ♕h4 23 ♘d2 ♗h6 24 ♘d3 f3 25 ♘xf3 and Black has insufficient compensation for his material deficit, Ogaard–Moen, Oslo 1976.

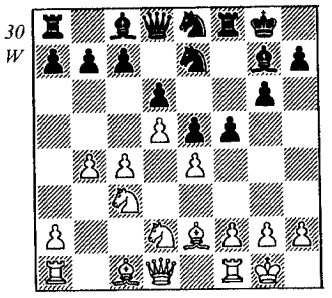
b) **17 b6** dc (17 ... ab 18 cb c5 19 dc bc 20 ♗xd6 ♖d7 21 ♕b3 wins, but Ftacnik gives 17 ... cb!? 18 ♘xd6 ♗xd6 19 cd ♘e8 20 d7 ♗xd7 21 ♕b3 as unclear) 18 bc ♖xc7 19 ♘b5 (19 d6!? ♖c6 20 ♕b3 ♔h8 21 ♖ad1 ♗xd6 22 ♘b5 ♗e6 23 ♘bxd6 ♖xd6 24 ♕xb7 is also promising for White) 19 ... ♖g7 20 d6 ♗e6 21 ♘c7 ♖xc7 22 dc ♕xc7 23 ♕c2 h5, Ftačnik–Přibyl, Czechoslovak Ch 1984, and now 24 ♗b2 or 24 ♘d2 (intending ♗c4) would have been very good for White.

C

9 ... ♘e8

The best Black can hope for after this move is transposition to the dismal variation B. Other lines are worse, because Black's lack of control over c5 makes it easier for White to advance his queenside pawns.

10 b4 f5 *(30)*



11 c5

Here there is no reason to avoid this direct move, even though 11 f3 is perfectly playable. After 11 f3 Black may try:

a) **11 ... f4** 12 c5 g5 13 ♘c4 ♖f6 (13 ... ♖f7 14 a4 ♘g6 15 ♗a3 leaves Black with nothing better than 15 ... ♘f6 transposing to line B) 14 ♗b2! (aiming for quick pressure down the c-file is the best reply) 14 ... ♖g6 15 ♖c1 ♔h8 16 ♘b5 ♘g8 17 ♖c2 ♘h6 18 ♘xc7! ♕xc7 19 cd ♘xd6 20 ♘xe5 ♕b6+ 21 ♔h1 (not 21 ♗d4? ♗xe5! 22 ♗xb6 ab) 21 ... ♘df7 22 ♘xg6+ ♕xg6 23 ♗xg7+ ♕xg7 24 ♖c7 ♕e5 25 ♕a1 ♕xa1 26 ♖xa1 and White is winning, Nemet–Pavlović, Lugano 1988.

b) **11 ... ♗h6** 12 ♘b3 ♗xc1 13 ♖xc1 f4 14 c5 g5 15 a4 (15 ♘a5 ♔h8 16 ♕c2 ♖g8 17 ♘b5 was also good for White in Anikayev–Malachi, Graz 1972) 15 ... h5 16 a5 ♔h8 17 ♘d2 ♖g8 18 g4!, Schmidt–Andersson, Nice Ol 1974, and White's surprising pawn push seriously retards Black's attack.

After 11 c5 Black has a depressing choice:

a) **11 ... ♘f6** transposes to line B.

b) **11 ... h5** 12 ef gf 13 ♘c4 e4 14 ♗b2 h4 15 ♕d2 ♘g6 16 f3 is very good for White, Polugayevsky–Uitumen, Palma de Mallorca 1970.

c) **11 ... a5** 12 ♗a3 ab (12 ... fe 13 ♘dxe4 ♘f5 14 ba ♖xa5 15 ♗b4 ♖a8, Lombardy–Yanofsky, Siegen Ol 1970, and now 16 ♘b5 gives White a clear plus) 13 ♗xb4 dc 14 ♗xc5 b6 15 ♗b4 ♘d6 16 ♘c4 and Black's queenside is under heavy pressure, Taimanov–F. Portisch, Zalaegerszeg 1969.

d) **11 ... c6** 12 ♘c4 fe 13 ♗g5! and Black is in trouble.

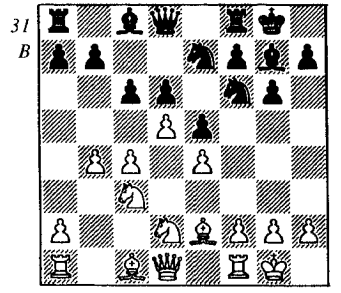
e) **11 ... h6** (not the world's most useful move) 12 ♗a3 ♔h8 13 b5 ♘g8 14 ♘c4 ♘gf6 15 ef!? (perhaps 15 f3 ♘h5 16 g3 ♕g5 17 ♖f2 ♘f4 18 ♗f1 is even better, since there is no obvious way for Black to make progress on the kingside) 15 ... gf 16 ♕d2! ♖g8? (16 ... f4 17 f3 ♗f5 18 ♗d3 may be better, but this is still unpleasant for Black) 17 cd cd 18 f4 e4 19 ♔h1 with a massive positional advantage for White, Mikhalchishin–Tseshkovsky, Cienfuegos 1981.

D

9 ... c6

10 b4

Or 10 ♖b1 (10 dc transposes to Chapter 3, while 10 a3 cd 11 cd ♘e8 intending ... f5 gives Black counterplay) 10 ... b5 11 dc b4 12 ♘d5 ♘xc6 13 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 14 ♘f3 ♗g4 15 ♗e3 ♗xf3 16 ♗xf3 ♘d4 (or 16 ... ♗g5!? 17 ♗xg5 ♕xg5 18 ♕xd6 ♖ac8 19 ♕d3 ♘d4 20 ♖bc1 ♖fd8 21 ♕e3 ♕f6 22 ♗d1 ♖c5 23 ♗a4 ♘e6 24 a3 a5 25 ab ab 26 ♕b3 ♖b8 27 ♕e3 ♘d4, Dautov–Yanvarev, Warsaw Open 1989, and Black's positional advantage made it impossible for White to capitalise on his extra pawn) 17 a3 ♖c8 18 b3 ba 19 ♖a1 ♕a5 20 ♗d2 ♕c5 21 ♗c1 ♗d8 22 ♗xa3 ♕c6 23 ♕d3 ♗b6 and Black has a very comfortable position, Gligorić–Kuzmin, Moscow GMA Open 1989.



10 ... a5

This makes more sense than 10 ... b5?! 11 dc ♘xc6 (11 ... bc 12 b5 a6 13 ♘xc4 ab 14 ♘xb5 ♘xe4 15 c7 is very good for White) 12 cb ♘d4 (12 ... ♘xb4? 13 a3) 13 ♘b3 ♗e6 14 ♗e3 ♘xe2+ 15 ♕xe2 ♖c8 16 ♖fc1 with a definite advantage for White, Conquest–Chiburdanidze, Hastings 1986.

11 ba

Not 11 dc ab 12 cb ♗xb7 13 ♘d5 ♘exd5 14 cd ♘d7! 15 ♕b3 ♘c5 16 ♕xb4 ♖a4 17 ♕b1 ♕a8 with very good compensation for the pawn, Sirov–Lanka, USSR 1989.

11	...	**♕xa5**
12	**♕c2**	**c5**
13	**♘b3**	**♕d8**
14	**a4**	

Or 14 ♖d1!? (14 f4 ef 15 ♗xf4 h6 16 ♖ae1 g5 17 e5 ♘fxd5! was promising for Black in Sirov–Lanka, USSR 1988) 14 ... ♘d7 (14 ... ♘e8 is better because the knight serves no extra function on d7, but simply weakens d6) 15 ♘b5 ♖a6 16 ♗e3 (now Black must worry about a sacrifice on d6) 16 ... f5 17 f3 f4 18 ♗f2 g5 19 a4! with advantage for White, Suba–I.Sokolov, Preston 1989.

14	...	**♘d7**

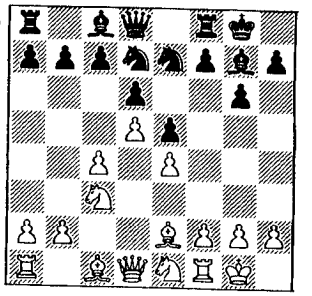
This is a hard decision for Black. If he retreats to e8 then White can play a5 and ♘a4, occupying b6 without wasting time on ♖d1 as in the last note, e.g. 14 ... ♘e8 15 ♗d2 f5 16 f3 f4 17 a5 h5 18 ♘a4 g5 19 ♘b6 with advantage to White, Dreev–Geo.Timoshchenko, Tbilisi 1989. On the other hand moving to d7 has the same fault as above.

After 14 ... ♘d7 the game Sirov–Lanka, USSR 1989, continued 15 ♗e3 (15 ♘b5!, as in Suba–I. Sokolov, is more dangerous) 15 ... f5 16 f3 f4 17 ♗f2 g5 18 a5 h5 19 ♘a4 (19 ♘b5!) 19 ... ♔h8 with an unclear position.

5 9 ♘e1 ♘d7 10 ♘d3 (and 10 ♗d2)

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**c4**	**g6**
3	**♘c3**	**♗g7**
4	**e4**	**d6**
5	**♘f3**	**0-0**
6	**♗e2**	**e5**
7	**0-0**	**♘c6**
8	**d5**	**♘e7**
9	**♘e1**	**♘d7** *(32)*

32
W



This is the first chapter in which we deal with the move 9 ♘e1. Black almost invariably replies 9 ... ♘d7, which prepares ... f5 and restrains White's c5. Other replies are considered in Chapter 8. This chapter is by far the longest in the book, with a great deal of deep and complex analysis. Nevertheless all the lines examined here are closely related, so I have decided not to split the material into a number of chapters. I apologise for the horrible 'B221's and so on, but I believe this is the best way to present a difficult subject.

10	**♘d3**	

If White intends to play the system with ♘d3 and ♗d2 (lines with 10 f3 are covered in Chapters 7 and 8), it normally makes no difference whether he plays ♘d3 or ♗d2 first. However there is one attempt to make use of 10 ♗d2, which was first played by Miles several years ago. This runs 10 ♗d2 f5 11 ♖c1 and now:

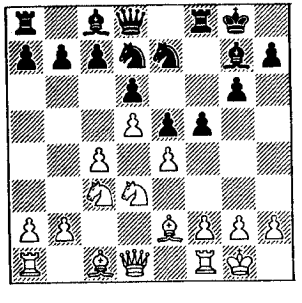
a) **11 ... ♘f6** 12 f3 c5!? (12 ... f4 13 c5 dc!? 14 ♘a4 b6 15 b4 cb 16 ♕b3 ♔h8 17 ♗xb4 ♘e8 18 ♘d3 g5 19 ♘ab2 a5 20 ♗a3 ♗a6 21 ♘c4 ♗xc4 22 ♕xc4 is unclear, Miles–Lind, Gausdal 1980) 13 dc (13 ♘d3 preparing b4 is better) 13 ... bc 14 ♘d3 ♗e6 15 c5 fe! 16 fe (16 cd ed 17 de ♕xe7 18 ♗xd3 ♖ad8 19 ♕e2 ♕d6 wins for Black) 16 ... d5 17 ed ♘fxd5 18 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 19 ♕a4 ♘f5! 20 ♗g4 (20 ♕xc6? ♘d4) 20 ... ♘xc3 21 ♗xc3 ♗d5 (threat

... e4) 22 ♗xe5 ♗xe5 23 ♘xe5 ♕h6! 24 ♖e1 (24 ♖c3 ♖e8 wins) 24 ... ♕d2 and Black wins, Miles–Bukić, Bugojno 1978.

b) **11 ... c5** 12 f4 ef!? 13 ♗xf4 ♘e5 14 ♕d2 fe 15 ♘xe4 ♗f5 (15 ... ♘f5–d4 is also possible) 16 ♘f2 (16 ♘g5 ♕d7 17 h3 h6 18 ♘e6 ♗xe6 19 de ♕xe6 20 ♗xh6 ♖xf1+ 21 ♗xf1 ♗xh6 22 ♕xh6 ♘f5 is fine for Black) 16 ... ♕b6 17 g4 ♗d7 18 ♘ed3 ♘xd3 19 ♘xd3 ♖ae8 with an unclear position, Miles–Sznapik, Malta Ol 1980.

10 ... f5 *(33)*

33 W



We have arrived at the first point of division. Today 10 ♗d2 is almost universal, but in former times 10 ef was quite popular and a good deal of practical evidence was accumulated before White players gave it up as offering no advantage. Hort used to be the main supporter of White's side, but even he seems to have abandoned it now.

A 11 ef
B 11 ♗d2

If White plays 11 f3 then Black can force a return to normal lines by 11 ... f4 12 ♗d2 ♘f6, but there are attempts to exploit White's move order: 11 f3 f4 (there is little to recommend 11 ... ♘f6, since White may still transpose by 12 ♗d2, or he may try 12 c5!? c6?! 13 ♕b3!, when 13 ... ♔h8 14 ♗e3 fe 15 fc cd 16 cd ♘c6 17 ed ♘d4 18 ♗xd4 ed 19 ♘b5 ♗g4 20 ♗f3 ♗h6 21 ♘c7 was very good for White in Skembris–Gufeld, Athens 1985) 12 ♗d2 g5 (the idea is to exploit the lack of ... ♘f6 to play ... ♖f6–h6) 13 g4! fg (13 ... ♘f6 14 c5 h5 15 h3 is good for White) 14 ♗xg5 (better than 14 hg ♘g6 intending ... h5–h4) 14 ... gh+ 15 ♔h1 h6 16 ♗h4 ♗f6 17 ♗xf6 ♖xf6 18 f4 ef 19 ♘xf4 ♘e5 20 ♕d2 ♘7g6 21 ♘h5 ♖xf1+ 22 ♖xf1 ♕g5 23 ♕xg5 hg 24 ♔xh2 with a slight endgame advantage for White in Barlov–Mortensen, Budapest 1987.

A

11 ef

And now both recaptures are playable:

A1 11 ... gf
A2 11 ... ♘xf5

A1 is recommended by Russian schoolboys, but there is a danger that the pawn will be blockaded on f5 leaving the c8 bishop passively placed. Although both lines probably equalize, I believe that A2 is more comfortable for Black; although he gives away the e4 square Black can quickly open lines with ... c6 and White never gets the chance to enjoy his modest outpost.

A1

11 ... gf
12 f4 ♘g6

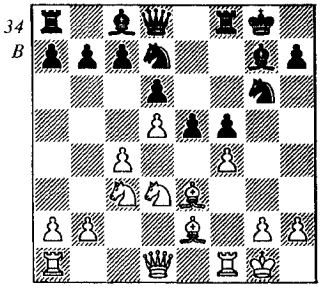
Black should keep the pawn structure fluid, since 12 ... e4?! permanently blocks in his white-squared bishop and leaves him with no active plan because he has no possible pawn breaks. On the other hand White can play for either c5 or g4, for example 12 ...e4?! 13 ♘f2 ♘f6 (after 13 ... c5 14 dc ♘xc6 15 ♗e3! Black has weaknesses on the d-file, Eliskases–Scanarino, Buenos Aires 1962) 14 ♗e3 c5 (trying to stop White on the queenside; 14 ... ♘g6?! 15 ♕d2 ♕e7 16 b4 was very pleasant for White in Petersen–Castagna, Varna Ol 1962) 15 h3 (15 dc bc 16 ♕d2 ♗e6 17 ♖ac1 ♕b8 18 ♖fd1 is probably also somewhat better for White) 15 ... ♔h8 16 ♔h2 ♖g8 and White is slightly better as he can prepare for g4, Clarke–Cobo, Varna Ol 1962.

13 ♗e3 *(34)*

Not **13 fe ?** ♘dxe5 14 ♘f4 ♘xf4 15 ♗xf4 ♘g6 16 ♗e3 ♗d7 17 ♕d2 ♕h4 18 g3?! (18 ♗f2 is equal) 18 ... ♕e7 19 ♗h5 f4! and Black's pieces become very active, Bannik–Suetin, USSR Ch 1962.

After **13 ♗h5** (artificial) 13 ... ♕e7 14 ♖e1 e4 (this makes more sense now as Black will gain time attacking the h5 bishop) 15 ♘f2 c5 16 ♗e3 ♗xc3 17 bc ♕g7 18 ♖c1 ♘f6 19 ♗e2 ♗d7 20 ♔h1 ♘h4 21 g3 ♘f3 22 ♗xf3 ef 23 ♕xf3 ♖ae8 the position was unclear, Reshevsky–Gligorić, Buenos Aires 1960.

34 B



13 ... ef

A safe choice, although 13 ... ♘f6 is also playable:

a) **13 ... ♕e7** 14 ♕d2 e4?! 15 ♘f2 ♘f6 16 ♘b5! (after 16 ♗d4 c5 17 dc bc 18 b4 c5 19 bc dc 20 ♗e3 White has an edge, Reshevsky–Benko, Buenos Aires 1960) 16 ... a6 17 ♘d4 ♗d7 18 ♕a5 with advantage to White according to Boleslavsky.

b) **13 ... ♖e8** 14 ♕d2 ♘b6 15 b3 ef 16 ♘xf4 ♕e7 17 ♗d4 ♗xd4+ 18 ♕xd4 ♕e3+ 19 ♕xe3 ♖xe3 20 ♖ac1 ♗d7 21 ♗h5 with a permanent endgame advantage for White, Szabo–Penrose, Leipzig Ol 1960.

c) **13 ... ♘b6** 14 c5 (14 ♕b3 is safer, with an edge) 14 ... ♘c4 15

♗c1 dc 16 ♘xc5 ♕e7 17 ♘e6!? ♗xe6 18 de ♘b6 19 ♕b3 ♖ae8 20 ♗e3 ♕xe6 21 ♗c5 is complex and unclear, Tal–Savon, USSR Ch 1961.

d) **13 ... ♘f6** and now:

d1) **14 ♖c1** (poor) 14 ... ♘e4 (14 ... ♔h8 15 c5 ♗h6 16 g3 ♕e7 gave White a slight plus in Klüger–Bronstein, Budapest 1961) 15 c5? (15 fe is equal) 15 ... ef 16 ♘xf4 ♘xf4 and Black is better, Baumbach–Vogt, Gorlitz 1972.

d2) **14 fe** de 15 ♕d2 f4! (fighting for the initiative) 16 ♗c5 ♖e8 17 ♖ae1 ♗f5 18 ♕d1 (18 ♗d1 ♗h6 19 ♗c2 b6 20 ♗a3 e4 was good for Black in Lazarev–Zaitsev, USSR 1964) 18 ... ♗h6 19 ♘f2 b6 20 ♗a3 e4 and again Black's pawns have started marching, Bukić–Gufeld, Sarajevo 1964.

d3) **14 c5! ?** (this offers the best chance for White) 14 ... ♖e8 15 cd cd 16 ♕b3 ♔h8 and White has an edge, Schmid–Roessel, Neuhausen 1961.

14 ♘xf4 ♘xf4
15 ♗xf4 a6

It is probably a good idea to prevent the manoeuvre ♘b5–d4, which exerts pressure on the f5 pawn and the weak e6 square.

16 ♕d2 ♕f6

After 16 ... ♘e5 17 ♗h6 ♗xh6 18 ♕xh6 ♗d7 19 ♕d2 ♖f7 20 ♖f2 ♕e7 21 ♖af1 ♖af8 22 b3 Black has no compensation for his broken kingside pawns, Schmidt–Pietzsch, Leipzig Ol 1960.

17 ♖ae1 ♘e5

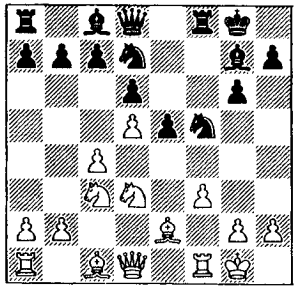
... and according to Boleslavsky and Pachman the position is equal, a view with which I agree since there is little White can do to prevent Black completing his development by ... ♗d7 and ... ♖ae8.

A2

11 ... ♘xf5
12 f3 *(35)*

Consolidating White's grip on his main asset, the e4 square. After 12 ♘e4?! ♘f6 13 f3 ♘d4 14 ♗e3?! c6! 15 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 16 ♘f2 cd 17 cd ♕f7 18 ♗c4 b5 Black had already taken over the initiative in Schmidt–Gligorić, Hamburg 1965.

35
B



12 ... ♘f6

Although other moves have been played, in my view this is the best. Black should aim to open the position up by ... c6 and quickly complete his development by ... ♕b6+ and ... ♗d7. Alternatives:

a) **12 ... ♘d4** 13 ♘e4 b6 14 ♗g5 ♕e8 15 ♗d2 a5 16 ♖e1 ♘xe2+ 17 ♕xe2 h6 18 b3 g5 19 a3 ♕g6 with an unclear position, Reshevsky–Fischer, match 1961.

b) **12 ... c6** (this is also logical and leads to positions similar to those in the main line) 13 ♘f2 cd 14 cd ♕b6! 15 ♔h1 ♘f6 16 ♘fe4 ♗d7 17 ♗d3 ♖ac8 18 ♗g5?! (18 ♕b3 holds the balance) 18 ... ♘xe4 19 ♘xe4 h6 20 ♗c1 ♖f7 with an edge for Black, Toran–Kavalek, Montilla 1975.

c) **12 ... c5** (this solid move is often played; the outpost at d4 balances the e4 square, but Black can sometimes drift into a position without any constructive plan – see for example Hort–Hellers in the next note) 13 ♘f2 ♘f6 (13 ... ♘d4 14 ♖b1 h6 15 ♘fe4 ♘f6 16 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 17 ♗d3 ♗f5 18 ♗e4 ♖f7 19 ♗e3 with an edge for White, Sabatkuhi–B. Toth, Nice Ol 1974) and now:

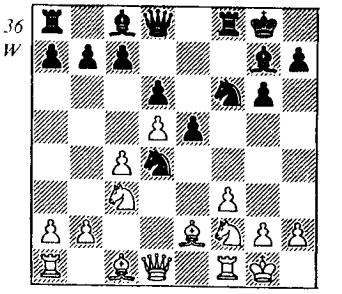
c1) **14 ♗d3** a6 (14 ... ♘d4 15 ♘fe4 a6 16 ♗g5 ♕c7 17 f4? ♘xe4 18 ♗xe4 h6 19 ♗h4 ♘f5 was good for Black in Panno–Mecking, Sao Paulo 1972, but White should have played 16 a4) 15 a4 ♘d4 16 ♗e3 ♘h5 17 ♘fe4 ♘f4 18 ♔h1 ♕c7 19 ♖e1 ♘xd3 and when Black can make this exchange he equalizes, Hort–Penrose, Palma de Mallorca 1969.

c2) **14 ♘fe4** a6 15 a4 ♘xe4 (15 ... ♖b8 16 ♖b1 b6 17 g4! is slightly better for White, Hort–B. Jacobsen, Kapfenburg 1970) 16 ♘xe4 ♘d4 17 ♗d3 and the structure is the same, so I must give this as a little better for White.

13 ♘f2 c6

Better than 13 ... ♘d4 *(36)* (Hort mentions the line 13 ... ♗h6 14 ♗xh6 ♘xh6 15 g4!) and now:

36
W



a) **14 ♘b5** (a very strange move) 14 ... ♘xe2+ 15 ♕xe2 c6 and Black is at least equal, Smyslov–Milev, Havana 1962.

b) **14 ♗e3** ♘h5 (or 14 ... c5 15 a3 ♘h5 16 b4 b6 17 g3 ♘f6 18 ♖b1 ♗f5 19 ♘fe4 h5 20 ♖f2 ♕d7 21 ♗d3 with an edge for White in Schmidt–Micheli, Gstaad 1973) 15 ♘fe4 (15 ♖e1 a6 16 ♗f1 c5 is similar, Dzhindzhihashvili–Geller, USSR 1975) 15 ... ♘f4 16 ♖f2 (such positions are normally assessed as equal, but Hort gives reason to think that White has more chances for active play) 16 ... c5 17 ♗f1 ♕e7 (I don't like this move; Black should try to play ... b5) 18 a3 a5 19 ♖b1 ♗f5 20 b3 b6 21 ♖fb2 g5 22 ♔h1 h5 23 b4! (23 g3 g4!?) 23 ... ab 24 ab cb?! (seriously weakening Black's queenside; 24 ... ♖a7 was better) 25 ♖xb4 g4 26 ♖xb6 gf 27 gf (White is winning now) 27 ... ♖a3 28 ♖b7 ♕d8 29

♗xf4 ♗xe4 30 ♘xe4 ♖xf3 31 ♗g2 ♖3xf4 32 ♕xh5 ♘f5 33 ♘g5 ♖h4 34 ♖xg7+ ♔xg7 35 ♖b7+ 1–0 Hort–Hellers, Wijk aan Zee 1986.

c) **14 ♖e1** c5 15 ♗e3 a6 16 a4 ♘f5 17 ♗d2 ♗h6 18 ♗xh6 ♘xh6 19 g4 ♘f7 20 ♕d2 b6 21 ♔g2 and again White has an edge, Hort–Gligorić, Venice 1971.

d) **14 ♘fe4** ♘h5 (14 ... ♘xe4 15 ♘xe4 ♗f5 16 ♗d3 and 14 ... c5 15 ♗d3 a6 16 a4, Petrosian–Geller, Bled 1961, lead to the usual slight advantage for White) 15 ♗g5 (15 ♖f2 ♘f4 16 ♗f1 h6 17 b4 g5 18 a4 ♖f7 19 ♘b5 is good for White, Mukhin–Listengarten, USSR 1973) 15 ... ♕d7 16 g3 h6 (or 16 ... c5 17 ♘b5 ♘xb5 18 cb ♘f6 19 ♕d2 with White advantage, Tal–Gligorić, Bled 1961) 17 ♗e3 c5!? 18 ♗xd4 ed 19 ♘b5 a6 20 ♘bxd6 d3 21 ♕xd3 ♗d4+ and now the famous game Gligorić–Fischer, Bled 1961, continued 22 ♔g2 ♘xg3! ending in a forced perpetual check. Boleslavsky suggests 22 ♖f2! as clearly better for White, but Fischer does not mention this move in his book of best games. I suspect that White is slightly better after 22 ♖f2.

14 ♘fe4 ♘xe4

14 ... cd 15 cd ♕b6+ 16 ♔h1 ♗d7 transposes to the equal line 12 ... c6, and this may be the most accurate as I cannot see any advantage for Black in delaying the exchange on d5.

15 ♘xe4 ♕b6+

15 ... h6 16 g4 ♘d4 17 ♗e3 cd 18 cd ♕b6 19 ♕d2 ♗d7 was played in Hort–Bukić, Banja Luka 1974, and now 20 ♘c3! is good for White.

16 ♔h1 ♗d7

. . . and Hort assesses this position as unclear, but it seems to me that Black has no problems at all.

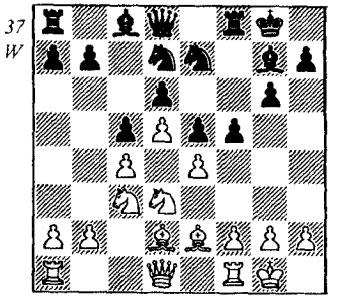
B

11 ♗d2 ♘f6

The usual move, but there are at least four alternatives:

a) **11 ... ♖f7** 12 ♖c1 ♕f8 13 b4 ♘f6 (13 ... ♗h6 14 f4 is dangerous for Black) 14 f3 ♗h6 15 c5 (15 ♘b5 ♗xd2 16 ♕xd2 fe 17 fe ♘xe4 is critical, but 18 ♖xf7?! ♕xf7 19 ♕e3 ♘f6 20 ♘xc7? ♘f5 doesn't work, so White must be satisfied with the unclear 18 ♕e3 ♘f6 19 ♘xc7 ♘f5 20 ♖xf5 ♗xf5 21 ♘xa8 ♕xa8) 15 ... ♗d7 16 ♘b2 ♔h8! 17 ♘c4 ♘eg8 18 ♗xh6 ♘xh6 19 ♕d2 f4 20 a4 g5 21 cd cd 22 h3 ♖g7 23 ♘a5 with a double-edged position, Cebalo–Kir. Georgiev, Baile Herculane 1983. It is surprising that this idea has not been repeated.

b) **11 ... c5** *(37)* with the branch:



b1) **12 f4** a6 13 a4 ef 14 ♗xf4 ♗xc3 15 bc fe 16 ♘e1 ♘f5 17 ♕d2 e3 18 ♕c1 ♕e7 19 ♘c2 ♕e4 20 ♘xe3 ♘d4 21 cd ♖xf4 22 ♖xf4 ♕xf4 23 ♘c2 ♕xc1+ 24 ♖xc1 cd 25 ♘xd4 ♘c5 with a level ending, Ftačnik–Sznapik, Dortmund 1982.

b2) **12 ♗g5** (a very strange and highly dubious idea) 12 ... h6 13 ♗xe7 ♕xe7 14 ♖b1 ♘f6 15 f3 h5 16 ♕e1 ♗h6 17 ♗d1 f4 18 ♔f2 g5 19 h3 g4 20 hg hg 21 ♖h1 ♗g5 22 ♔e2 a6 23 a4 ♕c7, Rogers–Nijboer, Wijk aan Zee II 1989, and Black has the only winning chances.

b3) **12 ♖b1** (this must be the best) 12 ... ♘f6 13 f3 f4 14 b4 b6 15 bc bc and now:

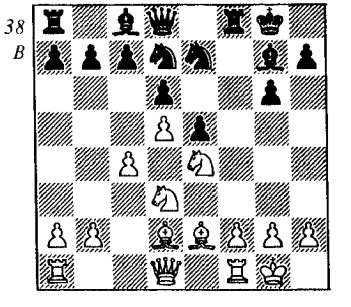
b31) **16 ♕a4** g5 17 ♘f2 h5 18 h3 ♗h6 19 ♖b2 ♔h7 20 ♖fb1 ♖g8 21 ♕d1 ♘g6 22 ♖b8 ♖xb8 23 ♖xb8 ♕e7 24 ♘b5 a6 25 ♘c3 ♘h4 26 ♗e1 ♘xg2 27 ♔xg2 ♗xh3+ 28 ♘xh3 ♖xb8 was very good for Black in Ligterink–Vanheste, Amsterdam OHRA 1988.

b32) **16 ♕e1** g5 17 ♘b5 a5! (preventing ♗a5) 18 ♘f2 h5 19 h3 ♖f7 (19 ... a4! 20 ♕d1 ♖f7 21 ♘c3 ♗d7 is better) 20 ♖b3! (Black cannot save his a-pawn once the rook reaches a3) 20 ... ♗f8 21 ♖a3 a4 22 ♕d1 with a distinct plus for White, P. Littlewood–Britton, British Ch 1983.

b33) **16 ♘b5** g5 (16 ... a6? 17 ♘c3 g5 18 ♘a4 ♘g6 19 ♘b6 ♖a7 20 ♘xc8 was good for White in Sosonko–Schmidt, Holzoster am See 1981) 17 ♘f2 h5 18 h3 ♘g6 19 ♕e1 ♕e7 20 ♗a5 ♘e8 21 ♖b3 ♖f7 22 ♕d2 ♗h6 23 ♖fb1 g4!? 24 fg f3 25 ♕xh6 ♘f4 with a totally unclear position, Sosonko–Nijboer, OHRA B, Amsterdam 1989.

b34) **16 ♖b2!** g5 17 ♘f2 h5 18 h3 ♖f7 (the plan of Ligterink–Vanheste above looks better, since the first rank needs support) 19 ♕a4 ♗f8 20 ♖fb1 ♖g7 21 ♖b8! ♖xb8 22 ♖xb8 ♕c7 23 ♖b3 a6 24 ♘cd1! intending ♗a5, with advantage for White, Rashkovsky–Ermolinsky, USSR 1st League 1981.

c) **11 ... fe** (an important alternative, for if it is good White would have to play 11 f3 instead of 11 ♗d2) 12 ♘xe4 *(38)* and now:



c1) **12 ... ♘f6** (less accurate as Black cannot recapture on f6 with the queen) 13 ♘xf6+! (13 f3 ♘f5 14 ♘df2 ♘xe4 15 ♘xe4 c5 causes no problems) 13 ... ♗xf6 14 ♗c3 ♘f5 15 ♗f3 ♗g7 16 ♗e4 ♕h4! (not 16 ... ♘d4? 17 ♗xd4 ed 18 f4 followed by ♕f3 and ♖ae1) 17 ♖e1 (17 ♕e2 ♗d7 18 g3 ♕e7 19

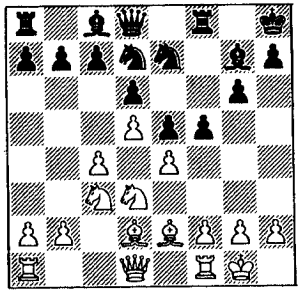
♗g2 ♖ae8 20 ♖ae1 is promising since 20 ... c5? is bad after 21 dc bc 22 c5) 17 ... b6! (not 17 ... ♗d7 18 c5 ♖ae8 19 c6) 18 g3 (Sveshnikov recommends 18 b4) 18 ... ♕g5! 19 ♕c1 ♕xc1 20 ♖axc1 a5 ½–½ Polugayevsky–Tal, match 1980.

c2) **12 ... ♘f5** 13 ♗c3 (13 f3 ♘f6 14 ♘df2 ♘xe4 15 ♘xe4 c6 is equal, while after 13 ♗g4 ♘f6 14 ♗g5 ♕d7 15 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 16 c5 ♗g7 17 ♖c1 ♕f7! 18 cd cd 19 ♗xf5 gf 20 ♘xd6 ♕xd5 21 ♘b4 ♕xd1 22 ♖fxd1 ♖d8 the bishops give Black an edge, Meduna–A.Rodriguez, Prague 1980) 13 ... ♘f6 14 ♗f3 ♘h4 15 ♘xf6+ ♕xf6 16 ♗e4 ♗f5 17 ♕e2 (17 f3 ♕g5 18 ♕e2 ♗h6 19 ♔h1 ♕e3 20 ♕xe3 ♗xe3 21 ♖fe1 ♗h6 22 c5 is a little better for White) 17 ... ♗xe4 (17 ... g5 18 f4! gf 19 ♘xf4 ♗xe4 20 ♕xe4 ♕f5 21 ♕xf5 ♘xf5 22 ♘e6 gave White a clear plus, M.Gurevich–Kupreichik, USSR Ch 1987) 18 ♕xe4 ♕g5?! (18 ... ♕f5 was more accurate, since later Black heads for the same type of position, but only after losing a number of tempi) 19 ♖ad1! ♖f7 (19 ... ♖f3? 20 g3 ♕f5 21 ♕xf5 ♘xf5 22 ♘e1 wins) 20 ♗d2 ♕f6 (20 ... ♕f5 21 f3) 21 b4 ♘f5 22 ♗c3 ♕h4 23 ♕xh4 ♘xh4 with some endgame advantage for White, Ftačnik–Mortensen, Esbjerg 1985.

The conclusion is that 11 ... fe, while solid, leads to a structure which normally gives White a slight advantage.

d) **11 ... ♔h8** *(39)* (this semi-waiting move leaves the knight on d7 so as to force White to prepare c5; in this respect it may appear more logical than the similar line B3 below, which runs 11 ... ♘f6 12 f3 ♔h8, since in that line White can play c5 directly, whereas here he usually has to spend a tempo on b4 or ♕c2; however the negative side of 11 ... ♔h8 is that Black has to play ... f4 very early, which reduces his own options)

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W



12 f3 (12 ♖c1 ♘g8 13 ♕c2 ♘df6 14 f3 f4 15 c5 a6 16 ♘a4 ♗d7 17 ♗a5 ♗xa4 18 ♕xa4 b6 19 cb cb 20 ♗d2 was good for White in Ree–Ligterink, Ter Apel 1987, but 12 ... c5 may be better, hoping to prove that the rook on c1 is poorly placed) 11 ... f4 (Black cannot sensibly delay this; 11 ... ♘g8 is met by 12 f4, while 11 ... ♘f6 transposes to B3) 13 ♖c1 (a similar plan was played in Neverov–Timoshchenko, Tbilisi 1989, but with the important difference that White brought his king's rook to c1, leaving the other rook to operate on the third rank: 13 b4 g5 14 c5 ♘f6 15 ♘f2 h5 16 h3 ♘eg8 17 ♕c2 ♘h6 18 cd cd 19 ♘b5 ♘e8 20 ♖fc1 ♗d7 21 a4 a6 22 ♘a3 g4 23 fg hg 24 hg ♗f6 25 ♘c4 ♗h4 26 ♗e1 ♗g3 27 ♖a3 ♖c8 28 ♕d2 ♔g7 29 ♘h1 ♗xe1 30 ♕xe1 ♘xg4 31 ♗xg4 ♗xg4 32 ♘f2 ♕g5 33 ♘xg4 ♕xg4 34 ♖ac3 ♖d8 35 ♖h3 ♘f6 36 ♘e3 fe 37 ♖g3 ♖c8 38 ♖xc8 ♖xc8 39 ♕xe3 ♖c1+ 40 ♔h2 ♔f7 41 ♕xc1 ♕h4+ 42 ♖h3 ♕xe4 1–0) 13 ... ♘g8 14 b4 (White has to spend this tempo now) 14 ... ♘df6 15 c5 g5 16 cd cd 17 ♘b5 (different move orders are possible, but will probably transpose) 17 ... ♘e8 18 a4 h5 19 ♘f2 ♘h6 20 h3 and now:

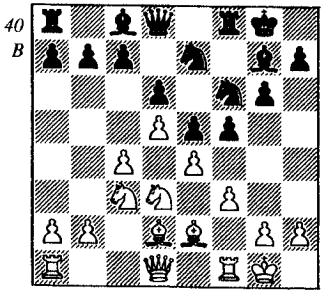
d1) **20 ... ♖f7** 21 ♕c2 ♗f8 22 ♘xa7 (22 a5!? intending 22 ... ♖g7 23 ♘xa7 ♗d7 24 ♘c6 should be met by 22 ... ♗d7!, when 23 ♕b2 ♖g7 24 ♖c3 a6 25 ♘a3 b5!? 26 ab ♕xb6 27 ♖fc1 ♘f6 28 ♖c6! ♗xc6 29 ♖xc6 ♕d8 was totally unclear in L.Hansen–Loginov, Starozagorski Bani 1989) 22 ... ♖c7 23 ♘c6 bc 24 dc ♖h7 25 b5 ♖aa7 26 ♕b3 ♖ag7 27 b6 g4 28 fg hg 29 b7 gh 30 ♘xh3 (the only move as 30 b8♕? hg 31 ♖fd1 ♕h4 32 ♕xc8 fails to 32 ... ♕h1+!) 30 ... ♗xh3 31 ♕xh3 d5 32 ♗a5 ♘c7 33 ♗b6 ♘g8 34 ♕f5 ♗d6 35 ♗f3 (35 ed! wins according to Neverov and Novikov) 35 ... d4 36 ♕c8 ♕h4 37 b8♕ ♕h2+ 38 ♔f2 ♖xg2+ 39 ♗xg2 ♕g3+ 40 ♔g1 ♕h2+ ½–½ Neverov–Loginov, USSR 1985.

d2) **20 ... ♖g8** 21 ♖c3! ♗f8 (or 21 ... a6 22 ♘a3 ♗f8 23 a5 ♘df6 24 ♘c4 g4 25 fg hg 26 hg ♗xg4 27 ♘b6 ♖b8 28 ♘xg4 ♘fxg4 29 ♗xg4 ♖xg4 30 ♕e2 with a slight plus for White) 22 ♕c2 ♗d7 (once again 22 ... g4 doesn't quite equalize after 23 fg hg 24 hg ♗xg4 25 ♘xg4 ♘xg4 26 ♖h3+ ♘h6 27 ♖c1) 23 ♖c1 ♖g7 (delay only makes matters worse; 23 ... g4 24 fg hg 25 hg ♘xg4 26 ♘xg4 ♗xg4 27 ♗xg4 ♖xg4 28 ♗e1 would have been a better chance) 24 a5 g4 25 fg hg 26 hg ♘xg4 27 ♘xg4 ♗xg4 28 ♗xg4 ♖xg4 29 ♗e1 ♕g5 30 ♕e2! with a good game for White, Cebalo–Cvitan, Yugoslav Ch 1986.

It is up to Black to prove that 11 ... ♔h8 is playable, since the above lines, although complicated, seem to be good for White.

12 f3 *(40)*

40
B



There are now three main lines, of which the first two start with 12 ... f4. In the first White tries the recent idea 13 g4!?, which has so

far had excellent practical results. However its theoretical value is less clear. The second is the traditional main line for White. The third features the move 12 ... ♔h8, a relatively untested option for Black, but one which is probably less reliable than 12 ... f4.

B1 12 ... f4 13 g4
B2 12 ... f4 13 c5
B3 12 ... ♔h8

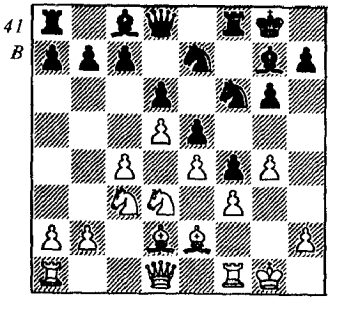
Or 12 ... c5!? 13 g4 (13 ♖b1 transposes into the note to Black's 11th move, line b) 13 ... fg (13 ... ♔h8 14 ♔g2 ♗d7 15 ♘f2 ♘eg8 16 h4 ♖f7 17 ♖h1 fg 18 fg ♕f8 19 ♗e3 gave White a favourable type of Benko system in Akesson–Coleman, London Lloyds Bank 1988) 14 fg h6 (intending ... g5 and ... ♘g6) 15 h4 ♗d7 16 g5 hg 17 hg ♘h7 18 ♖xf8+ ♗xf8 19 ♗g4, Cvetković–Plachetka, Stary Smokovec 1977, and now 19 ... ♘c8! 20 ♗xd7 (20 ♘f2?! ♘b6 21 b3 ♗e7 22 ♘h3 ♘xg5 23 ♗xd7 ♘xd7 24 ♘xg5 ♗xg5 25 ♕g4 ♗xd2 26 ♕xg6+ ♔h8! wins for Black) 20 ... ♕xd7 21 ♕f3 ♘b6 22 b3 ♗e7 23 ♕g3 would have been unclear after 23 ... ♖f8 or 23 ... ♕d8.

B1

12 ... f4
13 g4 *(41)*

13 b4 is dubious because after 13 ... g5 14 c5 ♘g6 15 ♖c1 ♖f7 16 ♘f2 h5 17 h3 ♗f8 18 cd cd 19 a4 ♖g7 Black has a version of the main line in which White has wasted time on b4, which may not be very useful (this may transpose into the note to White's 20th move in line B22).

The logic behind 13 g4 is that the lines with g4 which we will consider in Chapter 6 often run into trouble because of the pressure on e4 and g4. By waiting until Black has played ... f4 before advancing the g-pawn White avoids all these problems. It might seem that 13 ... fg 13 hg is the natural response, but White can develop quickly by ♗e3, ♕d2, ♔g2 and ♖h1, when Black finds it hard to generate any real play on the kingside. The other possibility is 13 ... h5, but as this has only been played twice it is hard to form any clear conclusions. One can only say that 13 g4 offers a new and critical test of Black's whole system. A possible answer is suggested in line B12 below, but more practical experience is necessary.



B11 13 ... fg
B12 13 ... h5

Or 13 ... g5 14 ♗e1 h5 15 h3 ♘g6 (the alternative 15 ... ♔f7 16 ♔g2 ♖h8 17 ♖h1 hg 18 hg ♖xh1 19 ♔xh1 ♘g6 20 ♗f2 ♗d7 21 ♔g2 ♘h4+ 22 ♔f1 ♕e7 23 c5 was also good for White in Vuruna–Hebden, Vrnjačka Banja 1989) 16 ♔g2 (16 ♗f2 is also promising, e.g. 16 ... ♖f7?! 17 ♔g2 ♗f8 18 b4 ♖h7 19 ♖h1 leaves White free to proceed on the queenside, while 16 ... ♔f7 17 ♔g2 ♘h4+ 18 ♗xh4 gh 19 b4 ♖g8 20 c5 ♗f8 21 ♔h2 ♗e7 22 cd ♗xd6 23 ♘a4 b6 24 ♘ab2 followed by ♘c4 gives White some advantage) 16 ... ♖f7 17 a4 hg 18 hg ♘h4+ 19 ♗xh4 gh 20 ♖h1 ♘h7 21 a5 ♘g5 22 ♘f2 a6 23 b4 ♗f8 24 ♕d3 ♖h7 25 ♘h3 ♘xh3 26 ♖xh3 ♗d7 27 ♗d1 ♔h8 28 ♗a4 c6 29 ♖hh1 ♖c8 30 ♔h3 ♗e8 31 ♖hb1 ♕c7 32 ♕d2 ♗f7 33 ♗b3 c5 34 b5 ♖a8 35 ♘a4 with a clear plus for White which eventually proved enough to win, Lutz–Timoshchenko, Budapest 1989.

B11

13 ... fg
14 hg c6

14 ... h5 was played in Tsorbatzoglu–Belli, Thessaloniki Ol 1988, when 15 ♖f2 c6 16 a4 cd 17 cd ♘h7 18 ♘b5 a6 19 ♘a3 ♗f6 20 ♘c4 ♘g5 21 ♖h2 ♖b8 22 a5 ♘f7 23 ♕b3 ♗d7 was unclear. However 18 ♗e3 followed by ♕d2 (preventing ... ♗f6–g5) is better.

After 14 ... c6 White has played three different moves, all with success:

a) **15 a4** a5 16 ♗e3 ♔h8 17 ♕d2 cd?! 18 cd ♗d7 19 ♔g2 ♖f7 20 ♖h1 ♖c8 21 ♘f2 h5 22 ♖a3! was very good for White in Pavlović–Vokac, Trnava II 1988.

b) **15 ♔g2** b5 16 b3 (16 ♘b4 cd 17 ♘cxd5 ♘fxd5 18 cd ♗d7 19 ♖c1 also gave White some advantage in Maksimović–Brustman, Tuzla 1987) 16 ... a5 17 ♖h1 bc 18 bc ♗a6 19 ♘f2 ♖b8 20 ♖c1 ♕b6 21 ♖c2 ♖fc8 22 ♗g5 cd 23 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 24 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 25 ♕xd5+ ♔f8 26 c5 ♖xc5 27 ♖xc5 dc 28 ♗xa6 ♕xa6 29 ♖xh7 1–0 Wilder–Hellers, Haninge 1989.

c) **15 ♗e3** h6 16 ♔g2 g5 17 ♘f2 cd 18 cd ♘g6 19 ♖h1 ♖f7 20 a4 ♗f8 21 a5 ♖h7 22 ♘b5 ♗d7 23 ♘xa7 with an excellent White position, Lutz–Fedorowicz, Porz 1988.

B12

13 ... h5

Condemned by some annotators after a disastrous outing in Lautier–Nunn, Groningen 1988, but in fact the error came later. However, Black players should be warned that playing this move commits them to a piece sacrifice.

14 g5

If the later analysis proves adequate for Black, then White might prefer 14 h3 here. If White is allowed time to consolidate with ♗e1–f2, then Black will end up with the same type of bad position as in Vuruna–Hebden above, so perhaps he should try 14 h3 c6 15

♗e1 (15 a4 a5 followed by ... c5 is drawish) 15 ... b5!? with complications.

14 ... ♘h7
15 h4 ♘xg5

If Black delays then White stops the sacrifice with ♗e1 or ♖f2 and then proceeds with his queenside attack, e.g. 15 ... c6 16 ♗e1 ♖f7 17 ♗f2 ♗h3 18 ♖e1 with advantage for White in the Lautier–Nunn game mentioned above, or 15 ... c5 16 ♖f2 ♗d7 17 b4 cb 18 ♘xb4 a6 19 ♗f1 ♕c7 20 ♗e1 ♖fb8 21 ♖c1 ♘c8 22 ♖b2, Züger–Haba, Prague 1989, and again Black has no counterplay.

16 hg ♘f5

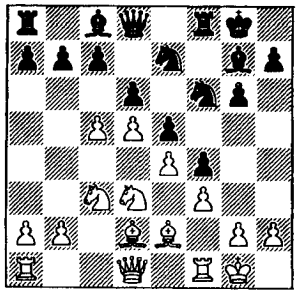
. . . with reasonable compensation for the piece, for example 17 ♖f2 (17 ♗e1? ♘e3) 17 ... ♕xg5+ 18 ♖g2 ♘g3 19 ♘f2 ♕f6 (intending ... g5–g4) and now 20 ♖h2 ♕g5! 21 ♖g2 (21 ♗d3 ♘e2+ 22 ♔f1? ♕g1+ is good for Black) 21 ... ♕f6 is a draw, while 20 ♗d3 g5 21 ♘h1 ♘xh1 22 ♔xh1 g4 and 20 ♘h1 ♘xe2+ 21 ♕xe2 g5 22 ♖h2 ♕g6 followed by ... g4 give Black dangerously mobile kingside pawns.

B2

12 ... f4
13 c5 *(42)*
13 ... g5

The only other option is 13 ... c6 14 cd ♕xd6 15 dc ♘xc6 16 ♘b5 and now:

a) **16 ... ♕d8** 17 ♘b4 ♗e6 18 ♗e1! (to meet ... ♕b6+ by ♗f2; note that 18 ♘xc6 bc loses the b2



pawn after a check at b6 or d4) 18 ... ♖f7 (18 ... ♘d4 19 ♘xd4 is also slightly better for White) 19 ♕xd8 ♖xd8 20 ♘xc6 bc 21 ♘a3 ♗f8 22 ♗c4 and White has the better pawn structure, Cvetković–Pavlov, Trnava 1981.

b) **16 ... ♕e7** 17 ♘b4 ♗e6 (17 ... ♘xb4 18 ♕b3+ is good for White after 18 ... ♘bd5 19 ed or 18 ... ♗e6 19 ♗xb4 ♕f7 20 ♕a3 ♖fd8 21 ♖fc1!) 18 ♘xc6 bc 19 ♘a3 ♘d7 (19 ... ♕c5+ 20 ♔h1 and now 20 ... ♘h5?! 21 ♗c4 ♗xc4 22 ♕c2 ♕e7 23 ♕xc4+ ♖f7 24 ♖fd1 was good for White in Ftačnik–Gufeld, Tallinn 1981; even the superior 20 ... ♖fd8 21 ♕e1 ♖ab8 22 ♗a5 ♖d7 23 ♖c1 ♕e7 24 ♖xc6 ♗xa2 25 ♕c3 and 26 ♗c4 fails to equalize) 20 ♕c2 ♖ab8 21 ♖fc1 ♖fd8 22 ♗a5 ♘b6 23 ♗e1 ♗f8 24 ♗a6 ½–½ Sosonko–Hübner, Wijk aan Zee 1982. White always has a slight theoretical advantage because of the weak c-pawn, but the knight on a3 is badly placed and Black's pieces are active, so in practice

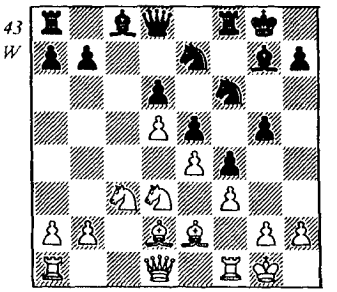
White's task is not easy.

14 cd

There is no reason to delay this capture. 14 ♕c2? g4 15 ♘b5 g3 16 h3 ♘e8 17 ♖fc1 ♘g6 18 a4 ♘h4 19 cd cd 20 ♘c7 ♗xh3 21 gh ♖c8 22 ♘e6 ♖xc2 23 ♘xd8 ♖xd2 24 ♔f1 ♘f6 25 ♘e6 ♘xe4 26 fe f3 0–1, Orgovan–Rajna, Budapest Ch 1984, is a drastic example of the consequences of inaccurate play by White.

14 ... cd *(43)*

Now there is a major division:



B21 15 ♘f2
B22 15 ♖c1

The first line may transpose into the second, so we only consider independent paths under line B21. The main reason for playing 15 ♘f2 is that it allows White to bring his king's rook into play by ♕c2 and ♖fc1, whereas in the main line of B22 the rook gets blocked in at f1. On the other hand the delay in playing ♘b5 sometimes gives Black the chance to hold up White's queenside attack by a timely ... a6.

B21

15 ♘f2 h5
16 h3 ♘g6
17 ♕c2

Or 17 ♕b3 ♖f7 18 ♖fc1 ♗f8 (18 ... g4 19 fg hg 20 hg ♘e8 21 ♗e1 f3!? unclear, Gavrikov–Kuksov, USSR 1979) 19 a4 g4!? 20 fg hg 21 hg ♘h7 22 ♘h3 ♘h4 23 ♘d1 ♖g7 24 ♘df2 ♘f6 25 ♕d1 ♕e8 26 g5 ♕g6 (Votruba gives 26 ... ♗xh3 27 ♘xh3 ♕g6 as slightly better for Black) 27 ♖xc8 ♖xc8 28 ♗g4 ♘xg4 29 ♕xg4 ♖c2 with a very unclear position, Meduna–Bilek, Czechoslovakia 1988.

17 ... ♖f7

Or:

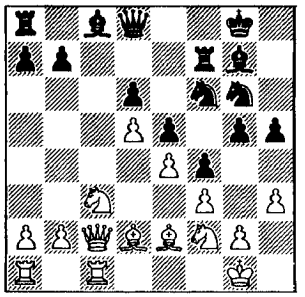
a) **17 ... g4!** ? 18 fg hg 19 hg ♘e8! 20 a4 ♗f6 21 ♘h3 ♗h4 22 ♘d1 ♖f7 23 ♘df2 ♖h7?! (23 ... ♖g7 followed by ... ♘f8 is slightly better for Black according to Möhring) 24 ♖a3 ♘f6 25 a5 ♗d7 26 ♕d1 was Möhring–Uhlmann, Halle 1981, and now 26 ... ♘e8 would have been unclear.

b) **17 ... ♘e8** (the start of a plan designed to bring the g7 bishop to b6 via f6 and d8) 18 a4 ♗f6 19 ♖a3 ♕c7 20 ♖c1 (van der Wiel prefers 20 a5) 20 ... ♗d8 21 ♘b5 (21 a5 ♕h7!?) 21 ... ♕b8?! (21 ... ♕xc2 22 ♖xc2 a6 23 ♘c3 ♗b6 is about equal) 22 a5 a6 23 ♘c3 b6 24 ♘cd1 with an edge for White, Karpov–

van der Wiel, Brussels 1987.

18 ♖fc1 *(44)*

Or 18 a4 ♗f8 (not 18 ... ♗h6 19 ♖a3 ♘h4 20 ♖c1 g4 21 hg hg 22 fg f3 23 ♗xh6 ♘xg4 24 ♘xg4 ♗xg4 25 ♕d2! fe 26 ♘xe2 with a large plus for White, Hort–Maier, West German Ch 1987) 19 ♘b5 g4! 20 fg hg 21 hg a6 22 ♘a3 ♖g7 23 ♖fc1?! (23 ♘c4! ♘h4 24 ♗a5 is a better idea) 23 ... ♘h4 24 ♕d1 ♗xg4! (not 24 ... ♘xg4? 25 ♖xc8) 25 ♘xg4 (25 ♗xg4 ♘xg4 26 ♘xg4 is refuted by 26 ... ♘xg2! 27 ♘h6+ ♔h7 28 ♕h5 ♕h4! 29 ♕xh4 ♘xh4+ and Black wins) 25 ... ♘xg2! (25 ... ♘xg4? 26 ♗xg4 ♕g5?! 27 ♗e6+ ♔h8 28 g4! won for White in Sosonko–Kavalek, Wijk aan Zee 1977, and even 26 ... ♘xg2 27 ♗e6+ ♔h8 28 ♕h5+ ♖h7 29 ♕xh7+ ♔xh7 30 ♔xg2 is good for White) 26 ♖c3 (26 ♔xg2 ♘xg4 27 ♗xg4 ♕h4 28 ♕f3 ♖xg4+ 29 ♔f1 ♖g3 30 ♕f2 f3! wins) 26 ... ♘xg4 27 ♗xg4 ♘e3 28 ♗xe3 ♕h4 29 ♗f2 ♖xg4+ 30 ♔f1 ♕h1+ 31 ♔e2 ♕xe4+ 32 ♔f1 (32 ♔d2!? may be the best chance, but with two pawns and a strong attack for the piece Black has a large advantage) 32 ... ♕g2+! 33 ♔e2 (hoping for a draw, but the central pawns combined with the initiative are worth more than a piece) 33 ... e4 34 ♕f1 (34 ♕g1? e3 wins) 34 ... ♗g7! 35 ♕xg2 ♖xg2 36 ♔f1 ♖h2 37 ♖b3 (37 ♔g1 ♖h5) 37 ... ♖h1+ 38 ♗g1 f3 and Black is winning, Cabrera–Browne, Las Palmas 1977.



18 ... a6

Once again Black has a considerable choice:

a) **18 ... ♗f8** (the usual move with the other rook on c1, but for some reason it has not been played very often in this position) 19 ♘b5 ♘e8 20 ♘xa7 ♗d7 (certainly not 20 ... ♖c7 because after 21 ♗a5 ♖xc2 22 ♗xd8 ♖xe2 23 ♘xc8 the a2 pawn is defended) 21 ♘b5 g4 22 fg hg 23 hg f3! 24 gf ♗xb5 25 ♗xb5 ♖xf3 26 ♕d1 ♖xf2 27 ♔xf2 ♕b6+ 28 ♗e3 ♕xb5 and Black is clearly better, Stean–Hjartarson, Lucerne Ol 1982.

b) **18 ... g4!** ? is possible, e.g. 19 fg hg 20 hg ♘h7 (20 ... ♘e8 and ... ♗f6, as in the the note to Black's 17th, is also playable here) 21 ♘b5 ♘g5 22 a4 ½–½ Sosonko–Kavalek, Tilburg 1980.

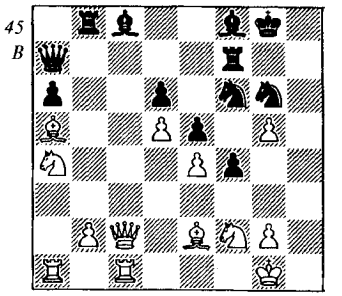
19	**a4**	**♗f8**
20	**a5**	**g4**
21	**fg**	**hg**
22	**hg**	**b5**

Not 22 ... ♘h4? 23 ♘a4 ♖g7 24 ♕d1 f3 25 gf 1–0 Kozul–Gunawan, Sarajevo 1988.

23	**ab**	**♕xb6**
24	**♘a4**	**♕a7**
25	**♗a5**	**♖b8**
26	**g5!** *(45)*	

Better than 26 ♗b6? (26 ♘b6 comes to the same thing) 26 ... ♖xb6 27 ♘xb6 ♕xb6 28 ♕xc8 ♘xe4 29 ♖f1 ♘g3 30 ♔h2? (also not 30 ♖xa6? ♘xe2+ and 31 ... ♕xf2, but even Gipslis's suggestion of 30 ♕xa6 loses after 30 ... ♕e3 followed by ... ♖h7), Ermenkov–Lanka, Jurmala 1978, and now 30 ... ♕xf2! would have caused instant resignation.

After 26 g5! White has the advantage, e.g:



a) **26 ... f3** 27 ♗xf3 ♘g4 28 ♕d2! (threat ♖xc8) 28 ... ♖h7 29 ♗b6 ♖xb6 30 ♖xc8 ♖xb2?! (30 ... ♘xf2 31 ♕xf2 ♖b4 32 ♕xa7 ♖xa7 33 ♖c6 is also miserable for Black, but I suppose he may have some drawing chances) 31 ♕xb2 ♘xf2 32 ♕b6!, Spassov–Danailov, Pamporovo 1981, and White is material up.

b) Spassov recommends **26 ... ♘g4** 27 ♗xg4 ♗xg4, but 28 ♕c6! is very good for White since 28 ... ♗d7 is met by 29 ♗b6, while 28 ... ♖fb7 29 ♘c5! is extremely unpleasant.

c) **26 ... ♘h7** 27 ♘b6 f3 (27 ... ♖xb6 28 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 29 ♕xc8 ♘xg5 30 ♕g4 refutes the attack) 28 ♗xf3 ♖xb6 (26 ... ♗d7 27 ♘xd7 ♖xd7 28 ♗g4 is very good for White) 29 ♗xb6 ♕xb6 30 ♕xc8 ♘xg5 31 ♖xa6 ♕e3? (according to Rogers 31 ... ♕xb2 32 ♕c2 ♕d4 33 ♖a3 would have been only slightly better for White, but I suspect that he is underestimating White's advantage) 32 ♖a3! and White's material plus was decisive, Rogers–Sznapik, Thessaloniki Ol 1988.

Even though the main line eventually turned out well for White, there are a number of interesting Black deviations earlier and I feel that this line does not represent a serious problem.

B22

15	**♖c1**	**♘g6**
16	**♘b5**	

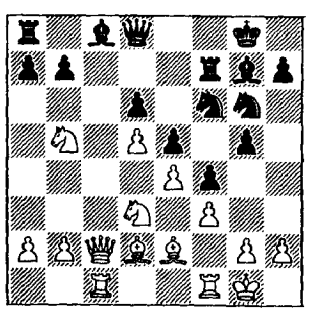
White should probably play this at once for two reasons. Firstly Black may play ... a6, preventing ♘b5 and leaving White with no easy route for the ♘c3 to reach b6 (a4–a5 and ♘a4 is hard to arrange with the rook not on a1), and secondly Black may eventually be able to meet ♕c2 with a move other than ... ♘e8, saving two tempi. An example of the second

point is Zaltsman–Evans, US Ch 1980, which went 16 ♘f2 h5 17 h3 ♖f7 18 a4 ♗f8 19 ♘b5 ♖g7 20 ♖c3 (20 ♕c2 g4 is dangerous) 20 ... ♘h4 21 ♗e1 a6 22 ♘a3 ♗d7 23 a5 ♖c8 24 ♘c4 ♗b5 25 ♘b6 ♖xc3 26 ♗xc3? (26 bc intending c4–c5 was better) 26 ... ♕e8! 27 ♘c4? (27 ♗xb5 ♕xb5 is just an edge for Black) 27 ... ♕g6 with dangerous kingside threats.

16 ... ♖f7

17 ♕c2 *(46)*

Once again ♘f2 exposes White to the unnecessary risk of not forcing ... ♘e8, for example 17 ♘f2 a6! 18 ♘a3 b5 and now Gligoric–Quinteros, Novi Sad 1982, went on 19 ♕e1 h5 20 ♗a5 ♕f8 21 h3 g4 22 fg hg 23 ♘xg4 ♗xg4 24 ♗xg4 ♘xg4 25 hg ♗f6 26 ♕e2 ♗h4 27 ♖c3 ♗g3 28 g5 ♕e7 29 ♕h5 ♕a7+ 0–1.



17 ... ♘e8

Or 17 ... g4 18 ♘c7 gf 19 gf (19 ♗xf3 ♖b8 is unclear) 19 ... ♗h3 20 ♘e6 and now:

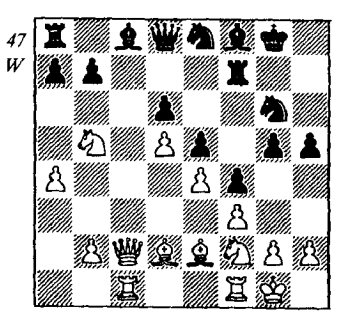
a) **20 ... ♕d7** (20 ... ♕b6+ 21 ♖f2 appears good for White) 21 ♖fd1 ♘h4 22 ♕b3 ♗h6 23 ♔f2! ♔h8 24 ♖c7 ♕e8 25 ♖xb7 ♕g8 26 ♘e1! (not 26 ♖g1? ♕xg1+ drawing) 26 ... ♖xb7 27 ♕xb7 ♖e8 28 ♖c1 with a clear plus for White in Bouwmeester–Navabi, corr. 1971.

b) **20 ... ♕e7** 21 ♖f2?! (21 ♖fd1! should be good for White as in the last note) 21 ... ♗h6 22 ♔h1 (22 ♕b3 ♗xe6 23 de ♖g7 24 ♔h1 ♘h5 is a little better for Black, while 22 ♕c7!? ♗xe6 23 ♕xe7 ♖xe7 24 de ♖xe6 25 ♖c7 is unclear) 22 ... ♔h8, Ftačnik–Ivanov, Hastings 1984, and now the correct 23 ♕c7 would have been similar to 22 ♕c7.

18 a4 h5

19 ♘f2 ♗f8 *(47)*

Or 19 ... ♗d7 20 ♕b3 ♗f6 21 ♖c2 ♕b8 (this plan is similar to Karpov–van der Wiel above) 22 a5 (the plan of attacking d6 adopted by Izeta looks dangerous) 22 ... ♗d8 23 ♘a3 (threat ♗b5) 23 ... a6 24 ♘c4 ♗b5 25 ♖fc1 ♕a7 26 ♗b4 ♗xc4 27 ♖xc4 g4 28 fg f3 29 gh ♘f4 1–0 Izeta–Sahović, Andorra Open 1984.



Here there is another major branch:

B221 20 ♘xa7
B222 20 h3

20 b4?! was played in Rashkovsky–Gufeld, USSR 1978. Not noticing the idea, Gufeld played 20 ... ♖g7, but 21 ♘xa7 ♖c7 22 ♘c6 bc 23 dc proved good for White after 23 ... g4?! (23 ... ♘f6 24 b5 is also bad for Black) 24 fg ♘f6 25 gh ♘h4 26 g3 ♖h7 27 b5! ♘xh5 28 ♕b3+ ♔h8 29 ♗xh5 ♖xh5 30 b6 ♖h7 31 b7 ♖b8 32 c7!. Gufeld suggests 20 ... ♗d7, while 20 ... a6 seems logical to me. Finally what about 20 ... ♖g7 21 ♘xa7 ♗d7? If the knight retreats to b5 Black gains a tempo on B221 below.

B221

20 ♘xa7 ♗d7

This pawn sacrifice is the sharpest continuation, but Black can force an ending in which he can probably equalize by 20 ... ♖c7 21 ♗a5 ♖xc2 22 ♗xd8 ♖xe2 23 ♘xc8 ♖xa4 24 ♘d3 g4 25 ♖f2 ♖e3 26 ♘e1 ♖a8 27 ♖fc2 ♖b3 28 ♔f2 ♖a2 29 ♖b1 ♔f7 30 ♔e2 ♗e7! (better than 30 ... ♗g7 31 ♘d3 ♗f6 32 ♗b6 ♖a8 33 ♗f2 ♗h4 34 ♗g1 ♗d8 35 ♘c1 with advantage to White, Miles–Vukić, Bugojno 1978) 31 ♘xe7 ♘xe7 32 ♘d3 ♖a8 33 ♗xe7 ♔xe7 with equality in Novikov–Glek, USSR 1985.

21 ♘b5 ♖g7

22 h3 ♘h4

22 ... g4 23 fg ♘h4 24 ♗e1 ♕g5 25 ♕d1 (Hillery suggests 25 ♕b3) 25 ... ♗e7 26 b3 ♗d8! 27 ♘a3 ♗b6 28 ♘c4 ♗d4 29 ♗c3 hg 30 hg ♘xg2! 31 ♗xd4 (31 ♔xg2 ♕h4 32 ♕d3 ♗xf2 33 ♖xf2? ♗xg4 wins for Black) 31 ... ♕h4 32 ♖c3! f3! 33 ♖xf3 (33 ♗xf3 ed 34 ♕xd4 ♘f4 is good for Black) 33 ... ♘f4 34 ♗xe5 (34 ♘e3 ♖h7 35 ♖e1 ♕h2+ 36 ♔f1 ♘f6!) 34 ... de 35 ♘e3 ♘f6 36 ♘g2 ♘xg2 37 ♖h3 ♕xh3 38 ♘xh3 ♘xg4 and Black won quickly in van Buskirk–Root, USA 1986, although even this position doesn't look entirely clear-cut. If sound, 22 ... g4 is an important addition to Black's resources, but the final verdict awaits further tests.

23 ♕b3 ♔h8 *(48)*

Or 23 ... g4!? 24 fg hg 25 hg (not 25 ♗xg4 ♘f6 26 ♘c7 ♘xg4 27 ♘e6 ♘xf2! 28 ♘xd8 ♖xg2 mate) 25 ... ♘f6 26 ♘c7! (better than 26 ♗e1 ♘h5! and now 27 gh loses to 27 ... ♖xg2+ 28 ♔h1 ♕g5, so Ftačnik–Sznapik, Baile Herculane 1982, continued 27 ♖c3 ♘g3 28 ♖xg3 fg 29 ♕xg3 ♖xa4 30 ♘c3 ♖a1 with an edge for Black) 26 ... ♘xg4 (26 ... ♗xa4 27 ♕xb7 ♖b8 28 ♕a6 ♖xc7 29 ♗a5 and 26 ... ♗xg4 27 ♘xg4 ♘xg4 28 ♘e6 win for White) and now:

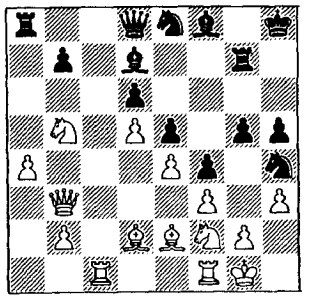
a) Not **27 ♘xa8 ?** ♘e3! 28 ♗xe3 ♖xg2+ 29 ♔h1 ♕g5 30 ♖g1 ♕g3 31 ♗xf4 ♖h2 mate, not **27 ♗xg4** ♗xg4 28 ♘xa8 ♗f3.

b) **27 ♘xg4** ♗xg4 28 ♗xg4 (not 28 ♘xa8 ♗xe2 29 ♖f2 f3) 28 ... ♖xg4 29 ♕h3!? ♖xg2+ 30 ♔h1 is

an interesting idea hoping to take over the initiative by ♘e6 or ♖g1 (Ftačnik).

c) **27 ♘e6** ♘xf2 (27 ... ♗xe6 28 de ♘xf2 29 e7+ ♔h7 30 ef♘+!) 28 ♖xf2 (not 28 ♘xg7 ♘xe4) 28 ... ♗xe6 29 de ♔h8 30 ♖c3 ♗e7 31 ♖h3 and now 31 ... ♕g8 gave White a clear plus in Ftačnik–Vokac, Czechoslovak Ch 1982. Ftačnik suggests 31 ... ♕c7, but I believe that White is still considerably better.

48
W



After 23 ... ♔h8 there are three lines for White:

a) **24 ♖c4** ?!, Ftačnik–F.Portisch, Zalaegerszeg 1979, and now 24 ... ♘f6! would have been good for Black according to Ftačnik, e.g. 25 ♘c7 g4 26 fg hg 27 hg ♘xg4 28 ♗xg4 ♗xg4 29 ♘xg4 ♖xg4 30 ♗e1 (30 ♕h3 ♖g3) 30 ... ♖xg2+ 31 ♔h1 f3 32 ♖xf3 ♕g5! 33 ♖g3 ♕h5! 34 ♖c1 (34 ♖xg2 ♘f3+ and 34 ♖h3 ♕e2 35 ♖xh4+ ♔g8 win for Black) 34 ... ♖c8 35 ♖h3 ♖g4 36 ♕f3 ♗e7 intending to bring the other rook to the kingside, with a very strong attack.

b) **24 a5** g4 (or 24 ... ♘f6 25 ♘c7 g4) 25 fg hg 26 hg (26 ♘xg4 ♘f6!) 26 ... ♘f6 27 ♘c7 ♘xg4 28 ♗xg4 (28 ♘xa8? ♘e3 29 ♗xe3 ♖xg2+ 30 ♔h1 ♕g5 wins) 28 ... ♗xg4 29 ♘xg4 ♖xg4 30 ♖f2? (30 ♗e1! should be met by 30 ... f3! 31 ♖xf3 ♕g5 with an unclear position, rather than 30 ... ♖xg2+ 31 ♔h1 f3 32 ♖xf3 ♘xf3 33 ♕xf3 ♖xb2 34 ♘xa8 ♕xa8 35 ♕h3+ ♔g8 36 ♖c8 and White wins) 30 ... ♕g5 31 ♕h3 (31 ♘xa8 ♖xg2+ 32 ♔f1 ♖xf2+ 33 ♔xf2 ♕g2+ 34 ♔e1 ♘f3+ wins) 31 ... ♖g3 32 ♕h1 ♖c8 and Black wins, Miles–Sax, London 1980.

c) **24 ♖c3** g4 25 fg ♘f6 26 ♕d1 hg 27 hg ♘h5 is dangerous for White and after 28 ♘c7 ♖c8 29 ♘e6 ♗xe6 30 de ♖xc3 31 ♗xc3 ♘g3 32 ♘h3 ♕b6+ 33 ♔h2 ♕e3 Black was slightly better in Frias–Wilder, New York Open 1984.

B222

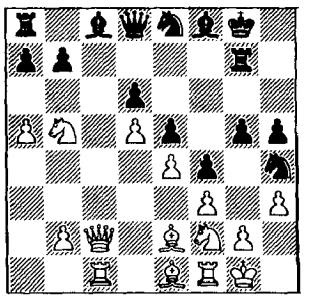
20	**h3**	♖g7
21	**♕b3**	

There are two other possibilities:

a) **21 ♘xa7** ♖c7 (21 ... ♗d7 is likely to transpose to B221 above) 22 ♗a5 ♖xc2 23 ♗xd8 ♖xe2 24 ♘xc8 ♖xa4 (better than 24 ... ♖xb2 25 a5 ♔f7 26 ♖c3 ♘e7 27 ♘d3 ♖b5 28 ♖fc1 ♘xc8 29 ♖xc8 ♖xc8 30 ♖xc8 ♗e7 31 ♗b6 and the weak b7 pawn gives White good winning chances, Ftačnik–Lanc, Trnava 1984) 25 ♘d3 (the only difference from line B221 is that White's pawn is on h3 instead of h2) 25 ... g4 26 ♖f2 ♖e3 27 ♘e1 g3 28 ♖fc2 ♖b3 29 ♔f1 ♖a2 30 ♖b1 ♔f7 31 ♔e2 ♖a8 32 ♘d3 ♗e7 33 ♗xe7 ♘xe7 34 ♘xe7 (34 ♖bc1 ♘g6 is unclear) 34 ... ♔xe7 35 ♖bc1 ♔d7 and Black was at least level in Averkin–Kasparov, USSR 1979.

b) **21 a5** ♘h4 22 ♗e1 *(49)* and now:

49
B



b1) **22 ... ♗d7** 23 ♕b3 ♗e7 (the moves of this game are virtually impossible to understand) 24 ♖c3 ♗f8 (this looks like a good moment for the ... ♕b8 and ... ♗d8 plan since the rook on c3 obstructs White's support for a5) 25 ♖c2 ♔h7 26 ♖c3 (just about the only move I do follow – if Black ever plays ... g4 White wants to swap lots of times on g4 and play ♖h3, but what happens if Black goes back to g8?) 26 ... ♔h8 27 ♕d1 a6?! (Sveshnikov recommends ... ♔g8 both here and on the last move) 28 ♘a3 ♕xa5 29 ♖c8 ♕xe1 30 ♖xa8! ♕b4 31 ♘c4 ♕c5 32 ♕d2 b5 33 b4 and White won in Polugayevsky–Tal, match 1980.

b2) **22 ... ♔h8** (this appears more logical because 23 ♕b3 may now be met by 23 ... ♘f6) 23 ♕c3 ♗d7 24 ♕b3 ♘f6 (once Black succeeds in playing this without allowing a crushing ♘c7 he is usually doing well) 25 ♕d1 (I don't understand this game either!) 25 ... g4 26 hg hg 27 ♘xg4 (27 fg f3 28 gf ♘xf3+ 29 ♗xf3 ♗xb5 is promising for Black) 27 ... ♘h5! 28 ♘c7, Torre–Rodriguez, Toluca 1982, and now 28 ... ♖c8 29 ♘e6 ♗xe6 30 de ♖xc1 31 ♕xc1 ♘g6! followed by ... ♘g3 would have been good for Black according to Rodriguez.

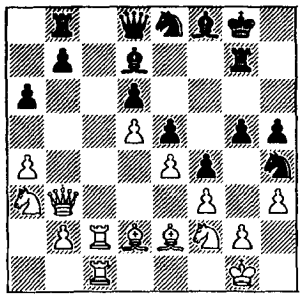
21	**...**	**♘h4**

Black adopted an unusual move order in Ftačnik–Pecorelli, Trencianske Teplice 1985, and after 21 ... ♗d7 22 ♖c2 a6 23 ♘a3 g4 24 fg ♘h4 25 a5 ♘f6 26 ♕b6 hg 27 ♕xd8 ♖xd8 28 hg ♘xg4 29 ♘xg4 ♗xg4 30 ♗xg4 ♖xg4 31 ♗e1 he should have played 31 ... ♗e7 instead of 31 ... ♖d7? 32 ♗xh4 ♖xh4 33 ♖c8 with a good ending for White. However, I believe that White would still have a slight advantage.

22	**♖c2**	**a6**
23	**♘a3**	**♘f6**

Or 23 ... ♗d7 24 ♖fc1 (24 a5 g4 25 fg transposes to the last note) 24 ... ♖b8 *(50)* and now:

a) **25 ♘c4** g4 26 fg b5 27 ab (27 ♘a5 ba 28 ♕a2 ♕g5 29 ♘c6 ♖b3



30 ♖c3 ♘f6 is dangerous for White) 27 ... ♗xb5 (not 27 ... ab? 28 ♘a5 followed by ♘c6) 28 ♕a3 (not 28 ♗a5 ♕g5 29 ♘a3 ♘xg2! 30 ♔xg2 ♗xe2 31 ♕xb8 hg 32 hg ♗xg4 and wins) 28 ... ♕f6 (28 ... ♖bb7? 29 ♘a5 ♗xe2 30 ♘xb7 ♖xb7 31 ♗a5 wins for White) 29 ♗e1 ♕g5 and now:

a1) **30 g3** fg 31 ♕xg3 ♗e7 32 ♖a1! ♘f6! 33 ♘e3 ♕f4 (33 ... hg 34 ♘exg4 ♗xe2 35 ♖xe2 ♘h5 36 ♕e3 ♘f4 37 ♖c2 may be slightly better for White) 34 ♕xf4 ef 35 ♘f5 ♘xf5 36 ef ♗xe2 37 ♖xe2 hg 38 hg ♘xd5 39 ♖xa6 f3! 40 ♖d2 ♘e3 with a likely draw, Kaunas–Lanka, USSR 1979.

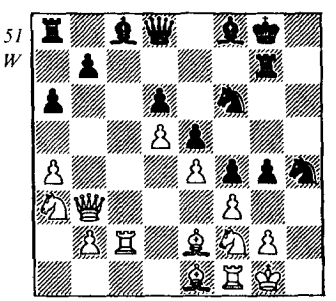
a2) **30 ♗d1!** (unpinning the knight to prepare ♘d2–f3) 30 ... ♗d7 31 ♘d2 ♘f6 32 ♘f3 ♘xf3+ 33 gf ♕h4!? 34 ♘d3 ♕xh3 (34 ... ♕g5 35 ♖g2 wins) 35 ♖h2 hg 36 ♖xh3 gh+ 37 ♔h1 ♘h5 38 ♗a4 ♗c8 (38 ... ♗xa4 39 ♕xa4 ♘g3+ 40 ♔h2 ♘f1+ 41 ♔xh3 ♖h7+ 42 ♗h4 is also winning) 39 ♗f2 ♘g3+ 40 ♔h2 ♘e2 41 ♖xc8! ♖xc8 42 ♘e1 and Black's attack proved inadequate in Lekander–Barwinski, corr. 1985. One tactical finesse can completely reverse the verdict on such a line, so it is hard to give a definite opinion, but certainly Black needs an improvement to make 23 ... ♗d7 playable.

b) **25 a5** (25 ♗e1 b5! 26 ab ab shuts the knight on a3 out of play since 27 ♘xb5? loses to 27 ... ♕b6) 25 ... ♘f6 26 ♗e1 (after 26 ♖c7 ♘e8 White should return since 27 ♖xb7 ♖xb7 28 ♕xb7 may be met by 28 ... ♘xg2 or 28 ... ♗xh3) 26 ... ♔h8?! (the immediate 26 ... g4 is better) 27 ♘c4 g4 28 fg hg 29 hg ♘xg4 30 ♗xg4 ♗xg4 31 ♘xg4 ♖xg4 32 ♕h3 ♕g5 33 ♘b6 ♖d8 34 ♗xh4 ♖xh4 35 ♕f3 ♖g4 36 ♕h3+ ♖h4 37 ♕f3 ♖g4 38 ♕h3+ ½–½ Ivkov–Marjanović, Bled–Portorož 1979.

24 ♗e1! g4
25 hg

Ftačnik suggests 25 fg!? without analysis. 25 ♘xg4 hg 26 ♗xh4 gh 27 ♖f2 ♖h7 looks dangerous for White.

25 ... hg *(51)*



After the odd move 25 ... ♕e8 the continuation 26 ♘c4 hg 27 fg ♘xg4 28 ♘xg4 ♗xg4 29 ♗xg4 ♖xg4 30 ♘b6 ♖d8 31 ♕h3! was good for White in Litinskaya–Levitina, USSR 1983.

26 ♘xg4

Or 26 fg ♘h5 27 ♘h1 ♗xg4 28 ♗xg4 ♖xg4 29 ♕h3 ♕g5 (this is the same as the next note except for the extra knights on the h-file; needless to say, this difference greatly favours Black) 30 ♗xh4 ♖xh4 31 ♕e6+ ♔h8 32 ♖f3 ♖g4 33 ♘c4 ♗e7 34 ♘xd6 ♗xd6 35 ♕xd6 ♖g8 36 ♘f2 ♖xg2+ 37 ♔f1 ♖h2 38 ♔e2 ♘g3+ 39 ♔d3 ♖h6 40 ♕a3 ♕h5 41 ♔d2 ♘f1+ 42 ♔c1 ♘e3 43 ♖h3 ♖g1+ 44 ♔d2 ♘f1+ 0–1 Anaya–Crespo, corr. 1985.

26 ... ♘h5!

The most dangerous move; 26 ... ♘xg4 27 fg ♗xg4 28 ♗xg4 ♖xg4 29 ♕h3 is likely to be slightly better for White.

27 a5

27 ♘c4 ♘g3 28 ♗xg3 (28 ♘b6 ♘xf1 29 ♘xa8 ♘g3 gives Black good play for the pawn) 28 ... fg 29 ♕b6 (29 ♖fc1 ♘xf3+ 30 gf ♕h4 is dangerous) and now 29 ... ♕e7 30 ♘ce3 ♖h7 31 ♖fc1 ♘g6 32 ♖c7 was good for White in van Dyck–Chapman, corr. 1989. However Black has many other possibilities, e.g. 29 ... ♗e7 30 ♕xd8+ ♗xd8 31 a5 (31 ... b5 was a threat) 31 ... ♗xg4 32 fg ♖c8 33 ♖c3 b5! with complications.

27 ... ♘g3

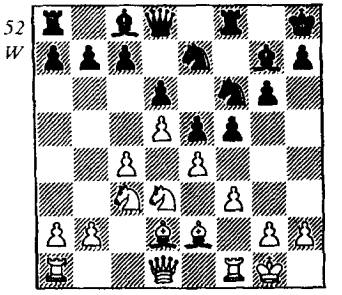
28 ♗xg3 fg 29 ♕b6! (not 29 ♕e3 ♖h7 30 f4 ♘f5 31 ef ♕h4 and wins) ♕e7 30 ♖fc1 ♗xg4 31 fg ♘g6 32 ♗f3 ♕h4 33 ♔f1 ♘f4! 34 ♖c7! ♖xc7 35 ♖xc7 ♗h6 36 ♘c4 (36 ♕g1 ♕h2 37 ♘c4 ♖f8 38 ♘xd6 ♘e2! wins for Black) 36 ... ♖f8 (Polgar recommends 36 ... ♘xg2! 37 ♗xg2 ♖f8+ 38 ♔e1 ♕h2 with a strong attack, but Ftačnik improves this line by 37 ♕g1! ♘f4 38 ♘e3 ♘h3 39 ♘f5 with equality) 37 ♘xd6 ♘xg2 38 ♘f5! ♕h1+ 39 ♔e2 ♕e1+ 40 ♔d3 ♕d2+ 41 ♔c4 ♕c2+ 42 ♔b4 ♕xb2+ 43 ♔c4 ♕c2+ and Black is better, but White eventually escaped with a draw, Ftačnik–Zsu. Polgar, Trencianske Teplice 1985.

One concludes that line B22 is satisfactory for Black and this opinion seems to be shared by others, for recently White players have switched to other lines.

B3

12 ... ♔h8 *(52)*

A semi-waiting move; Black prepares ... ♘eg8 and ... ♗h6, while keeping open the option of playing ... f4 later.



13 ♖c1 *(53)*

White responds with a flexible move of his own. The alternatives are:

a) **13 b4** ♘eg8 (13 ... c6 14 ♖c1 transposes into the note to Black's 13th move) 14 ♖c1 ♗h6 15 c5 ♗xd2 16 ♕xd2 f4 17 cd cd 18 ♘f2 (18 ♘b5 ♕b6+ 19 ♘f2 ♗d7 is equal) 18 ... g5 19 ♘b5 ♘e8 (not 19 ... ♖f7? because 20 ♕c3 threatens both ♘c7 and ♘xa7) 20 ♖c3 ♘gf6 21 ♖fc1 ♗d7 (White has only a faint edge) 22 a4 ♖g8 23 ♘c7 ♘xc7 24 ♖xc7 ♖b8 25 a5 a6 26 b5 ab 27 ♕b4 ♗c6 28 ♖f7 ♗e8 29 ♖fc7 ♗c6 with equality in Ermolinsky–Gufeld, USSR 1981.

b) **13 g4** c6 14 ♔h1?! (as so often in lines with g4, White must prevent ... b5 by playing a4) 14 ... b5! 15 b3 (15 g5 ♘h5 16 cb cd 17 ed is unclear) 15 ... ♖b8 16 a3 a5 17 ♘f2 b4 18 ab ab 19 ♘a2 fe 20 fe cd 21 cd, Polugayevsky–Gufeld, Sochi 1981, and now 21 ... ♘fxd5 22 ed ♘xd5 would have given Black good compensation for the piece, e.g. 23 ♗f3 ♗b7 24 ♗g5? ♖xf3! 25 ♗xd8 ♘e3 or 23 ♘e4 ♗b7 24 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 25 ♗f3 ♖a8 26 ♘g5 h6 27 ♘e6 ♕f6.

c) **13 c5** dc 14 ♘xc5 c6! is not recommended since 15 dc loses a piece to ... ♕d4+.

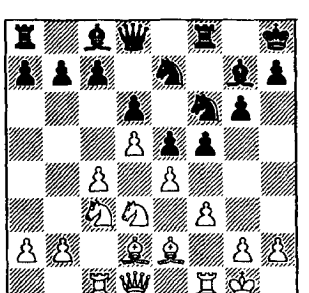
d) **13 a4!** ? with another branch:

d1) **13 ... a5** 14 g4 c5 (14 ... c6!? is possible) 15 ♖f2 b6 16 h4 ♖a7 17 ♖h2 ♔g8 18 h5 fg?! (Black should try 18 ... f4, playing for a draw by blockade) 19 fg gh 20 g5 ♘e8 21 ♗xh5 ♘g6 22 ♘b5 ♖b7 23 ♗g4 with an edge for White, Kozul–Gufeld, Tbilisi 1988.

d2) **13 ... c6** 14 a5 cd?! (opening lines for White; 14 ... ♘eg8 intending ... ♗h6 was better) 15 cd ♘eg8 16 ♘f2! ♗h6 17 ♗xh6 ♘xh6 18 ♕d2 f4 19 ♖fc1 (White has gained time over Ermolinsky–Gufeld in line a above) 19 ... g5 20 h3 ♘hg8 21 ♘b5 ♘e8 22 ♖c2 ♘gf6 23 ♖ac1 and White is better, Kozul–Pavlović, Yugoslavia 1988.

d3) **13 ... f4** ?! (this makes no sense, because the resulting positions resemble B22 above, but of the extra moves a4 and ... ♔h8 White's is much more useful) 14 c5 g5 15 ♖c1 (15 cd! would prevent Black's next move and leave White with a favourable version of line B22) 15 ... c6 16 cd ♕xd6 17 dc ♘xc6 18 ♘b5 ♕e7 19 ♕e1 (White keeps a slight advantage in any case) 19 ... a6 20 ♖xc6! bc 21 ♗b4 ♕d8 22 ♘d6 ♗e6 23 ♕c3 a5 24 ♗a3 ♘d7 25 ♕xc6 ♕b6+ 26 ♕xb6 ♘xb6 27 ♘c5 and White is a little better, Conquest–Botterill, British Ch 1986.

53
B



13 ... c5

a) **13 ... ♘eg8** 14 c5 (14 g4 fg 15 fg h6 16 h4 ♘xg4! 17 ♗xg4 ♕xh4 leads to a draw) 14 ... ♗h6 15 cd cd 16 ♘f2 a6 17 a4 ♗xd2 18 ♕xd2 f4 19 ♘b1 (White's method of conducting the queenside attack is very odd) 19 ... g5 20 ♘a3 h5 21 a5 g4 and Black has good counterplay, Barlov–Lenz, Graz Open 1987.

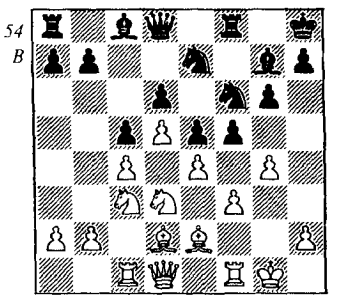
b) **13 ... c6** (this is probably the best move) 14 b4 (14 dc transposes to the next note, but perhaps 14 a4 should be considered even though the rook may not be well placed at c1) 14 ... b5 15 dc (other lines are worse, e.g. 15 cb cd 16 ed ♘exd5, 15 c5 cd 16 cd ♕xd6 17 ♘xb5 ♕b6+ 18 ♘f2 de and 15 ♕b3 bc 16 ♕xc4 cd 17 ed ♕b6+ 18 ♔h1 ♗b7 are all bad for White, while 15 ♗e3 bc 16 ♘b2 cd 17 ed ♗b7 18 ♗xc4 a5 19 b5 ♖c8 20 ♕b3 f4 21 ♗f2 ♘f5 was at least equal for Black in Michelet–Troffiguer, corr. 1985) 15 ... bc (15 ... ♕b6+ 16 c5 dc 17 bc ♕xc6 18 ♗e3 leaves Black's queenside weak) and now:

b1) **16 ♘f2** ♘xc6 17 ♗xc4 (17 b5 ♘d4 18 ♗xc4 ♗b7 19 ♗g5 ♖c8 20 ♕d3 ♕a5 was already a little better for Black, Spassov–Zsu. Polgar, Bulgaria 1981) 17 ... ♘d4! (17 ... ♘xb4? 18 ♘b5 ♘c6 19 ♗g5 is unpleasant) 18 ♘d5 ♗b7 19 ♗e3 ♘xd5 20 ♗xd5 ♗xd5 21 ed ♕b6 22 ♗xd4 ed 23 ♘d3 ♖ac8? (23 ... ♕b5 24 ♕b3 ♖ac8 25 a4 ♕b7 26 ♖c6! ♖xc6 27 dc ♕xc6 28 ♖c1 gives White an edge, but 23 ... a5!? 24 ♖c6 ♕b5 25 a4! ♕xd5 26 b5 is unclear) 24 ♖xc8 ♖xc8 25 ♕a4! ♗h6!? 26 f4 ♕b7 27 ♖e1 and White is slightly better, Frias–Sznapik, Thessaloniki Ol 1984.

b2) **16 ♘b2** ♘xc6 (16 ... fe 17 fe ♕b6+ 18 ♔h1 ♕xb4 19 ♘xc4 ♘xc6 20 ♘d5 ♕b8 21 ♖b1 ♗b7 22 ♘xf6 ♗xf6 23 ♘xd6 with perhaps an edge for White) 17 ♘xc4 ♘d4 18 ♗e3?! (White should challenge the knight by 18 ♗d3 ♗e6 19 ♘e2, with an unclear position), Ftačnik–P. Littlewood, Hastings 1982/3, and now 18 ... ♗e6! 19 a3 ♖c8 would have given Black the advantage.

14 g4 *(54)*

54
B



Or 14 dc ♘xc6 (better than 14 ... bc 15 ♗e3 ♕e8 16 ♕a4 ♗e6 17 ♖fd1 fe 18 fe ♘g4 19 ♗xg4 ♗xg4 20 ♖d2 ♗e6 21 b3 ♖f7 22 ♘f2 ♘c8 23 ♖cd1 ♘b6 24 ♕a5 ♗f8 25 c5 with a clear plus for White, Hübner–Nunn, Bundesliga 1985) 15 ♗e3 ♗e6 16 b3 ♘d4 17 ♘f2 ♘h5 18 ♖e1 ♘f4 19 ♗f1 ♗g8 20 ♘e2 ♘fxe2+ 21 ♗xe2 fe 22 ♘xe4

d5 23 cd ♗xd5 24 ♗c4 ♗xe4 25 fe ♖c8 26 ♕d2 ♕h4 27 ♗d5 ♖xc1 28 ♖xc1 b6 29 b4 ½–½ Schacht–Schubert, Bundesliga 1985.

After 14 g4 Black may play:

a) **14 ... ♗d7** 15 ♘f2 ♘eg8 16 ♔h1 f4 17 b4! b6 (17 ... cb 18 ♘b5 ♕b6 19 ♗xb4 a6 fails to 20 c5!) 18 ♘b5!? a6 19 ♘a3 ♘e8 20 ♖b1 ♕h4 21 ♗e1 h5 22 ♘d3 ♕f6 (22 ... ♕h3 23 ♘f2 repeats) 23 h3 hg 24 hg ♘h6 25 bc bc 26 ♖b6 (this gives Black a useful tempo, so 26 ♖b2 is better) 26 ... ♕d8 27 ♖b2 ♗f6 with an unclear position, Ftačnik–Geller, Sochi 1977.

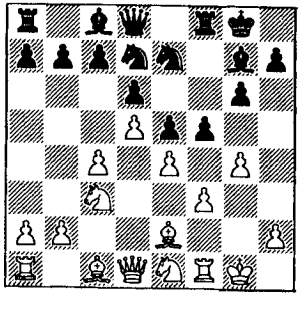
b) **14 ... ♘eg8** 15 ♔g2 ♘e8 (15 ... f4 16 h4 ♘xg4 17 fg ♕xh4 18 ♗e1 ♕g5 19 ♘f2 h5 20 ♘h3 ♕f6 21 gh g5 22 ♘f2 is good for White) 16 g5 f4 17 h4 ♖f7 18 ♖h1 ♗f8 19 ♕g1 ♘g7 20 ♗d1 ♘h5 21 ♘e2 h6 (21 ... ♗g7 22 ♗a4 ♘e7 23 b4 b6 was much better, with just an edge for White) 22 ♔f1 ♗e7 23 ♗a4 hg 24 hg ♗xg5 25 ♗e8! (I had completely overlooked this move) 25 ... ♖g7 26 ♗xg6 ♖xg6 27 ♖xh5+ ♔g7 28 ♗c3 ♕e7 29 ♖c2 ♗h6 30 ♕h2 ♔h7 31 ♘exf4! ef 32 ♘xf4 ♕f7 33 ♖f2 ♖f6 34 ♗xf6 ♕xf6 35 ♖g2 ♕d4 36 ♕g3 ♕d1+ 37 ♔f2 ♕d4+ 38 ♔e1 ♗f5 39 ♖xf5 ♕e3+ 40 ♖e2 1–0 Ftačnik–Nunn, Vienna Open 1986. This game was awarded the brilliancy prize.

Although the lines above give no clear evidence against 12 ... ♔h8, I have the feeling that it is less reliable than 12 ... f4. Nevertheless it may be recommended to those who do not wish to learn a whole mass of theory.

6 9 ♘e1 ♘d7 10 ♘d3 f5 11 g4

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**c4**	**g6**
3	**♘c3**	**♗g7**
4	**e4**	**d6**
5	**♘f3**	**0-0**
6	**♗e2**	**e5**
7	**0-0**	**♘c6**
8	**d5**	**♘e7**
9	**♘e1**	**♘d7**
10	**f3**	**f5**
11	**g4** *(55)*	

55
B



This line, which we shall call the Benko System, appears to contradict one of the basic rules of chess, namely that one shouldn't advance pawns where one is being attacked. This rule applies particularly in the case of an attack on the king, such as Black often develops in this variation of the King's Indian. Nevertheless in this special situation there is logic behind White's plan. He intends to block the kingside completely, whereupon play can only take place on the other wing, where the pawn structure gives White the advantage. For example, if Black plays 11 ... f4, then White will reply 12 h4, meeting ... g5 by h5 and ... h5 by g5. Similarly 11 ... h5 by Black is met by 12 g5. If Black exchanges on e4 or g4 then his attacking chances are reduced and White may even play g5 and ♗g4 later, blocking in the g7 bishop and exchanging off his own bad bishop. Nevertheless the move 11 g4 is risky, since if Black can avoid the blockade and open the position up then White will have cause to regret his pawn advance. A second point is that White's pieces tend to become tied down to the defence of e4 and g4, which often impedes normal development.

These days there are two main lines. The first is 11 ... ♘f6, usually followed by ... c6, whereby Black opens the position in an attempt

to prove that White is over-extended. The second plan, which has become very popular recently, is 11 ... ♔h8. This multi-purpose move aims firstly to play 12 ... ♘g8 and 13 ... ♗h6, and to prevent this White may play ♘g2 and h4, when the reserve plan of ... ♘g8-f6 and ... ♘c5 comes into operation. The knight on c5 needs to be secured with ... a5, but despite this slight loss of time the resulting pressure on e4 is awkward for White, who also needs to defend g4. Note that this plan should only be used in response to ♘g2, for otherwise the knight on c5 can be eliminated by ♘d3.

A 11 ... f4
B 11 ... h5
C 11 ... ♘f6
D 11 ... ♔h8

Or:

a) **11 ... c6** (if White replies with a developing move this will probably transpose to line C after a later ... ♘f6, but we give a couple of independent examples) 12 dc (12 ♗e3 cd 13 cd a5 14 ♘d3 b6 15 ♔g2 ♘c5 16 h4 ♗d7 17 ♘f2 ♘c8 18 ♖h1 ♗f6 19 g5 ♗e7 20 ef ♗xf5 21 ♕d2 is good for White, Gipslis–Wittmann, Jurmala 1978) 12 ... ♕b6+ (12 ... ♘xc6 is the only consistent move; if then 13 ♕xd6 ♘d4 gives some play for the pawn) 13 ♖f2 ♕xc6 14 ♘d3 fg 15 fg ♘f6 16 c5! ♗e6 (16 ... ♘xe4 17 ♘b4 wins after 17 ... ♘xc3 18 ♕b3+ or 17 ... ♕xc5 18 ♕b3+ and 19 ♘xe4) 17 cd ♕xd6 18 ♗e3 b6 19 g5 ♘h5 20 ♘b5 ♕c6 21 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 22 ♘f2 ♘f4 23 ♗f1 with advantage to White, Knaak–Westerinen, Jurmala 1978.

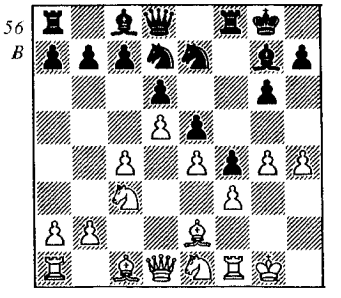
b) **11 ... a5** (the remaining 11th move options are dubious and should be avoided) 12 ♘d3 (12 ♗e3 f4 13 ♗f2 g5 14 ♘d3 b6 15 a3 h5 16 gh ♘f6 is fine for Black, Taimanov–Ivkov, USSR–Yugoslavia 1962) 12 ... ♘c5?! 13 ♘xc5 dc 14 ♗e3 b6 15 ♘b5! fe 16 fe ♖xf1+ 17 ♗xf1 and White's plan has worked perfectly, Kagan–Stoppel, Havana Ol 1966.

c) **11 ... fg ?!** (releasing the tension so early also plays into White's hands) 12 fg ♖xf1+ 13 ♔xf1 h6 (13 ... ♘f6 14 ♘d3 c5 15 ♗e3 ♗d7 16 ♔g1 ♔h8 17 ♔h1 ♕c7 18 g5 ♘fg8 19 ♘b5, Portisch–Attard, Madrid 1960, is clearly better for White) 14 h4 ♘f6 15 g5 ♘h7 16 ♗e3! ♕d7 17 ♔g1 ♕h3 18 ♘g2 hg 19 hg, Ghitescu–Bolbochan, Varna Ol 1962, is a good example of bad play by Black. His knights are passive and White has a big space advantage.

A

11 ... f4
12 h4 *(56)*

Other moves do not block the kingside and are therefore usually dismissed as being inconsistent with White's plan, e.g. 12 ♗d2 g5 13 ♘d3 h5 14 h3 ♖f6 15 ♔f2 ♖h6 16 ♖h1 ♘g6 17 ♕g1 ♘f6 18 ♔e1 c5, Portisch–Gligorić, Madrid 1960, or 12 b4 g5 13 ♘d3 h5 14 h3 hg 15 hg ♘f6 16 c5 ♘g6 17 a4 ♖f7 18 a5 ♗f8 19 ♖a2 ♖h7, Debarnot–Simón, Spain 1975, are usually given as at least equal for Black. However, a comparison with line B2 of Chapter 5 shows a marked similarity, and in some cases a direct transposition can occur. Black's main advantage here is that his knight is still on d7, restraining White's c5 and allowing ... ♖f6-h6 to be played. Therefore Black's play in Portisch–Gligorić is much more logical than in Debarnot–Simón. I would assess the former as roughly equal and the second as better for White. However this discussion is rather academic since the main line is promising for White.



12 ... c5

A number of other moves have been tried without altering the general assessment that Black cannot achieve anything on the kingside, while White still has chances on the other flank:

a) **12 ... ♔f7** 13 ♘g2 ♗f6 14 ♗d2 c6 15 ♖b1 cd 16 cd ♘g8 17 ♗e1 h5 18 g5 ♗e7 19 b4 with a clear plus for White, Gipslis–Klüger, Lublin 1972.

b) **12 ... ♔h8** 13 ♗d2 ♗f6 14 ♘g2 ♘g8 15 ♗e1 ♖f7 16 b4 h5 17 g5 ♗e7 18 ♗f2 ♖h7 19 ♔h2 ♗xg5 (desperation) 20 hg ♕xg5 21 ♖h1! ♕e7 22 ♘h4 ♖h6 23 ♔g2! and Black has little for his sacrifice, Gipslis–Anerbayev, USSR 1972.

c) **12 ... a5** (this may hold White up for a little while, but cannot change the basic structure) 13 ♘g2 ♘c5 14 ♗d2 ♔h8 15 ♗e1 ♗d7 16 ♗f2 and now White is ready to advance on the queenside, Benko–Eliskases, Buenos Aires 1960.

d) **12 ... ♘f6** (this makes much more sense when the pawn is still on f5) 13 ♗d2 c6 was played in Langeweg–Casa, Lugano Ol 1968, and now the simple 14 ♘d3 gives White his usual advantage. However I cannot resist giving the rest of this game, which also serves as a warning to White players that they have moved all the pawns in front of their king and so cannot totally ignore the possibility of a sacrificial breakthrough: 14 b3?! cd 15 cd ♗d7 16 a4 ♖c8 17 ♘d3?! (asking for it . . .) 17 ... ♗xg4! 18 fg ♖xc3 19 ♗xc3 ♘xe4 20 ♗e1 ♕b6+ 21 ♘f2? ♘g3 22 ♖a2 e4 23 a5 ♕e3 24 ♗c4 ♗e5 25 b4 ♘e2+! 26 ♖xe2 ♕g3+ 27 ♔h1 f3 28 ♘xe4 ♕h3+ 29 ♔g1 ♕xg4+ 30 ♔h1 ♕h3+ 31

♔g1 ♘f5! 32 ♘f6+ (I'm not sure what this is for) 32 ... ♖xf6 33 ♖xf3 ♕xf3 34 ♕d3 ♗d4+ (missing a chance for some gold coins by 34 ... ♕f1+! 35 ♔xf1 ♘e3+) 35 ♔h2 ♘e3 36 ♗g3 ♘f1+ 37 ♔h3 ♘xg3 38 ♕xf3 ♖xf3 39 ♖e8+ ♔f7 0–1.

13 a3

White has a good deal of flexibility, since the stable pawn structure is unlikely to change in the near future. 13 ♗d2 ♔h8 14 ♘g2 ♘g8 15 ♗e1 ♘h6 16 ♕d3 was similar in Clarke–Najdorf, Havana Ol 1966.

13 ... ♔h8

14 ♗d2 ♘g8 15 ♘g2 ♗f6 16 ♗e1 ♗e7 17 b4 ♘gf6 18 ♘a4 ♘e8 19 bc (it doesn't seem necessary to release the tension so quickly; Black has no constructive plan so White can afford to improve his position by ♗f2 followed by developing his queen and rooks) 19 ... ♘xc5 20 ♘xc5 dc 21 ♗c3 ♗d6 22 ♕d2 and White still has an edge, Benko–Pachman, Portorož 1958.

B

11 ... h5

12 g5

Once again the blockading move is best. After 12 gf (12 h3 hg 13 hg may be met by 13 ... f4 as in line A, note to Black's 12th move, or by 13 ... ♘f6!?) 12 ... gf 13 f4 ef Black has an excellent position, e.g. 14 ♗xh5 ♘f6 or 14 ♗xf4 ♘g6.

12 ... h4

This is the point of Black's last move. If White is allowed to play h4 the kingside will be permanently blocked, so Black aims to isolate the g5 pawn by ... h4 and ... f4, then round it up.

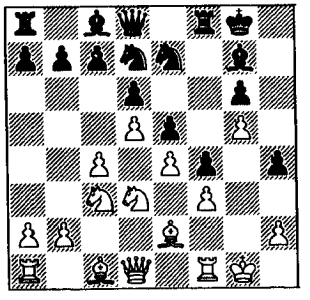
13 ♘d3

White's answer is to develop his queenside play as fast as possible, so that Black will have no time to win the g5 pawn. 13 ♔h1!? f4 14 ♖g1 ♔f7 15 b4 ♖h8 16 c5 ♘f8 17 ♗a3 is an alternative method which was also good for White in Cuellar–Yépez, Caracas 1973.

13 ... f4 *(57)*

Black intends ... f4, ... ♔f7, ... ♖h8–h5 and, if necessary, ... ♘g8. Perhaps it is not surprising that it is all too slow. After 13 ... ♔f7 14 c5! f4 15 ♕b3 b6 16 cd cd 17 ♕a3 White was clearly better in Sanguinetti–Szmetan, Argentine Ch 1974.

57
W



14 ♔h1

14 ♕e1?! is a mistake, because after 14 ... ♔f7 White doesn't really want to take the pawn on h4;

Wade–Reshevsky, Buenos Aires 1960, continued 15 ♔h1 ♖h8 16 ♖g1 ♘f8 17 c5 ♗d7 18 b3 ♖h5 and Black can be happy with his position.

14 ... ♔f7

15 c5

Even the less active 15 ♗d2 ♖h8 16 ♖g1 ♘g8 17 b4 ♖h5 18 c5 ♘f8 19 ♖c1 ♗d7 20 ♘xf4! ef 21 ♗xf4 ♕e7 22 ♕d2 ♘h7 23 ♗e3 h3 24 ♗d3 was very good for White in Weinstein–R. Byrne, US Ch 1963/4.

15 ... ♖h8

After 15 ... ♘xc5 16 ♘xc5 dc 17 ♕b3 ♔e8 18 ♖d1! or 15 ... dc 16 ♕b3 ♔e8 17 ♕a4 ♔f7 18 ♕c4 White has a massive attack for the pawn, while after 15 ... b6 16 c6 ♘c5 17 ♘f2 a5 18 ♖b1 followed by b3, a3 and b4 Black is going to be completely paralysed.

16 ♕b3

White has a choice of very promising lines. After 16 ♘b5!? ♘f8 (16 ... dc 17 ♕b3 and 16 ... ♘xc5 17 ♘xc5 dc 18 b4! are horrible for Black) 17 ♗d2 followed by ♖c1 Black's queenside is crumbling.

16 ... b6

Or 16 ... ♘g8 17 cd cd 18 ♖g1 ♖h5 19 ♘b5 ♗f8 20 ♗d2 a6 21 ♕a3 ♘b6 22 ♗a5! ab 23 ♗xb6 ♖xa3 24 ♗xd8 ♖a8 25 ♗c7 with a very good ending for White in Cheremoson–Anikayev, USSR 1966.

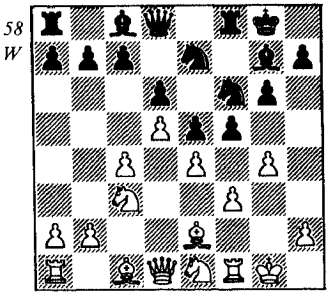
17 cd cd

18 ♕a3 ♘c5 19 ♘xc5! dc 20 b4! cb 21 ♕xb4 ♗h3 22 ♖g1 ♖b8 23 ♘b5 ♘c8 24 ♗a3 ♗f8 25 ♕c4 ♗e7 26 ♕c7! with a clear plus for White, Larsen–Tal, match 1965.

C

11 ... ♘f6 *(58)*

58
W



12 ♘d3

The critical move, but there are two alternatives:

a) **12 ♗e3** (this generally transposes to one of the other lines after a subsequent ♘g2 or ♘d3, but we give a couple of independent examples) 12 ... f4 (12 ... ♗d7 13 ♔h1 ♕c8 14 ♖g1 f4 15 ♗f2 g5 16 c5 ♕e8 17 ♕b3 was good for White in Koblents–Kirilov, USSR 1966) 13 ♗f2 g5 14 ♘d3 ♘g6 15 b4 h5 16 h3 ♘h4 17 ♖e1 hg 18 hg ♘xg4 19 fg f3 20 ♗f1 ♗xg4 was unclear in Probst–Albrecht, Biel 1974, but I would assess this line as good for White if he misses out time-wasting moves and plays 15 c5 directly. Therefore Black should continue with 12 ... c6 transposing back to the main line.

b) **12 ♘g2** c6 13 ♗e3 (13 ♖b1 cd 14 cd ♗d7 15 ♗e3 f4 16 ♗f2 g5 is

equal according to *ECO*, while 13 h4 is met by 13 ... cd 14 cd ♕b6+ and if 15 ♗e3 Black can probably take on b2) 13 ... f4 14 ♗f2 g5 15 h4?! (15 ♕d3! intending dc and ♖fd1 is better, when 15 ... h5 16 h3 hg 17 hg c5 is unclear) 15 ... gh 16 ♘xh4 h5 17 ♔g2?! (17 ♘f5 hg 18 fg cd 19 cd would have kept Black's advantage to a minimum) 17 ... cd 18 cd hg 19 fg b5! and Black had a dangerous initiative in Bertok–F. Portisch, Virovitica 1977.

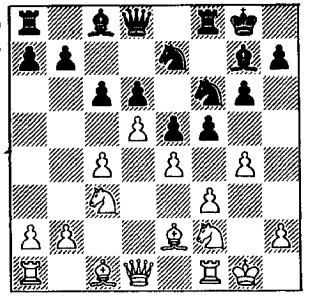
12 ... c6

Or 12 ... h6!? 13 h4 (13 c5 fg 14 fg g5 followed by ... ♘g6–f4 is fine for Black) 13 ... c6 14 ♘f2 a6! 15 ♗e3 (either here or on the next move White should play a4, when Black still has to prove that ... h6 is useful) 15 ... ♔h8 16 ♔g2?! b5! 17 dc ♘xc6 18 g5! (18 cb ♘d4 is a reasonable pawn sacrifice) 18 ... ♘h5 19 gh ♗f6 20 ♘d5! ♗xh4 21 cb ab (21 ... ♘d4 22 ♗xd4 ed 23 ♕xd4+ ♗f6 24 ♘xf6? ♘f4+! wins, but 24 ♕e3 ♗e5 25 f4! ♘xf4+ 26 ♘xf4 ♕g5+ 27 ♘g4! is good for White) 22 ♖c1 with a very sharp and unclear position in Zaichik–Podgayets, USSR 1978.

13 ♗e3

After the alternative 13 ♘f2 *(59)* (not 13 ♔h1? fg 14 fg ♘xg4! losing a pawn, Ghitescu–Timman, Wijk aan Zee 1974) Black has a wide choice:

a) In this and similar positions Black can choose to play for a draw by **13 ... a6! ?** 14 a4 (or else ...



b5 is awkward) 14 ... a5 followed by ... c5 blocking the queenside. This is an argument for keeping the knight on d3, when ... c6 and ... b5 can often be met by ♘b4.

b) **13 ... ♔h8** 14 ♔g2 (14 ♗d2 a5 15 a3 ♗d7 16 ♖b1 ♕b8 17 b3 ♖f7 18 ♕c1 ♕c7 19 b4 ab 20 ♖xb4 ♖af8 was equal in Taimanov–Kavalek, Montilla 1977) 14 ... ♕c7 15 ♗e3?! (15 ♗d2 makes more sense) 15 ... ♗d7 16 h4 ♖f7 17 ♖c1 ♖af8! 18 ♗d2 (countering the threat of 18 ... fg 19 fg ♗xg4! 20 ♘xg4 ♘xg4 when e3 hangs) 18 ... fg 19 fg cd 20 cd ♕b6! 21 ♘h3! (21 ♕b3? ♘fxd5!) 21 ... h6 22 g5 ♗xh3+ 23 ♔xh3 hg 24 hg ♘h7 25 ♖xf7 ♖xf7 26 ♕g1! ♕xb2 27 ♕e3 ♘g8 is unclear, Lukacs–Sznapik, Baile Herculane 1982.

c) **13 ... a5** 14 ♔g2 (just as in the note to Black's 12th move, White should play a4 at some point) 14 ... ♔h8 15 h4?! b5! (not 15 ... cd 16 cd ♗d7 17 a4 and Black's queenside is weak) 16 dc (16 cb cd 17 ed ♗b7 and 16 g5 ♘h5 17 cb cd 18 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 19 ♕xd5 ♖b8 are unclear) 16 ... bc 17 ♗xc4 (17 c7 ♕xc7 18 ♘b5 ♕c5 19 ♕xd6 ♕xb5 20 ♕xe7 fg 21 fg ♘xg4 22 ♘xg4 ♖xf1 23 ♔xf1 ♗xg4 24 ♗xg4 c3+ is good for Black) 17 ... ♘xc6 18 ef gf 19 g5 ♘h5 20 ♗d5 ♖a6 21 f4 ♘xf4+ 22 ♗xf4 ef is slightly better for Black, Kozlov–Boudy, Varna 1979.

13 ... ♔h8

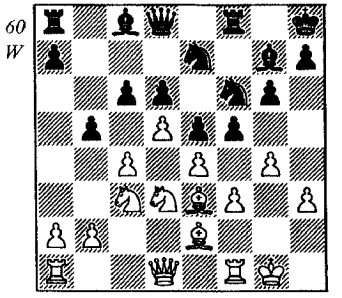
After other options Black is often reduced to taking on d5, but creating an open file on the queenside without any special reason usually favours White:

a) **13 ... ♗d7** 14 ♖c1 cd 15 cd ♔h8 16 ♘f2 ♘eg8 (or 16 ... ♘fg8 17 ♕b3 b6 18 ♔g2 ♗h6 19 ♘b5 with a slight advantage for White, Podgayets–Mista, Ybbs 1968) 17 ♕b3 f4 18 ♗d2 h5 19 h3 ♘h7 20 ♔g2 ♕h4 21 ♖h1 ♘h6 22 ♗e1 ♕e7 23 ♘cd1 ♖ac8 24 ♖c3 ♖xc3 25 ♘xc3 ♗c8 26 ♘b5 with advantage to White, Farago–Visser, Dortmund Open 1986.

b) **13 ... f4** 14 ♗f2 g5 15 h3 (15 c5 appears more critical) 15 ... c5 (15 ... cd leads to line c) 16 ♖b1 h5 17 b4 b6 18 bc bc 19 ♕a4 a6 was unclear in Lukacs–Hazai, Hungarian Ch 1974.

c) **13 ... cd** 14 cd f4 (14 ... ♗d7 will transpose to line a) 15 ♗f2 g5 16 a4 (16 ♔g2 h5 17 h3 ♘g6 18 ♖g1 hg 19 hg ♘h4+!? 20 ♗xh4 gh 21 ♖h1 ♘h7 22 ♕b3 ♘g5 23 ♘f2 ♖f7 24 a4 ♗f6 25 a5 ♗d7 26 ♕b4 ♕f8 led to a roughly balanced position in Okhlin–Korolev, corr. 1987) 16 ... h5 17 h3 ♔f7 (17 ... ♘g6 18 a5 a6 19 ♘a4 hg 20 hg ♗xg4 21 fg ♘xe4 22 ♗f3 ♘f6 23 ♘c3 was good for White in Donner–Ree, Wijk aan Zee 1970) 18 a5 ♖h8 19 a6 ba, Gipslis–Bukić, Olot 1973, and now 20 ♘b4! favours White according to Gipslis.

14 h3 b5 *(60)*



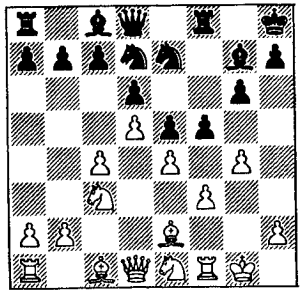
15 ♘b4!

Pinter's innovation is stronger than 15 c5 (15 dc bc 16 ♘b4 ♗e6! is fine for Black) 15 ... cd 16 cd ♘c6! (not 16 ... d4? 17 de ♕xe7 18 ♗f2 dc 19 ♗c5, but 16 ... ♕xd6 17 ♗c5 ♕d7 18 ♘xe5 ♕c7 19 ♗d4 ♘c6 20 ♘xb5 ♕b8 21 ♘xc6 ♕g3+ draws according to Pinter) 17 ed ♘d4 18 f4 (or 18 ♘xe5 ♘xe2+ 19 ♕xe2 b4! and Black is better) 18 ... ♘xe2+ 19 ♕xe2 e4 20 ♘e5, Pinter–Mortensen, Helsinki 1983, and now 20 ... b4 21 ♘b5 (21 g5 ♘h5! only adds the threat of ... ♘g3) 21 ... ♘xd5 22 ♖ad1 (22 ♗c5? ♘xf4) 22 ... ♗b7 followed by ... a6 gives Black the edge according to Mortensen.

After 15 ♘b4! Black cannot equalize, e.g. 15 ... bc (15 ... cd 16 ♘bxd5 ♘exd5 17 ♘xd5 ♗b7 18 ♘xf6 ♕xf6 19 cb is clearly better for White, Pinter–Sznapik, Prague 1985) 16 ♘xc6 ♘xc6 17 dc ♗e6 18 ♕a4 fe 19 fe d5 20 ♗c5 with a slight plus for White, Pinter–Mortensen, Copenhagen 1985.

D

11 ... ♔h8 *(61)*


61 W

In my view this is a logical move, although some opening books frown on it. Black's worst placed piece is his knight on e7 and by moving it to g8 Black prepares both ... ♗h6 and an assault on the weak e4 pawn by ... ♘c5 and ... ♘g8–f6.

12 ♘g2 *(62)*

One of many possible moves:

a) **12 ♘d3** and now:

a1) **12 ... f4** (completely illogical) 13 ♗d2 g5 14 ♖c1 ♖f7 15 b4 ♘f6 16 c5 ♘g6 17 ♖f2 ♗f8 18 ♕b3 with some advantage for White, Mecking–Bouaziz, Sousse 1967, since White's queenside attack is in full swing while Black has no counterplay on the other flank.

a2) **12 ... ♘g8** 13 ♔h1 (13 ♗e3 f4 14 ♗f2 h5 is fine for Black after 15 ♕e1 ♗f6 16 h4 g5 or 15 ♔h1 ♗f6 16 ♕e1 ♖f7) 13 ... a5 15 ♖g1 ♖f7! 15 g5 f4 16 ♗f1 ♗f8 17 b3 ♗e7 18 ♘b5 b6 (not 18 ... ♗xg5? 19 ♘xc7) 19 ♗h3 ♘c5 20 ♗xc8 ♘xd3 21 ♕xd3 ♕xc8 22 ♕f1 h6 23 gh g5 24 a3 ♖h7 25 ♖a2 ♖xh6 and Black is at least equal, Vaganian–Uhlmann, Nikšić 1978.

a3) **12 ... c5** 13 ♔g2 ♘g8 14 ♗e3 ♗h6 15 ♗f2 ♗g5 16 ♕e1 fg 17 fg ♘df6 18 h3 h5 19 gh ♘xh5 20 ♗xh5 gh 21 ♕e2 ♘f6 22 ♗e3 ♗h4 23 ♔h2 ♕d7 24 ♖f3 ♕h7 with equality, Agzamov–Lanka, USSR 1979.

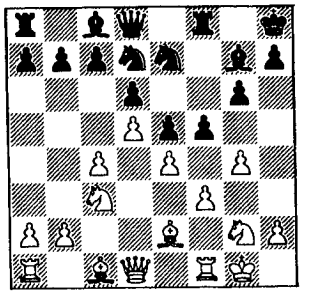
b) **12 h4** ♘g8 13 g5 h6 14 ♔g2 f4 15 ♖h1 ♖f7 16 ♘d3 ♗f8 17 ♕g1 was better for White in Gipslis–Muchnik, USSR 1970. A better reply to 12 h4 is 12 ... ♘f6 followed by ... c6, as in the Pinter games above, when White has not only wasted a tempo on h4, he has also deprived himself of the chance to support g4 by h3.

c) **12 ♗e3** ♘g8 13 ♕d2 and now:

c1) **13 ... ♘df6** 14 h3 h5 15 ♔g2 ♘h7 (15 ... fg 16 fg hg 17 hg ♗xg4 18 ♗xg4 ♘xg4 19 ♖h1+ ♗h6 20 ♗xh6 ♘8xh6 21 ♖xh6+ ♔g7 22 ♖h3! ♖f2+ 23 ♕xf2 ♘xf2 24 ♔xf2 is very good for White) 16 ♘d3 hg 17 hg ♘gf6 18 ♕d1! ♕d7 19 ♘f2 f4?! 20 ♗d2 ♗h6 21 ♖h1 ♔g7 22 b4 ♘g5 23 ♔f1 ♕e7 24 ♖c1 ♗d7 25 c5 with advantage for White, Pinter–Krum Georgiev, Warsaw 1987.

c2) **13 ... a6** (13 ... ♕h4 14 ♗g5 ♗h6 15 ♗xh4 ♗xd2 16 ♘b5 is good for White) 14 ♘g2 f4 15 ♗f2 h5 16 h3 (not 16 gh? g5! and now Black is slightly better, Pinter–Nunn, Dubai Ol 1986) 16 ... ♗f6 17 ♔h2 ♖f7 18 ♖h1 ♖h7 19 ♔g1 hg (it is also possible to delay this exchange, for example by 19 ... a5 holding up b4, with just an edge for White) 20 hg ♕e7 21 ♖xh7+ ♕xh7 (now the position appears somewhat better for White, but this may be deceptive as it is far from easy for White to bring his remaining rook to the h-file) 22 b4 ♗e7 23 ♖c1 ♘df6 24 ♘e1 ♗d7 25 ♔g2 ♕h6 26 ♕d1 (White is held up since 26 ♘d3 allows 26 ... ♗xg4!) 26 ... ♕g5 27 ♔f1 ♖f8 28 ♘d3 ♖f7 29 ♔g2 ♖h7 30 ♕g1 ♘h6 31 ♔f1 ♘hxg4! 32 fg ♘xg4 33 ♗xg4 ♗xg4 34 ♔e1 ♖h3 and Black is much better, Shrentzel–Gallagher, Tel Aviv 1988.

c3) **13 ... f4** 14 ♗f2 h5 (this is the most logical; Black gains time and develops his bad bishop to an active position) 15 h3 (the point is that 15 h4 doesn't block the kingside because of 15 ... g5) 15 ... ♖f7 16 ♔g2 ♗f6 17 ♘d3 ♖h7 18 ♖h1 ♗h4! 19 ♗d1 ♘f8 20 c5 ♗xf2 21 ♕xf2 g5 and with black-squared bishops exchanged Black is not worse, Jacimović–Vukić, Kastel Stari 1988.


62 B

12 ... a5

The problem with 12 ♘g2 is that while the knight is on e1 White has the option of ♘d3, but now Black's d7 knight is given free access to c5. This, coupled with ... ♘g8–f6, will exert uncomfortable pressure on e4 and g4. Other plans have turned out well for White, e.g. 12 ... ♘g8 13 h4 ♘df6 14 ef gf 15 g5 ♘h5 16 f4 ♘xf4 17 ♘xf4 ef 18 ♗xf4 ♗d7 19 ♕d2 ♕e7 20 ♗f3, Vasilik–Gipslis, USSR 1963, or 12 ... ♘f6 13 ♗d2 c5 14 ♖b1 ♗d7 15 ♔h1 ♕c7 16 a3 ♖f7 17 ef gf 18 g5 ♘h5 19 f4 ♘xf4 20 ♗xf4 ef 21 ♗h5 ♖ff8 22 ♘xf4, Bilek–Stein, Stockholm 1962, with the same type of advantage for White in both cases.

13 h4

Without this move White cannot play ♗e3 because of the reply ... f4 followed by ... h5.

13 ... ♘c5

14 ♗e3 ♘g8

Black's correct plan is not to touch the kingside pawns, since

any change he might make will favour White by either releasing the tension or blocking the position. Nor can White improve his own kingside set-up, for example 15 g5 is met by 15 ... f4 16 ♗f2 h6, strong here because a white rook cannot quickly reach the h-file. In Zilberstein–Petrushin, USSR 1979, White released the tension himself by 15 ef gf 16 g5 but after 16 ... f4 17 ♗xc5 dc 18 ♘e4 ♘e7 19 ♘xc5 ♘f5 20 ♘e4 ♖a6 21 ♗d3 ♖g6 22 ♖f2 h6 Black had a very strong attack for the pawn.

15 ♖b1

Since there is a stalemate on the kingside, White decides to start a queenside pawn advance. We now follow the game Pinter–Nunn, Thessaloniki Ol 1988, which is characteristic of this variation.

15 ... ♗d7

After 15 ... ♘f6 White may reply 16 ef gf 17 g5! ♘h5 18 f4 and Black's c8 bishop is blocked in. Therefore I decided to wait for a better moment before playing ... ♘f6.

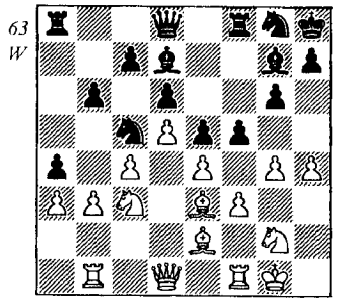
16 b3

White cannot play 16 a3 because of 16 ... a4, not only blocking the queenside but also preparing ... ♘b3–d4. Other moves are bad, e.g. 16 ♕d2 fg 17 fg ♘f6 forking e4 and g4, forcing White to play the horrible ♗xc5.

16 ... b6

Anticipating the next move, which might result in an open b-file. 16 ... ♕c8 was about equally good, but 16 ... fg is dubious after 17 fg ♖xf1+ 18 ♔xf1 ♘f6 19 ♗f3 ♕c8 (19 ... h5 20 gh gh 21 ♗g5 is also good for White) 20 g5 ♘g4 21 ♗g1 and Black's g7 bishop has no future.

17 a3 a4! *(63)*



It is unusual for Black to take the initiative on the queenside in the King's Indian. Here it is justified because White has heavily committed himself on the other side of the board, so if Black can open up the position or deflect some of White's pieces from the kingside then White's king will be exposed. The move ... b6 is useful in that the b7 pawn is not en prise and White cannot easily play b4 and c5. White is already worse, but it is hard to pinpoint a definite error; perhaps the whole idea of g4 and ♘g2 is doubtful.

18 b4 ♘b3

If White allows ... ♘d4 he won't be able to keep his kingside pawn structure intact, for example 19 ♖b2 ♘d4 20 ♖d2 ♕c8 and now White will have to take on f5.

19 ♘b5 ♘f6

20 ef

20 g5 (20 gf gf opening the g-file is a disaster) 20 ... ♘h5 threatens 21 ... f4 followed by ... h6, or 21 ... ♘g3 followed by ... fe.

20 ... gf

21 ♘c3

An unfortunate necessity. There was a threat of 21 ... f4 22 ♗f2 e4 (this is also the answer to 21 h5), while 21 g5 f4! (not 21 ... ♘h5 22 f4 unclear) 22 gf (22 ♗f2 ♘h5) 22 ... ♗xf6 23 ♗f2 (23 ♗d2 ♘xd2 24 ♕xd2 ♗xh4 followed by ... ♖g8 is crushing) 23 ... ♖g8 24 ♔h2 (24 ♖e1 ♗h3 25 ♗f1 ♖xg2+ 26 ♗xg2 ♕g8 27 ♔f1 ♕xg2+ 28 ♔e2 e4 wins) 24 ... ♖xg2+ 25 ♔xg2 ♗xh4 26 ♖h1 (26 ♖g1 ♕g5+ 27 ♔f1 ♗h3+ wins) 26 ... ♕g5+ 27 ♔f1 ♗xf2 28 ♔xf2 ♕g3+ 29 ♔f1 ♖g8 wins for Black.

21 ... e4!

22 g5

After 22 fe ♘xg4 23 ♗xg4 fg the pawn on e4 is very weak, while 22 gf ♗xf5 23 fe ♘xe4 24 ♘xe4 ♗xe4 results in a weak h4 pawn and an exposed white king.

22 ... ♘h5

Attacks c3, threatens ... f4 and prevents 23 f4 because of 23 ... ♘g3 winning the exchange. 22 .. ef 23 gf ♕xf6 24 ♖xf3 ♕xc3 25 ♗xb6 is less promising.

23 fe f4

This pawn sacrifice gives Black the advantage, but other players might have preferred 23 ... ♘g3 24 ♖f3 ♘xe2+ 25 ♘xe2 fe, when the two active bishops give Black a positional plus.

24 ♗d2

Taking on f4 loses a piece, while 24 ♗xh5 fe 25 ♕d3 (25 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 26 ♕c2 ♕f2+ wins a piece) 25 ... ♘d2 26 ♖xf8+ ♕xf8 27 ♖d1 ♕f2+ 28 ♔h1 ♗h3 29 ♘xe3 ♕xh4 is a winning attack for Black.

24 ... ♘xd2

25 ♕xd2 ♕e8

This simple continuation gives Black an unopposed black-squared bishop and an outpost on g3; more than enough for a pawn.

26 ♗f3

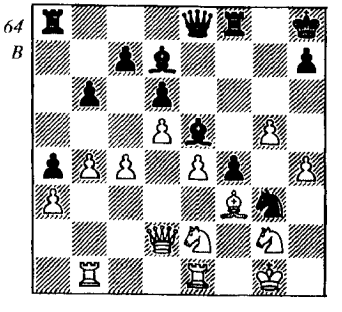
Not 26 ♗xh5 ♕xh5 27 ♖xf4 (or else ... f3) 27 ... ♖xf4 28 ♘xf4 ♕xh4 and the kingside falls apart.

26 ... ♘g3

27 ♖fe1 ♗e5

28 ♘e2 *(64)*

White must remove the strong knight, or else Black can improve his position by ... ♕g6–g7 and ... ♖ae8, with ...h6 to come later.



28 ... ♘xe4!

28 ... ♕f7 was tempting, with the idea 29 ♘xg3 fg 30 ♖f1 ♕xf3! 31 ♖xf3 ♖xf3 and now 32 ♖f1 ♖xf1+ 33 ♔xf1 ♖f8+ 34 ♔g1 ♖f2 35 ♕d1 ♖a2, 32 ♘e3 ♖f2 33 ♕d3 ♗h3 34 ♘f5 ♖g2+ 35 ♔h1 ♖h2+ 36 ♔g1 ♖f8! followed by ... g2, and 32 g6 ♖af8 33 ♖d1 (33 ♕h6 ♗d4+ mates) 33 ... ♗h3 followed by ... ♖f2 are all winning for Black. Unfortunately White plays 29 ♘d4! ♕g7 30 ♖bd1 and the well-placed knight on d4 gives White good defensive chances. The move played opens more lines for Black's bishops.

29 ♗xe4 f3
30 ♘ef4

Or 30 ♖f1 (30 ♗xf3 ♖xf3 and if the a3 pawn falls Black's passed a-pawn will decide the game) 30 ... ♕h5! 31 ♘ef4 ♖xf4 32 ♘xf4 ♕g4+ 33 ♘g2 (33 ♔h1 ♗xf4 34 ♕c3+ ♗e5 35 ♕xf3 ♕xh4+ mates) 33 ... ♕xe4 34 ♖be1 ♗d4+ 35 ♔h2 fg 36 ♖xe4 gf♘+ winning.

30 ... fg
31 ♘xg2 ♕h5

The queen probably belongs on g7, but there is no harm in this move since White can do nothing constructive. The threat is 32 ... ♗h3 followed by taking on g2 and h4, when White will be mated on the dark squares.

32 ♕d3 ♗g4

Preventing 33 ♖f1 because of 33 ... ♗e2 34 ♖xf8+ ♖xf8 35 ♕c2 ♗d4+ etc, and possibly intending ... ♗f3.

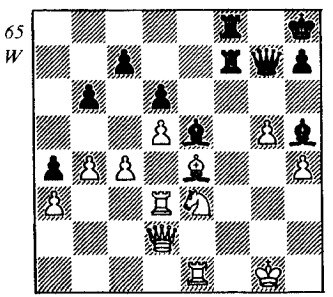
33 ♖e3 ♕f7

Black gains a tempo to reach g7. Not 34 ♖f1? ♕xf1+ and 35 ... ♗h2+.

34 ♕d2 ♕g7
35 ♖d3 ♖f7
36 ♖e1 ♖af8

With both players in time trouble, White has very few moves which do not lose at once. In fact there are only four, 37 ♕e3, 37 ♖b1, 37 ♘e3 and 37 b5 (37 ♖de3? ♗d4, 37 ♖c1? ♖f2 38 ♕xf2 ♗h2+ 39 ♔f1 ♖xf2+ 40 ♔xf2 ♕b2+). Which one White chooses makes little difference, e.g. after 37 ♕e3 ♗h5 White has nothing better than 38 ♕d2.

37 ♘e3 ♖f4
38 ♘g2 ♖4f7
39 ♘e3 ♗h5 *(65)*



40 ♖f1 ?

This blunder on the last move of the time control loses by force. The best way to meet the threat of

... ♗g3 is by 40 ♘g2 (40 ♕g2? ♖f4 wins). The question then is whether Black can win. The answer is that there is no forced win, but Black has good practical chances. The position after 40 ♘g2 is very unusual; White has only three moves not to lose immediately (♕e3, ♖b1 and b5), but Black cannot improve his position either. Therefore the best line is 40 ♘g2 ♖f2! 41 ♕xf2 ♖xf2 42 ♔xf2 ♗d4+ and now:

a) **43 ♘e3** ♕e5 44 ♗g2 (44 ♗f3 ♕h2+ is worse) 44 ... ♕f4+ 45 ♔g1 ♗g6 wins material.

b) **43 ♔g3** ♗c3! and now the lines 44 ♖b1/h1 ♕e5+ 45 ♘f4 ♕xe4, 44 ♖f1 ♗e2, 44 ♖ee3 ♗e5+ 45 ♔f2 ♗d4 and 44 ♖g1 ♗e2 45 ♖e3 ♗d4 lose material at once. 44 ♖c1 is more tricky, but 44 ... ♗e5+ 45 ♔f2 (45 ♘f4 ♕f7 46 ♖f1 ♗e2) 45 ... ♗d4+ 46 ♔g3 (46 ♘e3 ♕e5 as in line a, 46 ♔e1 ♕e5, or 46 ♔f1 ♕f7+ 47 ♗f3 ♗b2) 46 ... ♕e5+ wins.

c) **43 ♔f1** (this appears worst, but actually offers the best chances) 43 ... ♕f7+ 44 ♗f3 ♗b2! (44 ... ♗g6 45 ♖xd4 ♕xf3+ 46 ♔g1 ♕xa3 is possible, but White's rooks give him every chance of perpetual check) 45 ♔e2 (45 ♖ee3 ♗c1 and 45 ♔f2 ♗g6 followed by ... ♗xa3 are bad for White) 45 ... ♗g6 46 ♖e3 (46 ♖dd1 ♗xa3 and the a-pawn will be very dangerous) 46 ... ♗d4 47 ♖e6 ♗f5 (47 ... ♕f5!?) and Black has the advantage but I am not sure if he can win.

40 ... ♖xf1+
41 ♘xf1 ♖f4

Black has a decisive advantage: the game finished **42 ♕e1** (or 42 ♘g3 ♖g4 43 ♕g2 ♗xg3 44 ♖xg3 ♕d4+ and wins) **42 ... ♗d4+ 43 ♔g2** (43 ♔h1 ♕e5 44 ♘g3 ♗f3+ is even worse) **43 ... ♕e5 44 ♘g3 ♗g4!** (Black can win the queen at any time by ... ♗f2 or ... ♖f2+, but it turns out that he can win the queen for two pieces instead of a rook and a piece) **45 b5** (White can do nothing to escape the coming blow; the queen, bishop and knight cannot move, 45 ♖d2 and 45 ♔h1 lose to 45 ... ♗f3+ and 45 ♔h2 ♖f2+ 46 ♔h1 ♗f3+ is the same) **45 ... ♗f2 46 ♕xf2 ♗h3+** 0–1, since after 47 ♔g1 ♕a1+ White loses too much material.

In conclusion, the older line with 11 ... ♘f6 is dubious, but Black has been doing well with the modern 11 ... ♔h8.

7 9 ♘e1 ♘d7 10 f3 f5 11 ♗e3

1	d4	♘f6
2	c4	g6
3	♘c3	♗g7
4	e4	d6
5	♘f3	0-0
6	♗e2	e5
7	0-0	♘c6
8	d5	♘e7
9	♘e1	♘d7
10	f3	f5
11	♗e3	

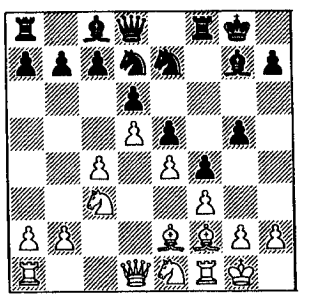
The distinctive feature of this line is the development of White's queen's bishop to e3. This gives Black a free tempo for his kingside attack when he plays ... f4, but in compensation the bishop at f2 is well placed to aid White's queenside play. Not only does it support c5, it also helps to exert uncomfortable pressure on the a7 pawn and if Black should later play ... a6 (to prevent ♘b5, for example), the weak b6 square comes under fire. This compares favourably with the activity of the bishop on d2 in Chapter 5. On the other hand, Black finds it easier to play ... g4 than in Chapter 5, since there is no knight at f2 to hold up the advance. However, achieving ... g4–g3 doesn't mean mate, as White can set up a second line of defence by ♔h1 and ♗g1. After ... gh the bishop returns to f2 and Black's attack still has a long way to go.

11	...	f4
12	♗f2	g5 *(66)*

Krum Georgiev has experimented with some alternative move orders. In one game he played 11 ... ♖f7 and in another 11 ... f4 12 ♗f2 ♖f7. Both opponents replied with ♘d3, which is a mistake since it transposes to line A below, which is considered satisfactory for Black. Korchnoi's ♘b5 line (C below) also makes less sense after 11 ... ♖f7, so the crucial test is 11 ... ♖f7 12 b4, but even if Black has nothing better than ... f4 and ... g5, at least he has cut down White's options. Unfortunately the line he has 'forced' White into is probably the most dangerous of the three variations for Black, so this may not be a genuine achievement!

After 12 ... g5 there are three main lines. The old 13 ♘d3 supports c5, but in fact the knight on d3 is poorly placed, blocking the e2 bishop. Black has no problems in this line. 13 b4 is much more dangerous. For a time Black was successful with the plan of forcing through ... g4 even at the cost of exchanging his white-squared bishop, but the most recent games suggest that this plan leaves Black fighting for a draw. However the new move 17 ... ♗f8 shows that alternative plans are possible. Finally Korchnoi's 13 ♘b5 intends to exchange the c8 bishop or force a weakness in Black's queenside. After initial successes for White supporters of Black's side have been fighting back, but the last word has not been said on 13 ♘b5.

66
W



A 13 ♘d3
B 13 b4
C 13 ♘b5

Other lines:

a) **13 g4** h5 (13 ... fg 14 hg h5 15 ♗e3 ♘g6 16 ♕d2 ♗f6 followed by ... h4 is satisfactory for Black) 14 h3 ♘g6 15 ♔h2?! (a very odd move; 15 ♘d3 or 15 ♔g2 is more to the point) 15 ... hg 16 hg, Marić–Vukić, Pula Open 1988, and now 16 ... ♔f7 followed by ... ♖h8+ takes advantage of White's 15th move.

b) **13 ♖c1** (if Black replies with ... ♘g6, this will probably transpose to line B below, but he can try to take advantage of White's move order) 13 ... ♖f6 (the idea of ... ♖f6–h6 and ... ♕e8–h5 occurs in a number of positions; this situation is relatively favourable for Black because of the tempo spent on ♖c1) 14 b4 ♖h6 15 c5 a6 16 cd cd 17 g4 fg 18 hg ♘g6 (18 ... ♕e8 19 g4 ♘g6 is also good for Black according to Uhlmann) 19 ♘g2 ♘f4! 20 gf gf 21 ♗h4 (or 21 ♕e1 ♗f6 intending ... ♕c8–h5) 21 ... ♗f6! (not 21 ... ♖xh4 22 ♘xh4 ♕xh4 23 ♖f2) 22 ♗xf6 ♘xf6 with a dangerous attack for Black in Speelman–Uhlmann, Leningrad 1984.

c) **13 a4** (another of Korchnoi's ideas; it has received too few tests for any verdict to be given) and now:

c1) **13 ... h5** 14 ♘b5 ♘f6 15 ♘xa7 ♗d7 (15 ... ♖xa7 16 ♗xa7 g4 17 c5 ♘g6 18 cd cd 19 a5 g3 20 ♗b6 ♕e7 21 ♖c1 ♘h7 22 ♔h1 ♕h4 23 ♗g1 ♘f6 24 ♖c7 proved unsound in Federau–Heim, Bundesliga 1987) 16 ♘b5 g4 (16 ... ♘g6 17 c5! g4 18 cd cd 19 ♘xd6 g3 20 ♗c5! is good for White) 17 fg (17 c5 g3! 18 hg fg 19 ♗xg3 ♘g6 is unclear according to Hellers) 17 ... hg 18 ♗h4 ♘xe4 19 ♗xg4 and White had some advantage in Korchnoi–Hellers, European Club Cup 1987.

c2) **13 ... a5** (13 ... ♘f6, 13 ... ♖f6

and 13 ... a6 are all alternatives, the last being my preference) 14 ♘d3 b6 15 b4 ab 16 ♘xb4 ♔h8 17 ♘b5 ♖f7 18 ♕d2 ♘f6 19 ♘c6 ♘xc6 20 dc ♕e8 21 a5 ba 22 c5 dc 23 ♖xa5 ♖xa5 24 ♕xa5 g4 with a murky position, Hofmann–Sieglen, Bundesliga 1988.

A

13 ♘d3 ♘f6

Better than 13 ... ♖f6?! 14 c5! (14 g4 fg 15 hg ♖h6 16 ♗e3 ♘g6 17 ♘f2? ♘f4! was very good for Black in Beni-Euwe, Mont Pèlerin 1953) 14 ... ♖g6 (14 ... ♖h6 15 cd cd 16 ♘b5 is good for White since 16 ... ♕e8 17 ♘xa7 ♕h5 18 h3 ♖xa7 19 ♗xa7 may be followed by ♘f2, defending the kingside) 15 ♖c1 a6 16 ♕c2 ♔h8 17 ♘a4 h5 18 cd cd 19 ♕c7 ♕e8 20 ♘b6 ♘xb6 21 ♗xb6 ♘g8 22 ♕d8 with an edge for White, Furman–Koblents, USSR 1963.

14 c5 ♘g6

Not 14 ... h5? 15 ♖c1 ♖f7 16 cd cd 17 ♘b5 forking a7 and c7, Yanofsky–Reeve, Canada zonal 1986.

15 ♖c1

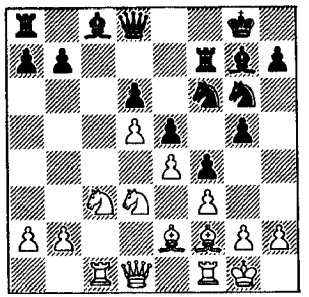
Or 15 a4 (this turns out to be too slow) 15 ... h5 16 cd cd 17 a5 g4 18 ♘b5 g3! 19 ♗xa7 ♘h7! 20 h3 ♕h4 21 ♗b6 ♗xh3! 22 gh ♕xh3 23 ♖f2 ♘h4 with a clear plus for Black, Larsen–Torre, Bauang 1973.

15 ... ♖f7

16 cd

In earlier times White players tended to allow Black's kingside attack to roll forwards, e.g. 16 b4 h5 17 a4 g4 18 b5 ♗h6 19 ♖c2 ♖g7 20 ♔h1 g3 21 hg fg 22 ♗xg3 h4 23 ♗f2 ♘h5, Vistaneckis–Borisenko, USSR 1963, or 16 ♕b3 g4! 17 fg ♘xg4 18 ♗xg4 ♗xg4 19 ♕xb7 f3, Eliskases–Gligorić, Mar del Plata 1953, with a clear plus for Black in both cases. Those were happy days for King's Indian players!

16 ... cd


67
W

17 ♖c2 (or 17 ♘b5 g4 18 g3 fg 19 hg gf 20 ♗xf3 ♗h3 21 ♖e1 ♗h6 22 ♖c2 a6 23 ♘a3 ♕f8 24 ♔h2 ♗d7 25 ♔g2 ♕g7 26 ♖h1 b5 27 ♗e1 ♖af8 with an enormous attack for Black in Miladinović–Krum Georgiev, GMA Belgrade Open 1988 – some things don't change!) 17 ... ♗f8 18 ♕d2 g4 19 ♖fc1 g3! 20 hg fg 21 ♗xg3 ♘h5 22 ♗h2 (22 ♗f2 ♘gf4 23 ♘b5 a6 24 ♘c7 ♕g5 was no better, Gligorić–Lukić, Yugoslav Ch 1955) 22 ... ♗e7 23 ♘b1 ♗d7 24 ♕e1 ♗g5 25 ♘d2 ♗e3+ 26 ♔h1 ♕g5 27 ♗f1 ♖af8 28 ♖d1 b5 29 a4 a6 30 ab ab 31 ♖c7 ♖g7 32 ♘b3 ♘h4 33 ♖c2 ♗h3 ('A picturesque position' – Bronstein) 34 ♕e2 ♘xg2 35 ♗xg2 ♗xg2+ 36 ♕xg2 ♕h4 37 ♕xg7+ ♔xg7 38 ♖g2+ ♔h8 39 ♘e1 ♘f4 40 ♖g3 ♗f2 41 ♖g4 ♕h3 42 ♘d2 h5 43 ♖g5 0–1 Taimanov–Najdorf, Zürich 1953. A famous game.

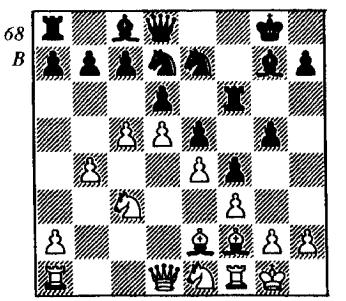
B

13 b4

The Dutch player Jeroen Piket has made a career out of winning with this move, as the examples in this section prove.

13 ... ♘f6

There is a major alternative in 13 ... ♖f6 (13 ... a6 14 c5 ♔h8 15 ♖c1 h5 16 ♘a4 ♘g8 17 ♕c2 ♖f7 18 ♘d3 ♗f6 19 ♘db2! was good for White in J. Piket–M. Schlosser, World Junior Ch 1988) 14 c5 *(68)* and now:


68
B

a) **14 ... a6** 15 c6 (a drastic attempt to refute Black's play, but it only results in a highly unclear position) 15 ... bc 16 dc ♘f8 17 a4 ♖h6 18 b5 ♕e8 19 ♔h1 ♘e6 20 ♗c4 ♔h8 21 ♘d3 ♘d4 22 ♘b4 ♕h5 23 ♗g1 g4 24 ♘xa6 g3 25 ♘xc7 ♕g5! (with the deadly threat of 26 ... ♖xh2+ 27 ♗xh2 ♕h4) 26 ♖f2 gf 27 ♘xa8 ♖g6 28 ♕f1 fg♕+ 29 ♕xg1 ♕h5 30 ♖f1 d5 31 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 32 ♗xd5 ♘e2 33 ♕b6 ♕xh2+ 0–1 Andruet–van der Wiel, Montpellier 1985.

b) **14 ... ♖h6** (Black has not done well with this move and the evidence is that the preparatory ... a6 is necessary) 15 cd cd 16 ♘b5 ♘f6 (after 16 ... ♕e8 Korchnoi–W. Watson, Beersheva 1987, continued 17 g4! fg 18 ♗xg3 when the weakness of c7 became important: 18 ... ♕d8 19 ♕c1 ♘f8 20 ♕c7 ♕d7 21 ♖c1 a6 22 ♕xd7 ♗xd7 23 ♘c7 ♖c8 24 ♘g2 ♘eg6 25 ♘e6 with an excellent position for White) 17 ♖c1 g4 18 fg ♘xe4 19 ♘c7 ♘xf2 20 ♖xf2 ♖b8 21 ♗d3 ♖f6 22 h3 ♗d7 23 ♕b3 with a slight advantage for White, D. Gurevich–W. Watson, Beersheva 1987.

14 c5 ♘g6

15 cd

White can delay this for a move, but he should not wait too long, or else Black may arrange to recapture on d6 with his bishop, e.g. 15 ♖c1 ♖f7 16 a4?! (16 cd was essential) 16 ... ♗f8 17 cd ♗xd6! 18 ♘d3, Miles–Ree, Amsterdam 1982, and now 18 ... b6 would have been good. Although this allows b5 and ♘b4–c6 one well-placed knight isn't too dangerous and Black has

several tempi to develop his kingside attack. 18 ... ♖g7?! was played and now White should have taken the chance to play 19 ♘c5, so as to be able to eliminate the white-squared bishop by a later ♘e6.

15 ... cd
16 ♖c1 ♖f7
17 a4 h5

Or:

a) **17 ... b6** 18 a5! ba 19 ba h5 (or 19 ... ♕xa5 20 ♘b5 ♕d8 21 ♕c2 ♘e8 22 ♘xa7 ♗d7 23 ♘c6 ♕f6 24 ♘d3 h5 25 ♖a1 ♖c8 26 ♖fb1 g4 27 ♖b8 g3 28 ♗e1 gh+ 29 ♔h1 with a slight advantage for White, J. Piket–Douven, Dutch Ch 1989) 20 ♘b5 g4 21 ♖c6 (according to Byrne and Mednis White can gain the advantage by 21 ♖xc8 ♖xc8 22 ♘xa7 ♖a8 23 ♘c6, but this has never been tested) 21 ... g3 22 hg fg 23 ♗xg3 and now:

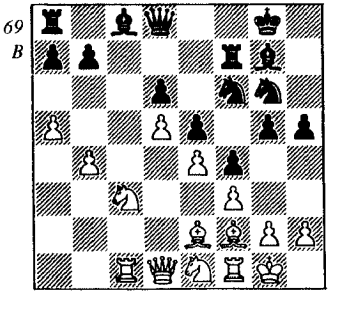
a1) **23 ... ♗f8** 24 ♕c1 h4 was played in Quinteros–Kavalek, Montilla 1974. This is assessed as unclear in *ECO*, but I prefer White.

a2) **23 ... ♘e8!** 24 ♘d3 ♖b8 (24 ... ♗h6! 25 f4 ef 26 ♗xh5 fg 27 ♖xf7 ♔xf7 28 ♕f3+ ♔g7 29 ♗xg6 ♔xg6 is unclear according to Piket) 25 f4! h4 26 ♗h2 ♖xb5 27 ♗h5 ♖f6 28 fe ♖xf1+ 29 ♕xf1 ♘h8 30 e6 ♗xe6 31 ♘f4 ♗xd5 32 ♘xd5 and White is winning, J. Piket–Nijboer, Dutch Ch 1989.

These lines are very complex, but my impression is that with White's attack already doing well on the queenside, it is hard for Black to justify the pawn sacrifice on the other flank.

b) **17 ... ♗f8!** (Kasparov's innovation; instead of preparing ... g4 by ...h5, Black intends ... ♖g7, not only activating the rook but also leaving h5 free for the f6 knight) 18 a5 ♗d7 19 ♘b5 (By leaving e4 weak this allows ... g4, but how else can White make progress? Other moves allow Black to improve his position by ... ♖g7) 19 ... g4 20 ♘c7 g3 21 ♘xa8 ♘h5! (this tactical point justifies Black's play; by threatening to mate by ... ♕h4 Black forces White to move his king, but this costs two tempi) 22 ♔h1 gf 23 ♖xf2 ♘g3+ 24 ♔g1 (a sad necessity) 24 ... ♕xa8 25 ♗c4 (the knight is still invulnerable as the queen may return to d8 and h4) 25 ... a6 26 ♕d3 ♕a7 27 b5 ab 28 ♗xb5 ♘h1! 0–1 J. Piket–Kasparov, Tilburg 1989.

18 a5 *(69)*



18 ... ♗d7

The sharp alternative is 18 ... g4

19 ♘b5 and now:

a) **19 ... g3** (19 ... a6? 20 ♗b6 ♕f8 21 ♘c7 ♖b8 22 ♗a7 ♗d7 23 ♘e6! wins for White) 20 ♗xa7! (not 20 hg fg 21 ♗xg3 h4 22 ♗f2 ♘h5 with the usual strong Black attack) 20 ... ♘h7 (the position is very tricky, but it seems that White can defend) 21 ♔h1! ♖xa7 (21 ... ♕h4 22 ♗g1 defends) 22 ♖xc8! (not 22 ♘xa7 ♗d7 followed by ... ♕h4) 22 ... ♕xc8 23 ♘xa7 ♕d8 24 h3 ♕h4 25 ♕c2 ♘g5 26 ♗b5! (White covers the second rank just in time) 26 ... ♘f8 27 ♔g1 with a distinct advantage to White, Bass–Spraggett, New York 1983.

b) **19 ... b6!?** (suggested in *Informator*, I have only been able to find one practical example, which was a very complex win for White) 20 ♘xa7!? (20 ab g3!?) 20 ... ♖fxa7 21 ♗xb6 ♕e7 22 ♗xa7 ♕xa7+ 23 ♔h1 ♗d7 (this position is hard to assess, but I suspect that White is better) 24 ♖c6!? ♗xc6 25 dc ♕c7 26 b5 ♖xa5 27 ♕b3+ ♔h7 28 fg hg 29 b6 ♕xc6 30 b7 ♘d7 31 ♗xg4 ♘b8 32 ♘f3 ♔h6 33 ♘d2 ♗f6 34 ♕f7 d5 35 ♗f5 ♗g7 36 ed ♖xd5 37 ♗e4 ♖d7 38 ♕e8 ♕a6 39 ♕xb8 ♖xd2 40 ♖g1 ♕b6 41 ♕c8 ♖d8 42 b8♕ ♕xb8 43 ♕h3+ 1–0 Piket–Pieterse, Dutch Ch 1988.

19 ♘b5 ♗xb5

Normally Black would preserve his white-squared bishop at all costs, for without it his kingside attack lacks much of its strength, but in this position the exchange on b5 gains a number of tempi. Nevertheless, the continuation exposes Black's white-squared weaknesses.

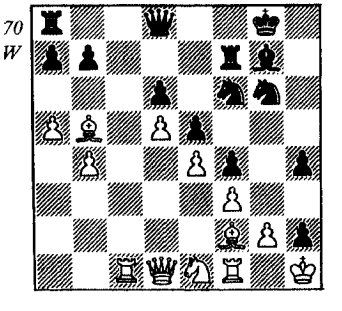
20 ♗xb5 g4
21 ♔h1

21 ♘d3 g3 22 ♗e1 is also possible, with the point that 22 ... gh+ 23 ♔xh2 h4 24 ♘f2 saves White two moves over D. Gurevich–Hellers below. However Black may adopt a different plan, e.g. 22 ... a6 followed by 23 ... b5!?.

21 ... g3
22 ♗g1

22 hg fg 23 ♗xg3 h4 24 ♗h2 ♘h5 gives Black good play for the pawn.

22 ... gh
23 ♗f2 h4 *(70)*



24 ♔xh2

When Black plays ... ♘h5–g3 the f1 rook should move to g1 to put Black off the sacrifice ... h3. Therefore 24 ♘d3 ♘h5 25 ♖e1?! is wrong (it wasn't too late to play 25 ♔xh2 ♘g3 26 ♖g1) and after

25 ... ♘g3+ 26 ♔xh2 ♘f8 27 ♗g1 h3! 28 gh ♘h7 29 ♘f2 ♕h4 30 ♕a4? (intending to defend h3 by ♗d7, but 30 ♗f1 ♘xf1+ 31 ♖xf1 ♘g5 32 ♔h1 ♘xh3 33 ♘xh3 ♕xh3+ 34 ♗h2 ♖c8 would have only been slightly better for Black) 30 ... ♖d8! Black was much better in D. Gurevich–Hellers, Beersheva 1986.

It is an open question whether Piket's move a6 should be played instead of 24 ♔xh2, so as to deprive Black of the chance to play ... a6 himself.

24 ... ♘h5
25 ♖g1

In a later game Piket preferred the immediate 25 a6 (to forestall a possible 25 ... a6) and after 25 ... b6 26 ♘d3 ♗f6 27 ♖g1 ♖g7 28 ♗e1 h3 29 gh ♗h4 30 ♗xh4 ♘xh4 31 ♖xg7+ ♔xg7 32 ♘f2 he gained the advantage in Piket–Pieterse, Netherlands 1989.

25 ... ♘g3

Black should probably play ... a6 here given the chance; admittedly this allows a later ♗b6, but Black should avoid further white-squared weaknesses if at all possible.

26 a6!

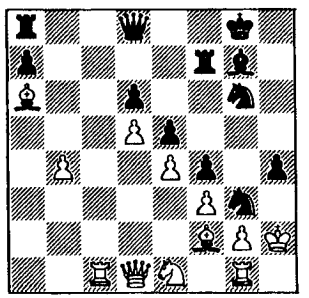
Piket's innovation is the most dangerous continuation. Hitherto White had played 26 ♘d3, when 26 ... ♗f8 27 ♗e1 ♖h7 28 ♘f2 h3 29 gh (29 ♘xh3!? a6 30 ♗a4 is another idea, meeting 30 ... ♕g5 by 31 ♗d7!) 29 ... ♕h4 30 ♖c3 ♕h5 31 ♗f1 (Hellers gives 31 ♕c2!? ♘h4 32 ♗e2 ♔h8 33 ♗d1 ♕g5! 34 ♖c8 ♘f1+ 35 ♔h1 ♘g3+ drawing) 31 ... ♔h8, D. Gurevich–Hellers, New York Open 1987, and now 32 ♕c2!? ♘h4 33 ♗g2 ♖d8! 34 ♘g4 (34 ♖c8 ♕xf3 draws) 34 ... ♗e7 35 ♗xg3 fg+ 36 ♔xg3 ♖f8 would have been unclear according to Hellers.

26 ... ba

After 26 ... b6 Piket gives 27 ♘d3 followed by ♗e1 and ♘f2 – as in Piket–Pieterse above – but 27 ♗c6 ♖b8 28 ♗b7 also looks very good because White can play ♕c2 followed by either ♕c8 or ♗c8 according to circumstances.

27 ♗xa6 *(71)*

White's ambition is to transfer his bishop to the c8–h3 diagonal, supporting the weak h3 square from an active position. While the bishop was on b5 Black could easily cover d7, but c8 is another matter.



27 ... ♗f8

28 ♘d3 ♖h7 29 ♗e1 h3 30 gh ♕h4 (even if the queen stays at d8 White can play ♕c2 to prepare ♗c8) 31 ♘f2 and in this critical position we have two lines:

a) **31 ... ♔h8?** 32 ♖c8 ♖xc8 33 ♗xc8 (in contrast to D. Gurevich–Hellers above White's bishop is on c8 instead of being buried at f1, and moreover he has exchanged one pair of rooks; White is clearly better) 33 ... ♗e7 34 ♘h1 ♕h6 35 ♗e6 (White could probably have won more easily, but he gets there in the end) 35 ... ♘f8 36 ♗g4 ♗d8 37 ♘xg3 fg+ 38 ♗xg3 ♗b6 39 ♖g2 ♘g6 40 ♕a4 ♘f4 41 ♕e8+ ♔g7 42 ♗h4! ♕g6 43 ♕xg6+ ♘xg6 44 ♗f5 ♖xh4 45 ♖xg6+ and the rest was technique, J. Piket–Paneque, World Junior Ch 1988.

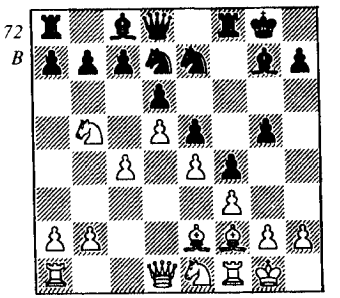
b) **31 ... ♕h5**. As pointed out by Piket himself, this offers Black drawing chances. After 32 ♖c8 ♘h4! 33 ♖xa8 ♘xf3+ 34 ♔g2 ♘h4+ we have an immediate perpetual check, while after 32 ♗c8 ♖xc8 33 ♖xc8 ♘h4 34 ♖c3 ♗e7 White is curiously tied up, while Black may continue with ... ♗d8–b6. This leaves 32 ♗f1 ♘h4 33 ♗g2, but again 33 ... ♗e7 gives Black counterplay.

It is clear that Black is under some pressure in this line, but if the Piket–Paneque line really holds for Black then he may well survive. Moreover 17 ... ♗f8 is promising.

C

13 ♘b5 *(72)*

The idea is to eliminate the important c8 bishop by 13 ... a6 14 ♘a7 ♘f6 15 ♘xc8. This would be so awful for Black that nobody has allowed it to happen! There are three possible replies, 13 ... a6 14 ♘a7 ♖xa7 hoping to trap the bishop, 13 ... ♘f6 offering the a-pawn and finally the simple 13 ... b6.



C1 13 ... a6
C2 13 ... b6

Or 13 ... ♘f6 14 ♘xa7 ♗d7 15 c5!? (an imaginative idea, but the critical line is probably the simple 15 ♘b5) 15 ... ♖xa7 16 cd ♘c8 17 dc ♕xc7 18 ♗xa7 ♘xa7 19 ♕b3 ♕c5+ 20 ♔h1 ♘h5 21 ♘d3 ♕e3 22 ♘f2 ♕xe2 23 ♕xb7, J. Benjamin–Nunn, Hastings 1987/8, and now 23 ... ♗b5 24 ♕xa7 ♕e3 25 ♕xe3 fe 26 ♘g4 ♗xf1 27 ♖xf1 e2 28 ♖e1 ♖c8 29 ♘e3 is roughly equal.

C1

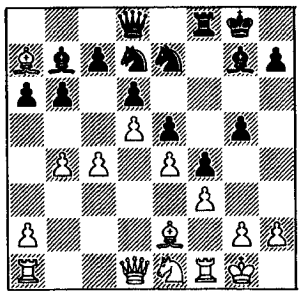
13 ... a6
14 ♘a7 ♖xa7
15 ♗xa7 b6
16 b4

Korchnoi points out that 16 c5

dc (but not 16 ... ♘xc5 17 b4 ♘d7 18 ♖c1 ♗b7 19 ♕c2 c5 20 dc ♘xc6 21 ♗xa6 ♗xa6 22 ♕xc6 ♗xf1 23 ♔xf1 with advantage for White) 17 ♕a4 ♗b7 18 ♗xa6 ♗xa6 19 ♕xa6 ♕a8 20 a4 ♘c8 21 a5 ♕xa7 22 ♕xa7 ♘xa7 23 ab ♘b5 24 bc ♖c8 is good for Black.

16 ... ♗b7 *(73)*

16 ... ♘f6 (probably Black's best chance in this line) 17 c5 g4 18 ♖c1 g3 19 cb ½–½ Karolyi–Vokac, Prague 1988, is not very informative, but the possible continuation 19 .. gh+ 20 ♔xh2 cb 21 a4 ♘h5 22 a5 ba 23 ba ♘g3 looks fine for Black. Perhaps White should play 18 fg!?.



17 c5

Korchnoi's continuation looks good, but there is a second promising line: 17 ♕a4!? ♘c8 18 c5 dc 19 ♗xa6 ♗xa6 20 ♕xa6 ♘d6 21 ♘d3 c4 22 ♘c5! bc 23 bc ♘c8 24 c6 ♘db6 25 ♗xb6 ♘xb6 26 a4 ♕a8 27 ♕b5 ♕a7 28 ♔h1 ♖a8 29 a5 ♗f8 30 d6! ♗xd6 31 ab! ♕xa1 32 ♕xc4+ ♔g7 33 b7 and White won in Züger–Agnos, London (Lloyds Bank) 1987.

17 ... dc

Or 17 ... bc 18 bc ♕a8 19 ♗b6 cb 20 c6 and White wins.

18 ♖c1

And now:

a) **18 ... ♘c8** 19 bc ♗a8 (19 ... ♘xc5 20 ♖xc5 gives White a decisive positional advantage) 20 c6 ♘f6 21 ♗xb6 ♘xb6 22 ♗xa6 with a clear plus for White, Korchnoi–Hulak, Zagreb 1987.

b) **18 ... cb** 19 d6 (Korchnoi gives 19 ♕a4 a5 20 ♗b5 ♘f6 21 ♕c2 and the lines 21 ... ♘c8 22 ♗b8, 21 ... ♘exd5 22 ed ♘xd5 23 ♗c4 ♖f7 24 ♘d3 ♖d7 25 ♖fe1 and 21 ... ♕a8 22 ♕xc7 ♖c8 23 ♕xe7 ♖xc1 24 ♕e6+ ♔h8 25 ♕xb6 all win for White) 19 ... cd (19 ... ♘c6 20 ♗xa6 ♗xa6 21 ♖xc6 is good for White) 20 ♕xd6 ♖f6 21 ♕c7 ♕c8 22 ♘d3 ♖c6 23 ♖xc6 ♘xc6 24 ♕xc8+ ♗xc8 25 ♖c1 ♘xa7 26 ♖c7 with a winning ending for White, Karolyi–Kupreichik, Lvov 1988.

On this evidence the exchange sacrifice is dubious.

C2

13 ... b6

14 b4

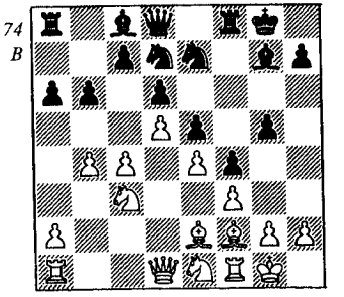
The usual move, but 14 a4 is a reasonable alternative, when Zuger–Hazai, Budapest 1988, continued 14 ... a6 15 ♘c3 a5 16 ♘d3 ♘g6 (I prefer 16 ... ♖f6) 17 b4 ♖f7 18 ba ba 19 c5 ♗f8 20 cd cd 21 ♘b2 ♘f6 22 ♘c4 with some advantage for White.

14 ... a6

It is possible to delay ... a6, but I am not sure what advantage Black gains by doing this. Federau–Klundt, Bundesliga 1988, continued 14 ... ♖f6 15 ♘d3 ♖h6 16 c5 a6 17 cd cd 18 ♘c3 and the only difference is that White has achieved c5 and cd more easily than in the main line.

15 ♘c3 *(74)*

Or 15 ♘a3 h5 16 c5 b5 17 ♘ac2 ♘f6 18 a4 ba 19 ♖xa4 ♘g6 20 b5 g4 21 ♘b4 g3! 22 hg fg 23 ♗xg3 h4 24 ♘c6 ♕d7 25 ♗h2 ♗h6! 26 f4! ♘xf4 27 ba ♕g7 28 ♗xf4? (28 ♔h1 ♘g4 29 ♖a3! dc would have been unclear according to Smirin) 28 ... ♗xf4 29 ♕d3, Huzman–Smirin, Sverdlovsk 1987, and now 29 ... ♘d7! would have won for Black.



Black has at least three playable moves here and there is insufficient experience to determine which is the best. My personal choice is 15 ... ♖f6, but this is purely subjective.

C21 15 ... ♘g6

C22 15 ... ♖f6

Or 15 ... h5 16 ♖c1 (16 c5 ♘f6 17 cb cb 18 b5 a5 19 ♘a4 ♖b8 20 ♖c1 followed by ♖c6 is Smirin's analysis, and this is probably White's best) 16 ... ♖f6 17 ♕c2 ♖g6 18 c5 g4 19 cd cd 20 ♔h1 g3 21 ♗g1 gh 22 ♗xh2, Hertneck–Sieglen, Bundesliga 1987, and now 22 ... h4 intending ... ♘f6–h5–g3 is fine for Black.

C21

15 ... ♘g6

16 ♘d3

In Gulicovski–Sahović, Vrnjačka Banja 1989, White played 16 c5 and my inclination would certainly be to take this pawn off. In fact the game continued 16 ... ♘f6 17 ♘d3 h5 18 h3 ♖f7 19 cb cb 20 a4 ♗f8 21 ♘b2 ♖b8 22 ♘c4 ♗d7 23 ♘d2 ½–½.

16 ... ♖f7

16 ... ♗f6 is a strange move and after 17 a4 a5 18 ba ♖xa5 19 ♘b4 ♘b8 20 ♘b5 ♖f7 21 ♗e1 ♘f8 22 ♘d3 ♖a6 23 a5 ba 24 c5 White had the advantage in Kosić–Vokac, Prague 1989.

17 a4

17 c5 ♗f8 18 cd ♗xd6! reminds one of Miles–Ree in the note to White's 15th move in line B above.

17 ... ♗f8

18 a5 ba

Better than 18 ... ♖b8 19 ab cb (Vukić recommends 19 ... ♘xb6 20 c5 ♘d7 followed by ... ♘f6, but this is just an inferior version of

line a below) 20 c5! h5, Cebalo–Vukić, Yugoslavia 1987, and now 21 ♘a4 b5 22 ♘c3 ♖g7 23 cd ♗xd6 24 ♘c5 is clearly better for White according to Vukić.

After 18 ... ba White may play:

a) **19 ba** ♖g7 20 c5 ♘f6 21 cd ♗xd6 22 ♘c5 ♘f8 23 ♕b3 ♕e7 24 ♘e6 ♘xe6 25 de ♗xe6 26 ♕b7 ♕e8 27 ♖fd1 g4 28 ♗h4 ♗c5+ 29 ♔h1 ♖a7 30 ♕b2 ♕h5! 31 ♗xf6 ♖g6 32 ♕b8+ ♔f7 33 ♕d8 ♖xf6 34 ♖d7+ ♗xd7 35 ♕xd7+ ♔f8 36 ♕d8+ ♔g7 37 ♕d7+ ♔h8 38 ♕c8+ ♖f8 and Black has a winning position, Thorhallsson–Jonsson, Reykjavik 1989.

b) **19 ♖xa5** ♖b8 20 c5 ♘f6 21 b5 ab 22 ♘b4 ♗d7, Piket–Douven, Dutch Ch 1988, and now instead of 23 c6 ♗c8 24 ♖a7 h5 25 ♘a6 ♗xa6 26 ♖xa6 b4 27 ♘b5 g4 with advantage to Black, White should have played the unclear 23 ♘c6 ♗xc6 24 dc b4 25 ♘d5.

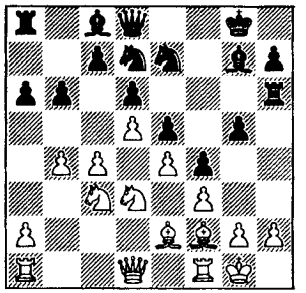
C22

15 ... ♖f6
16 ♘d3

Or 16 ♖c1 ♖h6 17 g4 fg 18 ♗xg3 ♘g6 19 ♘g2 ♘f4 20 ♘e3 ♘f6 21 c5 ♘6h5 22 ♘g4 ♘h3+ 23 ♔g2 ♘3f4+ 24 ♔g1 ♘h3+ ½–½ Schmidt–Novak, Poznań 1987.

16 ... ♖h6 *(75)*
17 ♗e1

Better than 17 c5 ♕e8 18 ♔h1, Braga–Fransson, London Peace 1987, and now instead of trapping his own queen by 18 ... ♕h5 19 ♗g1 ♘f6 20 ♘f2 ♕h4 21 ♘g4



♘xg4 22 fg bc 23 bc dc 24 h3 ♕g3 25 ♖c1 ♖b8 26 ♗f2 ♖xh3+ 27 gh ♕xh3+ 28 ♔g1 ♖b6 29 ♕d3 1–0, Black should play 18 ... ♘f6!, threatening 19 ... ♕h5 20 ♗g1 g4, and if 19 ♗g1 (preparing ♘f2) then 19 ... ♘h5.

17 ... ♘f6

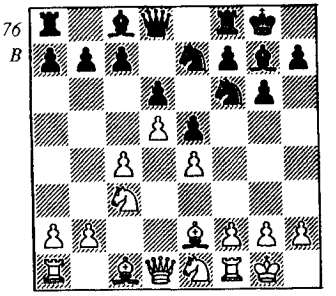
18 ♘f2 ♖g6 19 a4 h5 20 h3 ♔h8 21 a5 ♘eg8 22 b5 ♘h6 23 ab cb 24 ba ♖xa6 25 ♖xa6 ♗xa6 26 ♕a4 ♗c8 with a very sharp and unclear position which eventually petered out to a draw: 27 ♕a8 g4 28 fg hg 29 hg ♘fxg4 30 ♘xg4 ♘xg4 31 ♗xg4 ♖xg4 32 ♖f3 ♔g8 33 ♕c6 ♗f8 34 ♘b5 ♖g7 35 ♗h4 ♕xh4 36 ♕xc8 ♕e1+ 37 ♔h2 ♖g6 38 ♕f5 ♖h6+ ½–½ van der Sterren–Douven, Holland 1987.

Summing up, line A is harmless and line C depends on the double-edged lines in C21 and C22. The main line of B appears to give Black problems, so this line is critically dependent on the assessment of Kasparov's 17 ... ♗f8.

8 9 ♘e1 others

1	**d4**	**♘f6**
2	**c4**	**g6**
3	**♘c3**	**♗g7**
4	**e4**	**d6**
5	**♘f3**	**0-0**
6	**♗e2**	**e5**
7	**0-0**	**♘c6**
8	**d5**	**♘e7**
9	**♘e1** *(76)*	

Apart from 9 ... ♘d7, two other Black 9th moves have been played. 9 ... c5 is dubious and may be rejected, but 9 ... ♘e8 is a more interesting possibility. In many cases the knight returns to f6 whether Black plays ... ♘e8 or ... ♘d7, so we only consider independent lines in this chapter. There are two disadvantages to ... ♘e8 over ... ♘d7: firstly it is easier for White to play c5 and secondly White may respond to ... f5 by ef followed by f4, when Black would prefer to have his knight covering e5. On the plus side the c8 bishop is not blocked, and in some lines Black may gain time by playing ... ♘e8 directly instead of via ... ♘d7–f6–e8. However this last point is not clear-cut, as we discuss in more detail below.



9 ... ♘e8 *(77)*

Or 9 ... c5 and now White has a number of plausible moves, but although many of them maintain an edge, it is 10 f4! which really causes Black problems. The alternatives are:

a) **10 a3** ♘e8 11 b4 f5 12 bc dc 13 f3 f4 14 ♘d3 may give White an edge, Hradeczky–Sax, Hungary 1971.

b) **10 dc** bc 11 ♗f3 (11 ♘c2?! ♗e6 12 ♘e3 is a very passive plan and after 12 ... ♘e8 13 b4 f5 14 b5 ♘f6 15 bc ♘xc6 16 ef gf 17 ♘b5 ♘d4! 18 ♘xd4 ed 19 ♘c2 ♘e4 20 ♗d3 ♘c3 21 ♕f3 ♖c8 Black was clearly better in Granda Zuniga–Zapata, Thessaloniki Ol 1988) 11

... ♗e6 12 b3 c5 (there seems no need to play this so soon; 12 ... ♘e8 intending ... f5 appears better) 13 ♘d5 ♘c6 14 ♘c2 ♗xd5 15 cd ♘d4 16 ♘xd4 ed 17 g3 with a small but permanent plus for White, Nikolac–Bogdanović, Yugoslav Ch 1953.

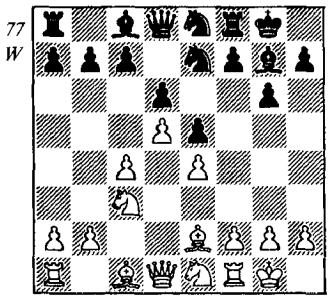
c) **10 ♗e3** ♘e8 11 f3 f5 12 ♘d3 ♘f6 (after 12 ... f4 13 ♗f2 g5 14 b4 cb?! 15 ♘xb4 ♖f6 16 c5 Black was clearly worse in Sherwin–Larsen, Copenhagen 1953; 14 ... b6 is better, but I still prefer White after 15 a4) 13 b4 b6 14 a4 a5 15 bc bc 16 ♖b1 with an edge for White, Donner–Medina, Palma de Mallorca 1967.

d) **10 ♘d3** ♘e8 (10 ... ♘d7 may be met by 11 ♘b5) 11 f4 will transpose to 10 f4, since Black has nothing better than to take on f4.

e) **10 f4!** (the critical move) and now:

e1) **10 ... ♘e8** (10 ... ♘d7 11 f5 gives White a large space advantage) 11 ♘d3 b6 12 fe (12 a3 a5 13 ♖b1 ♗a6 14 ♘f2 ef 15 ♗xf4 f5 16 ♕d2 was also good for White, Panno–Evans, Lugano Ol 1968) 12 ... de 13 b4! cb 14 ♘xb4 ♘d6 15 ♗a3!, intending ♘c6, and Korchnoi assesses this position as clearly better for White.

e2) **10 ... ef** 11 ♗xf4 ♘e8 (thanks to the move ... c5 Black cannot retreat his knight to d7) 12 ♘d3 f6 (not a pleasant move to play, but Black must stop e5) 13 ♕d2 ♔h8 14 ♖ab1 ♘g8 15 b4 b6 16 bc bc 17 ♘b5 ♖f7 18 ♗d1! ♖b7 19 ♗a4 with advantage for White in Korchnoi–Ciocaltea, Nice Ol 1974.


77
W

10 f3

Or 10 ♘d3 (this does not seem to cause Black many problems) 10 ... f5 and now:

a) **11 f4** ef (11 ... fe 12 ♘xe4 c6 13 dc ♘xc6 14 ♗e3 ♘d4 15 ♗xd4 ed 16 ♗f3 ♘f6 gave White an edge in Enklaar–Ghitescu, Amsterdam 1971) 12 ♗xf4 fe 13 ♘xe4 ♘f5 14 ♗g5 ♘f6 15 g4 ♘d4 16 ♘df2 ♕e7! ½–½ Petrosian–Tal, Bled 1961.

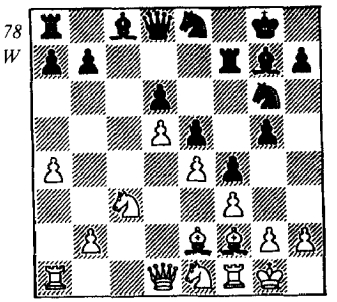
b) **11 ef** gf (11 ... ♘xf5! 12 f3 ♘f6 transposes to line A2 in Chapter 5, which is considered satisfactory for Black) 12 f4 e4 (after this White has a guaranteed advantage, so Black should try 12 ... ♘g6!?, or maybe the unclear 12 ... c6 13 ♗e3 cd 14 cd ♔h8 15 ♖c1 b6 16 ♘b4 ♗b7 17 ♗b5 ♘f6 18 h3 ♘e4 19 ♘xe4 fe 20 ♕b3 ♘f5 of Fauland–Kranzl, Graz Open 1987) 13 ♘f2 c5 14 dc (or 14 ♗e3 ♘f6 15 ♔h1 ♔h8 16 ♖g1 with the usual slight plus for White, Szilágyi–Beni, Mariánske Lázně 1956) 14 ... bc 15 ♗e3 ♘g6 (15 ... d5 16 ♗d4) 16 ♕a4 ♗d7 17 ♖fd1 ♕b8 18 ♖d2 ♖f7 19 g3 with a passive position for Black, Cruz–Benko, Mar del Plata 1965.

10 ... f5
11 ♗e3

The alternative is 11 g4 (if Black replies with 11 ... ♘f6, we transpose to line C of Chapter 6, so we only consider independent variations here) 11 ... c5 (11 ... h5 12 g5 h4 13 ♔h1 and 11 ... f4 12 h4 ♔h8 13 ♗d2 ♗f6 14 ♘g2 ♘g8 15 ♗e1 ♖f7 16 b4 h5 17 g5 ♗e7 18 ♗f2 ♖h7 19 ♔h2, Gipslis–Anetbayev, USSR 1972, are good for White) 12 ♖b1 (after 12 ♘d3 ♗d7 13 ♖b1 ♔h8 14 b4 b6 15 ♗d2 ♘g8 16 ♘f2 ♗h6 Black is at least equal, Tan–Crawley, London 1987, or 12 a3 ♔h8 13 ♘g2 ♘g8 14 b4 f4?! 15 h4 ♗f6 16 ♕e1 ♖f7 17 ♗d2 b6 18 ♖b1 with a slight advantage for White, Mukhin–Anetbayev, USSR 1973, but I prefer 14 ... b6 intending ... ♗h6) 12 ... h5 (12 ... ♔h8 as in Tan–Crawley above is better) 13 g5 h4 14 ♘d3 f4 (14 ... ♔h7 15 f4) 15 ♔h1 ♔f7 16 ♖g1 ♖h8 17 b4 b6 18 bc bc 19 ♕a4 with advantage to White, Dorfman–A. Fernandez, Mexico 1977.

11 ... f4
12 ♗f2 g5
13 c5 ♘g6
14 a4 ♖f7
15 cd cd *(78)*

This may be the crucial position for the assessment of 9 ... ♘e8.


78
W

Black has avoided the time-wasting ... ♘d7–f6–e8, but White normally has to play ♖c1 and ♕c2 to force ... ♘e8, while here Black has played it voluntarily. Two practical examples are:

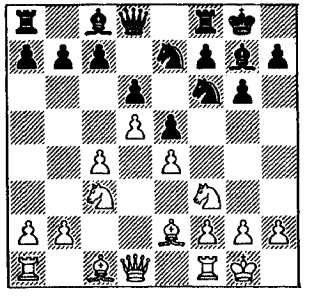
a) **16 a5** (this is logical in that White makes use of the omission of ♖c1) 16 ... h5 (16 ... ♘f6 17 ♘b5 g4 18 fg! ♘xe4 19 ♗xa7 is also good for White) 17 ♘b5 a6 18 ♘c3 ♘f6 19 ♘a4 ♘d7 20 ♘b6 and White stood well in O'Kelly–Ghitescu, Sandefjord 1975.

b) **16 ♖c1** h5 17 ♘b5 a6 18 ♘a3 ♖b8 19 ♘c4 b5 20 ♘b6 ♖xb6 21 ♖xc8 ♕xc8 22 ♗xb6 ♘f6 23 ♕c2 ♕b8 24 a5 and, as usual, the exchange of Black's c8 bishop gives White a clear advantage, Farago–Szekely, Hungary 1987.

9 ... ♘e8 is largely unexplored territory, and players who would like to avoid the masses of theory after 9 ... ♘d7 might like to investigate it. However some improvement is necessary in the main line, since the limited evidence available points to an advantage for White.

9 Other White 9th moves

1	d4	♘f6
2	c4	g6
3	♘c3	♗g7
4	e4	d6
5	♘f3	0-0
6	♗e2	e5
7	0-0	♘c6
8	d5	♘e7 *(79)*


79 W

The ideas in this chapter are based on the logic that Black may not be threatening ... ♘moves and ... f5 at the moment, because White can reply ♘g5-e6. After the exchange on e6 Black may round up the pawn on e6, but the time taken and the resulting white-squared weaknesses may enable White to develop a strong attack. Therefore White plays semi-waiting moves, while Black arranges ... f5; if Black plays ... h6 first to prevent ♘g5, then Black loses a clear tempo. Of the moves in this chapter, 9 ♗d2 is much the most important. The moves ♗d2 and ♖c1 are quite useful ways to pass the time while Black is preparing ... f5, and although the idea suffered a setback in the famous 1971 Taimanov–Fischer match, it was generally agreed that Taimanov's losses were not due to the opening. However Fischer did not play 9 ... ♘h5, now considered the best reply and the move which has tended to put 9 ♗d2 out of business in recent years.

9 ♔h1 is Larsen's idea. Too few games have been played to give any definite assessment, but it does not look like a move which will cause Black players to give up the King's Indian. 9 a4 is Korchnoi's latest idea, which he played against Kasparov at Barcelona. Black won this game, and Korchnoi's extravagant claim that this move refutes the King's Indian is certainly too optimistic. However, like 9 ♗d2, this is quite a useful move and it may be that we will see more games with 9 a4. Finally 9 ♗g5 has been played a few of times; it looks dubious.

A 9 ♗d2
B 9 ♔h1
C 9 a4
D 9 ♗g5

A

9 ♗d2

Black has two main moves:

A1 9 ... ♘e8
A2 9 ... ♘h5

The first was Fischer's preference, but the second is currently thought best.

A1

9 ... ♘e8

There are two other possibilities:

a) **9 ... c5** 10 dc bc 11 ♗g5! (compared to 9 ♘d2 c5, White benefits from having his bishop free) 11 ... ♗e6 (11 ... c5 is relatively best, but 12 ♕d3 is still a little better for White) 12 c5 ♘e8 (12 ... d5 13 ♘xe5 ♕b8 14 ed ♕xe5 15 ♗xf6 ♕xf6 16 de wins a pawn) 13 cd ♘xd6 14 ♕a4 f6 15 ♗e3 ♕c7 16 ♖ac1 and Black has no compensation for his weak c-pawn, Korchnoi–Byrne, Leningrad 1973.

b) **9 ... ♘d7** (as in many similar cases, this may transpose to 9 ... ♘e8 if the knight returns to f6; however it seems more logical to play 9 ... ♘e8 in this position, since White may play ♘g5 soon and with the knight on e8 Black is not forced to reply ... ♘f6 immediately) 10 b4 and now:

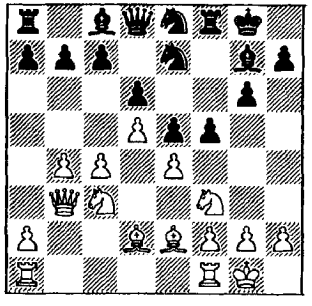
b1) **10 ... f5** 11 ♘g5 ♘f6 (with the knight on e8 Black can play ... h6 here; however even ... ♘f6 didn't turn out badly in this example) 12 f3 ♘h5 13 g3 ♗f6 14 ef gf 15 f4 ♘g7 16 ♖c1 ♘g6 17 ♔h1 a5 18 a3 ab 19 ab ♗xg5 20 fg f4 21 ♘e4 ♗f5 22 ♘f6+ ♖xf6 23 gf ♕xf6 with adequate compensation, Shamkovich–Shirazi, Lone Pine 1981.

b2) **10 ... h6** (if Black has to play this then 9 ... ♘d7 looks wrong, so b1 is the critical line) 11 ♕b3 ♔h8 12 ♖ac1 f5 13 ♘e1 ♘f6 14 f3 f4 15 c5 g5 16 ♘b5 ♘e8 (16 ... g4 17 cd cd 18 ♘c7 is good for White) 17 ♘d3 h5 18 ♘f2 ♘g8 (other moves may be better, but in any case the time-wasting ... h6 and ... h5 creates a bad impression) 19 ♖c2 ♘h6 20 h3 ♖f7 21 ♖fc1 a6 22 ♘a3 ♗f8 23 ♘c4 ♗d7 24 a4 g4 25 fg hg 26 hg with advantage to White, Gligorić–Quinteros, Linares 1981.

10 ♖c1

Or 10 b4 f5 (10 ... a6 11 ♖c1 f5 12 ♘e1 ♘f6 13 ef ♘xf5 14 ♗d3 a5 15 ba ♖xa5 16 a4 ♖a8 17 ♘e4 with an edge for White, Plachetka–W. Schmidt, Prague 1988) 11 ♕b3 *(80)* (not 11 ♘g5?! h6! 12 ♘e6 ♗xe6 13 de ♕c8 14 ♗f3 c6 15 b5 ♕xe6 16 bc bc 17 ♕a4 ♘f6 18 ♖ab1 and now instead of 18 ... ♘d7 19 ef! gf 20 ♗xc6 with an edge for White as in Janošević–Tseitlin, Kragujevac 1974, Black should

continue 18 ... fe! 19 ♘xe4 ♘xe4 20 ♗xe4 d5 with advantage) and now:



a) **11 ... h6** 12 ♘e1 ♘f6 13 f3 f4 14 ♘d3 g5 15 ♘f2 h5 16 h3 ♖f7 17 c5 ♗f8 18 ♖fc1 ♖g7 19 ♘b5 ♘g6 20 ♖c3 a6! 21 ♘a3, Ljubojević–Szmetan, Buenos Aires 1981, gave Black a superior version of Gligorić–Quinteros above. However White could have played much better. His main error was to delay c5 for so long that Black was able to defend c7 with his rook, thus avoiding ... ♘e8, and arrange to meet cd by ... ♗xd6, exchanging his bad bishop. 12 c5 is much more logical.

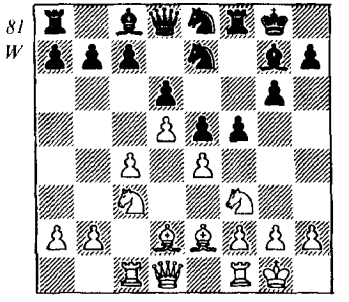
b) **11 ... ♘f6** 12 ef gf (12 ... ♘xf5!? is possible) 13 c5 ♔h8 14 cd cd 15 ♖ac1 and now the general opinion is that Black can equalize, but there is some disagreement as to exactly how. Kozma–Uhlmann, Leipzig 1975, continued 15 ... h6 (given a '!' by Uhlmann, but that is not so unusual) 16 ♘h4 ♗d7 17 f4?! (17 ♔h1 is given as equal by Uhlmann, but I prefer 17 a4!?) 17 ... ♕b6+ 18 ♔h1 e4 and Black has developed good piece activity. On the other hand Boleslavsky prefers 15 ... ♗d7 16 a4 a6! (but not 16 ... ♘g6?! 17 ♗b5 h6 18 ♗xd7 ♕xd7 19 ♘b5 ♘e8 20 ♘e1! and now White is slightly better, Korchnoi–Geller, Moscow match 1971), with an assessment of equality.

10 ... f5 *(81)*

This is the critical move, testing White's theory that ♘g5 is a good reply to ... f5. However there are other ideas:

a) **10 ... c5** (a solid and relatively safe alternative) 11 dc (11 a3?! f5 12 b4 h6 13 ♘e1 b6 14 ♘d3 ♘f6 15 f3 f4 16 bc bc 17 ♖b1 g5 was equal in Dueball–Teschner, Berlin 1971, not surprising because in this line the move ♖c1 is just a wasted tempo) 11 ... bc 12 b4 ♘c7 (12 ... f5? 13 c5!, Geller–Sax, Hilversum 1973, is a mistake because 13 ... d5 is met by 14 ed cd 15 ♗g5) 13 b5 d5 (after 13 ... ♘e6, Adamski–Botterill, Bath 1973, White should be able to keep an edge by 14 bc, rather than 14 ♗e3?! f5! 15 bc f4 as played) 14 cd cd 15 ♘xd5 ♘cxd5 16 ed ♘xd5 17 ♗g5 ♕d7! 18 ♕b3 ♘b6 19 ♖fd1?! (19 a4 is a better chance to keep an edge) 19 ... ♕f5! 20 ♖c5 ♘d7 21 ♖cd5 ♘b6 22 ♖c5 ♘d7 ½–½ Ribli–Torre, match 1983.

b) **10 ... h6** (just as in the lines above, this loses time if Black later has to advance his kingside pawns) 11 ♘e1 f5 12 ♘d3 f4 13 c5 g5 14 ♗g4 ♗xg4 15 ♕xg4 ♖f6 16 c6! bc (16 ... b6 17 ♕d7 is good for White) 17 dc ♘xc6 18 ♘d5 ♘d4 19 ♘xf6+ ♘xf6 20 ♕d1 ♘xe4 21 ♗a5 ♖c8 22 ♖e1 ♘f6 (not 22 ... d5 23 f3) 23 ♗c3 ♘f5 (after 23 ... c5 White gains the advantage by 24 ♗xd4, followed by ♕b3+ and ♕e6), Vogt–Hesse, DDR Ch 1980, and now 24 ♕b3+ ♔h8 25 ♗xe5 de 26 ♘xe5 ♕d5! 27 ♕h3 g4 28 ♘xg4 ♘xg4 29 ♕xg4 would have been slightly better for White.



11 ♕b3

As played by Taimanov in game 3 against Fischer, but it may not be the best move. Other possibilities:

a) **11 ef** (Taimanov's choice in game 1 of the match) 11 ... gf 12 ♘g5 h6 13 ♘e6 ♗xe6 14 de ♕c8 15 ♕b3 c6 (Fischer's move is safest, but 15 ... b6 is also possible, transposing into the note to Black's 13th move in the main line) 16 ♗h5 ♕xe6 17 ♕xb7 ♘f6 and Black has a fully satisfactory position, Taimanov–Fischer, match 1971.

b) **11 ♘g5** (the idea of ♘g5 is improved if White omits the preliminary ef) 11 ... h6 12 ♘e6 ♗xe6 13 de ♕c8 and now:

b1) **14 ♕b3** c6 15 f4!? ef (I prefer 15 ... ♘c7) 16 ♗xf4 g5 17 ♗g3 f4 18 ♗f2 ♕xe6 19 ♕xb7 ♘f6 20 c5! d5 21 ed ♘exd5 22 ♘xd5 ♘xd5 23 ♗c4 ♖ab8 24 ♖ce1! ♕xe1 25 ♕xc6 ♕e7 26 ♖e1 ♕d8 27 b3 ♔h8 28 ♗xd5 g4? (28 ... ♖f6!? was much better) 29 ♖e6 ♕g5 30 ♖g6 ♕h5 31 ♖xg7! g3 32 ♖g8+ 1–0 Ftačnik–Georgiev, Groningen 1976/7.

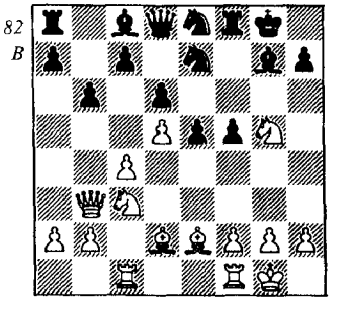
b2) **14 c5** ♕xe6 (14 ... dc 15 ♘d5 ♘xd5 16 ed b6 17 b4 is good for White) 15 cd cd 16 ♘b5 ♕d7 17 ♗b4 ♘c6 18 ♗xd6 ♘xd6 19 ♕xd6 ♕xd6 20 ♘xd6 ♘d4 21 ♗c4+ with just a faint edge for White, Geller–Minić, Skopje 1968.

11 ... b6

11 ... f4 is illogical, because Black is virtually forced to waste a tempo with ... h6 within a few moves. Tal's flexible suggestion of 11 ... ♔h8!? is more sensible.

12 ef gf

13 ♘g5 *(82)*



13 ... ♘f6

13 ... h6 is playable, e.g. 14 ♘e6 ♗xe6 15 de ♕c8 (15 ... c6!? 16 ♗h5 ♘f6 17 ♗f7+ ♔h7 was played in Skalkotas–Bukić, Poiana Brasov 1973, and now instead of 18 f4? e4 White could have kept a slight plus by 18 f3) 16 ♘d5 ♕xe6 17 ♘xe7+ ♕xe7 18 c5+ ♔h8 19 cd ♘xd6 (or 19 ... ♕xd6 20 ♖fd1 and now Taimanov claims White is slightly better, but in my view White still has to justify his pawn sacrifice after 20 ... c5) 20 ♖c6 ♖ad8 21 ♖fc1 ♖d7 with an unclear position in which White has sufficient compensation for the pawn, Taimanov–Tseitlin, USSR 1973.

14	**f4**	**h6**
15	**fe**	**de**
16	**c5**	**♘fxd5**
17	**♘xd5**	**♘xd5**
18	**cb**	**ab**
19	**♖c6**	**♔h8!**

We have reached a critical position from the game Taimanov–Fischer which was much discussed after the match. Taimanov played 20 ♘f3? ♗b7 21 ♖g6 ♘f4! 22 ♗xf4 ef 23 ♖d1 ♕e7 but now Black was clearly better and won easily. Afterwards there were claims that Fischer was lucky and that 20 ♕h3! would have won more or less by force. There is no doubt that 20 ♕h3! is the best move, but whether it would have won is very doubtful, for example 20 ♕h3 ♖f6 21 ♗c4 f4 (21 ... ♖xc6 22 ♘f7+ ♔h7 23 ♘xd8 ♖xc4 is also possible, and Black has sufficient compensation for the queen) 22 ♕h5 ♗b7 (with the point that 23 ♗xd5 ♕xd5 pins the rook against the mate on g2) 23 ♖e6! ♕f8! and *ECO* stops here with a cryptic assessment of equality. So far as I can see White will be hard-pressed to make a draw. In any case it would appear that 11 ♘g5 is the critical test of the 9 ... ♘e8 line; there have been few recent tests of 9 ... ♘e8, probably because the alternative 9 ... ♘h5 appears safer.

A2

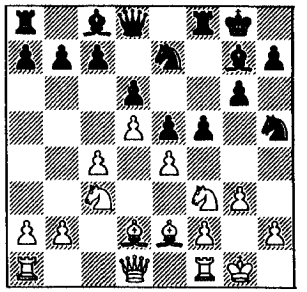
9 ... ♘h5
10 g3

Other moves are even less promising:

a) **10 ♘e1** ♘f4 11 ♘d3 ♘xe2+ (if White allows the exchange of this bishop Black generally has a comfortable position) 12 ♕xe2 f5 13 f3 f4 14 c5 g5 15 ♖ac1 ♘g6 16 cd cd 17 ♘b5 ♖f7 18 ♖c2 a6 19 ♘a3 b5 with advantage to Black, Cobo–A. Rodriguez, Cienfuegos 1977.

b) **10 ♖c1** f5 (10 ... h6 11 ♘e1 ♘f4 12 ♗xf4 ef 13 ♘d3 f5 14 ♘xf4 fe 15 ♘e6 ♗xe6 16 de ♘f5 17 ♕d5 c6 18 ♕xe4 ♕f6 19 ♗g4 ♖ae8 20 ♖ce1 ♖e7 21 ♖e2 ♖fe8 22 ♗xf5 gf 23 ♕d3 ♖xe6 turned out safely for Black in the end, Boersma–Riemersma, Dutch Ch 1987) 11 ef ♘xf5 12 ♘e4 (12 g4 ♘d4) 12 ... ♘f4 13 ♖e1 ♘xe2+ 14 ♕xe2 b6 15 b4 h6 and Black is at least equal, Taimanov–Spassky, USSR Ch 1973.

10 ... f5 *(83)*



11 ef

Or 11 ♘g5 ♘f6 12 f3 c6 13 ♕b3 and now:

a) **13 ... ♔h8** 14 ♗e3 f4 15 ♗f2 fg 16 hg ♘h5 17 ♘e6 ♗xe6 18 de ♕c8 19 c5 d5 20 ed cd 21 ♘xd5 ♕xe6 22 ♘xe7 ♕xe7 23 ♔h2 ♕g5 24 ♖g1 ♕h6 25 ♔g2, with a slight plus for White, Ree–Riemersma, Dutch Ch 1987.

b) **13 ... h6** 14 ♘e6 ♗xe6 15 de ♕c8 16 ♗e3 ♕xe6 (16 ... b6 17 ♖ad1 ♖d8 18 ♕a3 ♕xe6 19 b4 appears better, when White has to justify his pawn offer) 17 ♖ad1 ♔h8 18 ♕xb7 ♖fb8 19 ♕c7! (19 ♕a6? fe 20 fe ♖xb2 21 ♕a3 ♖xe2 22 ♘xe2 ♘xe4 is good for Black) 19 ... ♘e8 20 ♕a5 ♖xb2 21 ♖b1 ♖xb1 22 ♖xb1 with an unclear position, Plachetka–A. Rodriguez, Tbilisi–Sukhumi 1977.

11 ♘g5 is an interesting idea, but a comparison with line A of Chapter 1 suggests that this line should not be dangerous for Black, because b4 is a more useful move than ♗d2. For example, if Black plays 12 ... f4 then the two most obvious moves in Chapter 1, namely b5 and c5, are not possible here.

11 ... ♘xf5

Not 11 ... ♗xf5 (11 ... gf? 12 ♘xe5) 12 ♘g5 ♘f6 13 g4! ♗d7 14 ♘ge4 with a clear plus for White, Borisenko–Terentiev, USSR 1960.

12 ♘e4

Black wins after 12 g4? ♘d4 13 gh ♘xe2+ 14 ♕xe2 ♗g4.

12 ... ♘f6

And now:

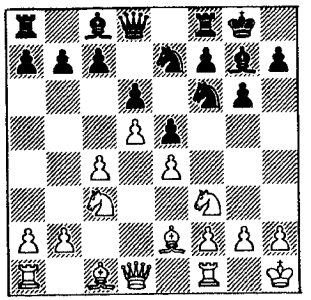
a) **13 ♗d3** ♗h6 (or 13 ... h6 14 ♗c3 c5 15 ♘fd2 b6 16 b4 g5 17 bc bc 18 ♖b1 with equality, Podgayets–Gufeld, USSR Ch 1975) 14 ♗c3 (14 ♘eg5 c6 15 ♗xf5? ♗xf5 16 ♘e6 ♗xe6 17 ♗xh6 ♗g4 would be a mistake, while the simple 14 ♗xh6 is roughly equal) 14 ... ♘g7! 15 ♘fd2 ♘gh5 16 ♖e1 ♗f5 17 c5 ♕d7 18 cd cd 19 f3 ♖f7! and Black held a slight plus in Dorfman–Kupreichik, USSR 1980.

b) **13 ♗g5** h6 14 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 15 ♗d3 (15 ♔g2 ♕e7 16 ♖e1?! ♗g7 17 ♖c1 b6 18 a3 ♗b7 19 ♔g1 ♕f7 was fine for Black in Furman–Plachetka, Madrid 1973) 15 ... ♗g7 16 ♔g2 b6 17 h4 ♗b7! (17 ... ♗d7?! 18 ♖h1 ♕e7 19 h5 gave White an edge, Korchnoi–Geller, USSR Ch 1973) followed by ... c6 and Black has sufficient counterplay to hold the balance.

B

9 ♔h1 *(84)*

After a move such as this virtually any reasonable reply comes into consideration. Perhaps 9 ... ♘d7 or 9... ♘e8 is best (the humorous 9 ... ♔h8!? 10 ♘g1 ♘d7 11 g4 f5 12 f3 ♘g8 13 ♗e3 ♗h6 14 ♗f2 a5 15 a3 ♘c5 was good for Black in Kanko–Hazai, Helsinki 1989, but White's play was very weak), but we content ourselves with two practical examples:



9 ... ♘h5

After this Black is virtually committed to taking on f5 with a piece, but Larsen shows that the resulting positions usually offer White an edge:

a) **10 ♘g1** ♘f4 11 ♗f3 c5 12 a4 h6 13 a5 g5 14 ♖a3 f5 15 ef ♘xf5 16 g3 ♘g6 17 ♘e4 ♘ge7 18 ♗g4 b5 19 ab ♕xb6 20 h3 ♗d7 21 ♘e2 ♗e8 22 ♘2c3 ♗g6 23 ♗h5 ♗h7 24 ♕a4 a6 25 ♔g2 ♘d4 26 ♖h1 ♘ef5 27 h4 gh 28 f4 ♘e7 29 ♖xh4 with a slight plus for White, Larsen–C. Hansen, Odense match 1988.

b) **10 g3** f5 11 ef ♘xf5 12 ♘g5 (12 g4? ♘d4) 12 ... ♘d4 13 ♗d3 ♘f6 14 f3 c6 15 ♘ge4 ♗h3 16 ♖f2 cd 17 ♘xf6+ ♗xf6 18 ♘xd5 ♗g5 19 ♗e4 ♖c8 20 b3 ♗xc1 21 ♖xc1 with a clear plus for White, Larsen–Nunn, Hastings 1987/8.

C

9 a4

Only played once, so again we content ourselves with giving the available evidence:

9 ... a5 10 ♘e1 ♘d7 11 ♗e3 f5 12 f3 ♘c5 13 ♘d3 b6 14 b4 ♘xd3 (Seirawan thinks 14 ... ab 15 ♘xb4 ♖a5 is slightly better for Black as White has no easy way to dislodge the rook on a5) 15 ♕xd3 ab 16 ♘b5 ♔h8 17 ♕b3 ♘g8 18 ♕xb4 ♘f6 (Seirawan gives 18 ... ♗h6 19 ♗xh6 ♘xh6 20 ♕d2 ♘g8 21 a5 ba 22 ♖xa5 ♗d7 aiming to leave White with a bad bishop, while Kasparov prefers 18 ... fe 19 fe ♖xf1+ 20 ♖xf1 ♗h6 with an edge for Black) 19 ef gf 20 ♗g5 (not 20 a5 ba 21 ♖xa5 c5!) 20 ... h6 21 ♗h4 ♗d7 22 ♖a3 ♕b8 23 ♗f2 ♖g8 24 ♖b1 ♘h5 25 ♔h1 (White should have played 25 a5 ♗xb5 26 ♕xb5 ba 27 ♖xa5 ♘f4 28 ♗f1 e4 29 ♕xb8 ♖gxb8 30 ♖xb8+ ♖xb8 31 fe fe with equality) 25 ... ♕d8 26 a5 ♗xb5 27 ♕xb5 ba 28 g3 f4 29 g4 e4 30 fe ♘f6 31 ♗h4 ♕e7 32 ♗f3 ♕e5 33 ♖e1 ♘h7 34 ♕d7 ♗f6 35 ♗xf6+ ♘xf6 36 ♕f5 ♕xf5 37 ef ♘xg4 38 ♗xg4 ♖xg4 39 ♖h3 ♔g7 40 ♖e7+ ♔f6 41 ♖e6+ ♔xf5 42 ♖hxh6 ♖f8 43 ♖h5+ ♖g5 44 ♖xg5+ ♔xg5 45 c5 a4 46 cd cd 47 ♖xd6 ♖a8 48 ♖e6 a3 49 ♖e1 ♔f5 50 h4 f3 51 d6 a2 52 ♖a1 ♔f4 53 ♔h2 f2 54 d7 ♔f3 55 ♖c1 a1♕ 0–1 Korchnoi–Kasparov, Barcelona 1989.

D

9 ♗g5

A speciality of the the Soviet player Legki, now taken up by Eingorn and Gelfand. It looks strange to offer the exchange of White's important black-squared bishop, but if Black spends a tempo on ... h6 White gains time for his queenside attack. Nevertheless I doubt if Black should be worried by this move. Practical experience is very limited:

a) **9 ... ♘d7** 10 ♘d2 and now:

a1) **10 ... f6?!** 11 ♗e3 f5 12 f3 f4 13 ♗f2 (Black's weak play has given White the best of both worlds: the active bishop position of Chapter 7 with the ♘d2–c4 manoeuvre of Chapter 4) 13 ... g5 14 b4 ♘f6 15 c5 ♘e8 16 a4 ♘g6 17 ♘c4 ♖f7 18 cd ♘xd6 19 a5 ♗f8 20 ♘xd6 ♗xd6 21 ♘b5 a6 22 ♘xd6 cd 23 ♖c1 with a massive advantage for White, Legki–Reyes, Vrnjačka Banja 1989.

a2) **10 ... f5** (much better) 11 ef gf 12 f4 ♘f6 13 ♗h5 (artificial) 13 ... e4 14 ♘b3 c5 15 dc bc 16 ♔h1 d5 17 ♗e2 ♔h8 18 ♗h4 ♘g6 19 ♗f2 ♘xf4! 20 ♗c5 ♘xe2 21 ♗xf8 ♘g3+ 22 hg ♕xf8 with excellent compensation for the exchange, Gelfand–Grivas, Haifa 1989.

a3) **10 ... a5** 11 a3 f5 12 f3 c5 13 dc bc 14 b4 ♘f6 15 ♔h1 ♗e6 16 ♘b3 ab 17 ab ♖xa1 18 ♕xa1 ♕b6 19 ♕a3 with a balanced position, Eingorn–Zapata, Moscow GMA 1989.

b) **9 ... h6** 10 ♗xf6 ♗xf6 11 b4 ♗g7 (or 11 ... ♔h7 12 c5 ♘g8 13 a4 dc 14 bc ♗e7 15 ♘xe5 ♗xc5 16 ♘c4 c6 17 ♗f3 cd 18 ed with an initiative for White in Eingorn–Uhlmann, Debrecen 1989, but I prefer 11 ... c6, making it harder for White to play c5) 12 c5 f5 13 ♘d2 fe 14 ♘c4 ♘f5 15 ♘xe4 dc 16 bc ♘d4 17 ♘e3 ♔h8 18 ♗d3 ♗f5 19 ♖c1 c6 20 dc bc 21 ♘d6 with a slight plus for White, Legki–Vuruna, Vrnjačka Banja 1989.

c) **9 ... ♘h5** 10 g3 f6 11 ♗d2 f5 transposes to line A2 of this chapter.

Index of Variations

1 d4 ♘f6
2 c4 g6
3 ♘c3 ♗g7
4 e4 d6
5 ♘f3 0-0
6 ♗e2 e5
7 0-0 ♘c6
8 d5 ♘e7

A 9 ♘d2
B 9 ♘e1

Or:
9 ♗d2 ♘h5 *106*
9 ♗d2 others *103*
9 ♔h1 *107*
9 a4 *108*
9 ♗g5 *109*
9 b4 ♘h5:
10 g3 *14*
10 c5 *16*
9 b4 others *11*

A 9 ♘d2 a5
9 ... ♗h6 *45*
9 ... ♘d7 *45*
9 ... ♘e8 *48*
9 ... c6 *49*
9 ... c5:
10 ♖b1 *35*
10 dc bc 11 b4 d5:
12 b5 *42*
12 others *41*
10 a3
10 others *20*
10 ... ♘d7
10 ... c5 11 ♖b1 ♘e8 12 b4 ab 13 ab b6 14 bc bc 15 ♘b3:
15 ... ♔h8 *31*
15 ... f5 *32*
10 ... others *22*
11 ♖b1
11 others *24*
11 ... f5
11 ... others *24*
12 b4 ♔h8
12 ... b6 *30*
12 ... others *25*
13 ♕c2 *26*
13 f3 *28*

B 9 ♘e1 ♘d7
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9 ... ♘e8 *99*
10 ♘d3
10 ♗d2 *51*
10 f3 f5:
11 g4:
11 ... f4 *76*
11 ... h5 *78*
11 ... ♘f6 *79*
11 ... ♔h8 *82*
11 ... others *76*
11 ♗e3 f4 12 ♗f2 g5:
13 ♘d3 *90*
13 b4 *91*
13 ♘b5 *95*
13 others *89*
10 ... f5
11 ♗d2
11 ef:
11 ... gf *53*
11 ... ♘xf5 *54*
11 f3 *52*
11 ... ♘f6
11 ... others *56*
12 f3 f4
12 ... ♔h8 *71*
12 ... c5 *60*
13 c5
13 g4 *60*
13 ... g5
13 ... c6 *62*
14 cd
14 others *63*
14 ... cd
15 ♖c1
15 ♘f2 *63*
15 ... ♘g6
16 ♘b5
16 others *66*
16 ... ♖f7
17 ♕c2
17 others *66*
17 ... ♘e8
17 ... g4 *66*
18 a4 h5
19 ♘f2 ♗f8
19 ... ♗d7 *66*
20 h3
20 b4 *67*
20 ♘xa7 *67*
20 ... ♖g7
21 ♘xa7 *68*
21 a5 *69*
21 ♕b3 *68*